novelibre User guide

Release 5.13.3

Peter Triesberger

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Deutsch

This page refers to the latest novelibre release. You can open it with **Help > Online help**.

Deutsch

CHAPTER

ONE

INTRODUCTION

This chapter is about the role of computer software for novelists, and how *novelibre* fits in.

1.1 Office software vs. writing software

If you want to write a novel on your PC, you generally have the choice between an office word processor or special writing software (plain text editors are neglected at this point).

Office software is readily available, widely used, efficient and proven. There is literature and training courses available. Many people use office software professionally and are familiar with its basic functions, so there is no particular difficulty to use it when "writing part-time".

However, anyone writing a large novel will sooner or later reach a point where the story threatens to become overwhelming. You may already have outlines, notes, planning documents, synopsis drafts, chapter overviews and so on, but as the manuscript grows, it becomes increasingly difficult to keep these documents up to date. Rearranging sections and chapters, introducing additional storylines, maintaining chronological coherence - all this can become a serious challenge at the latest during revision.

This is where specialized writing software comes in. It generally offers better tools than office software to break down a novel into small pieces and to provide these pieces with all the additional information which would otherwise consist of notebooks, spreadsheets, supplementary documents and sticky notes. The main purpose of this software is therefore to keep the big picture of the story in view, even if the story is constantly being expanded, shortened or restructured. If you move a part of the text, the summaries, notes, word count information, and everything that falls under the term "metadata" move with it, so that everything always fits together.

Many writing programs also offer access to the collected digital research material so that everything is in one place and users only need one program for all their work. Of course, this requires a certain willingness to learn. Some writing programs have an operating concept that deviates from the standards of office software. This can be a hurdle for authors who do not enjoy experimenting with their PC. In addition, the word processing function of free writing software in particular is not always as mature as we are used to with office software.

1.2 Why novelibre?

The developer of *novelibre* has worked with office word processors for decades and has come to appreciate their advantages. At the same time, it was always a pleasure for him to try out every piece of writing software that came his way, always on the lookout for the perfect program. For a long time, that seemed to be yWriter. It is free and stable, and you can use it especially in conjunction with an "external text editor", i.e. an office word processor. So you can structure and overview your novel with *yWriter* and write with OpenOffice at the same time. The developer of *yWriter* is a prolific writer himself and his software is very efficient in supporting especially his workflow.

However, there are other approaches to novel writing for which *yWriter* does not offer support out of the box. This mainly involves dramaturgical structures (e.g. the "three-act model" or the "hero's journey") and storytelling with

several narrative strands or plot lines. There are impressive solutions for this in the commercial sector, such as *DramaQueen* or *Causality*.

Anyway, programming is fun, and that's how *novelibre* was born, another writing program that tries to combine the advantages of very different software. You can see *novelibre* as a supplement to LibreOffice or OpenOffice. It manages the structure and metadata of the novel and, in addition to the actual manuscript, generates a selection of Office text and spreadsheet documents that can be worked on.

novelibre is primarily designed for authors who are familiar with LibreOffice or OpenOffice and who are missing the additional administration functions of specialized writing software.

As a special feature, you can use *novelibre* in combination with dedicated timeline software such as the free Timeline which opens up completely new possibilities for planning of the narrative plot.

As a computer program, *novelibre* has to save its data somehow. To do this, it uses an open and well-documented file format, so that nobody has to worry that his novel will at some point "be stuck in the program and no longer wants to come out".

Last but not least, this online manual provides a comprehensive documentation of the *novelibre* features.

However you may have found your way here, I wish you much joy and success in writing your novel with *novelibre*!

CHAPTER

TWO

PREPARATIONS

In the following I will describe how to install *novelibre*. I also give some tips on setting up LibreOffice and OpenOffice to optimize the interaction with *novelibre*.

2.1 Setting up novelibre

The actual installation of *novelibre* is simple and straightforward. The installation program automatically creates an installation directory, copies everything necessary into it, and generates a start file named **run.pyw** adapted for the respective computer, which must be called in order to execute *novelibre*.

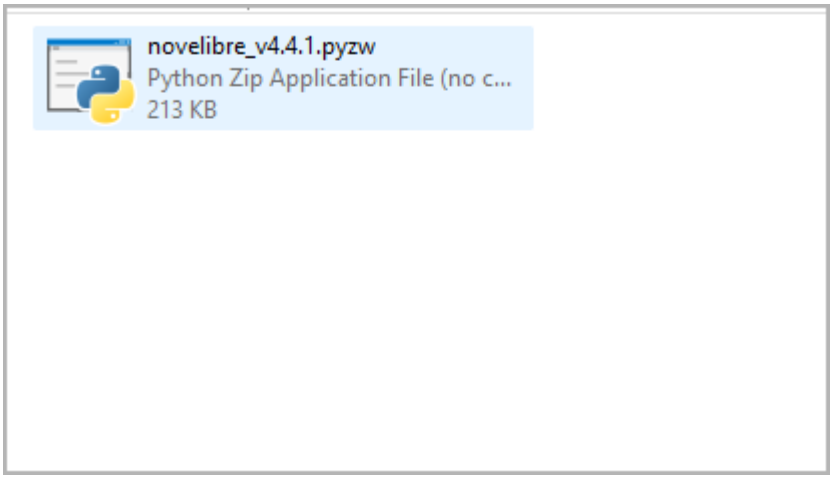
The necessary manual work consists of linking this start file to the desktop and, if desired, assigning a program icon to the link. I will also show you how to set it up under Windows so that the *novelibre* project files have their own program icon and that the program application is started when you double-click on them.

Unfortunately, I cannot automate this with my simple means without causing problems with the security mechanisms of the operating system.

2.1.1 Installing the application

Step 1

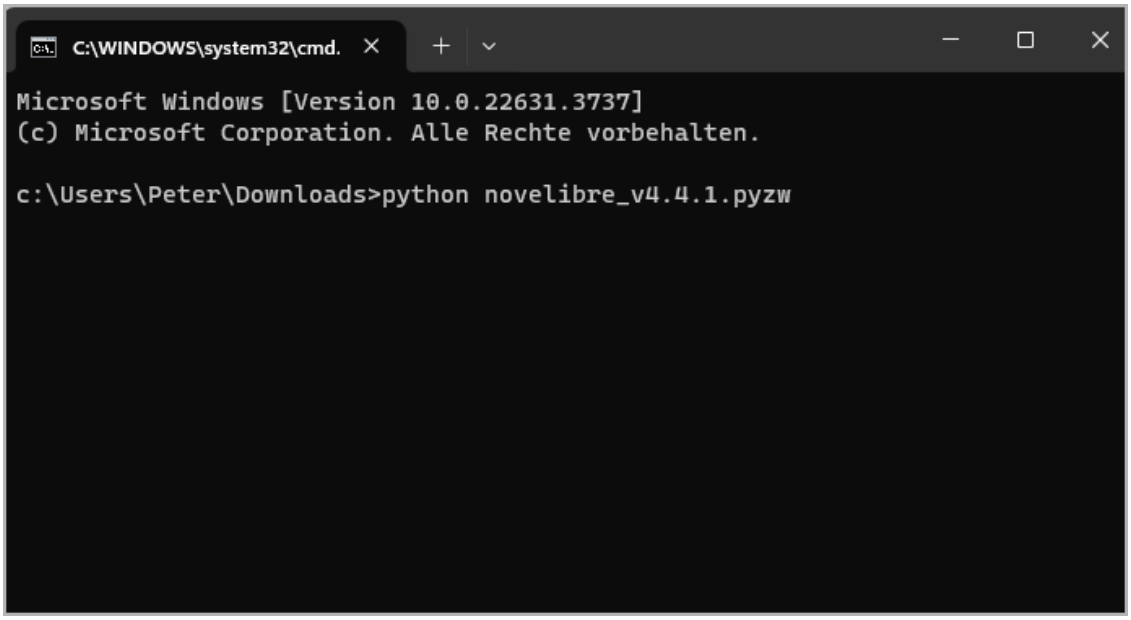
- Either launch the downloaded **novelibre_vx.x.x.pyzw** file by double-clicking (Windows/Linux desktop),



- or execute

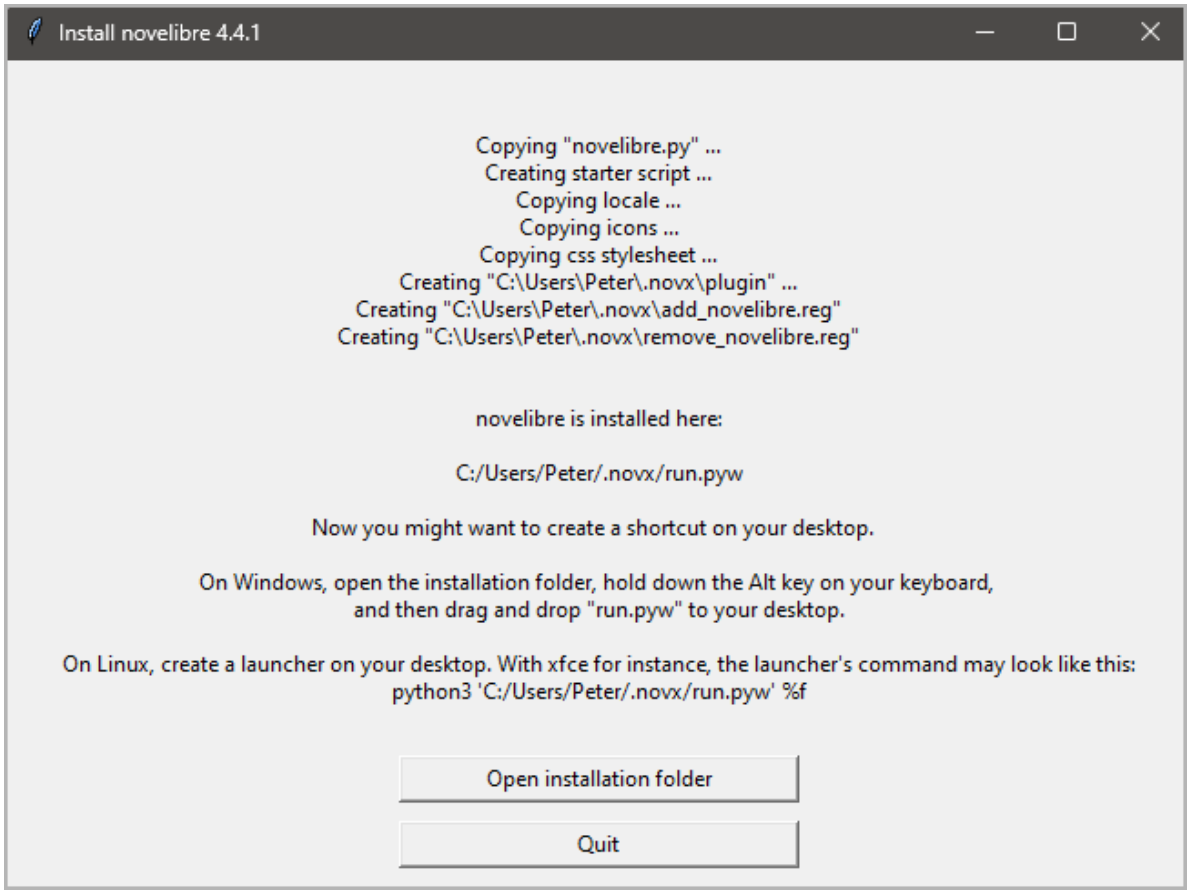
  `python novelibre_vx.x.x.pyzw` (Windows), resp.

  `python3 novelibre_vx.x.x.pyzw` (Linux) on the command line.



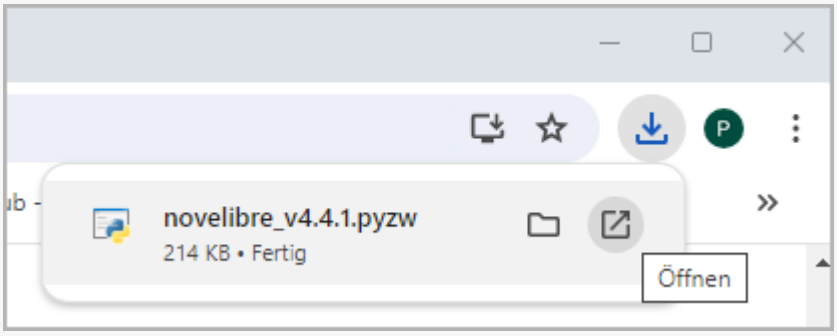
"x.x.x" means the version number.

In both cases, a pop-up window should appear indicating that the installation was successful.



Important

Many web browsers recognize the download as an executable file and offer to open it immedately. This starts the installation.



However, depending on your security settings, your browser may initially refuse to download the executable file. In this case, your confirmation or an additional action is required. If this is not possible, you have the option of downloading the zip file.

2.1.2 Making novelibre accessible on the Desktop

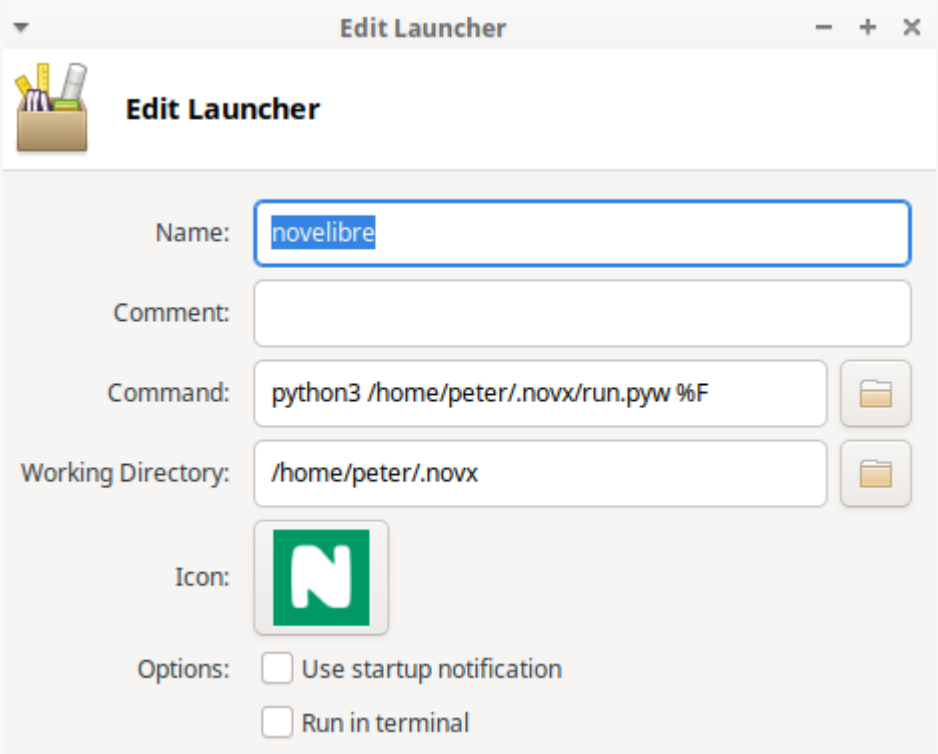
Note for Linux users

In the following chapters, the Windows procedure is described.

As a Linux user, you are expected to know how to set up a program launcher on your specific desktop. Roughly speaking, it is a matter of calling **python3** with **~/.novx/run.pyw** and an optionally specified file as parameters.

With the XFCE desktop, for example, my launcher command is:

```
python3 /home/peter/.novx/run.pyw %F
```

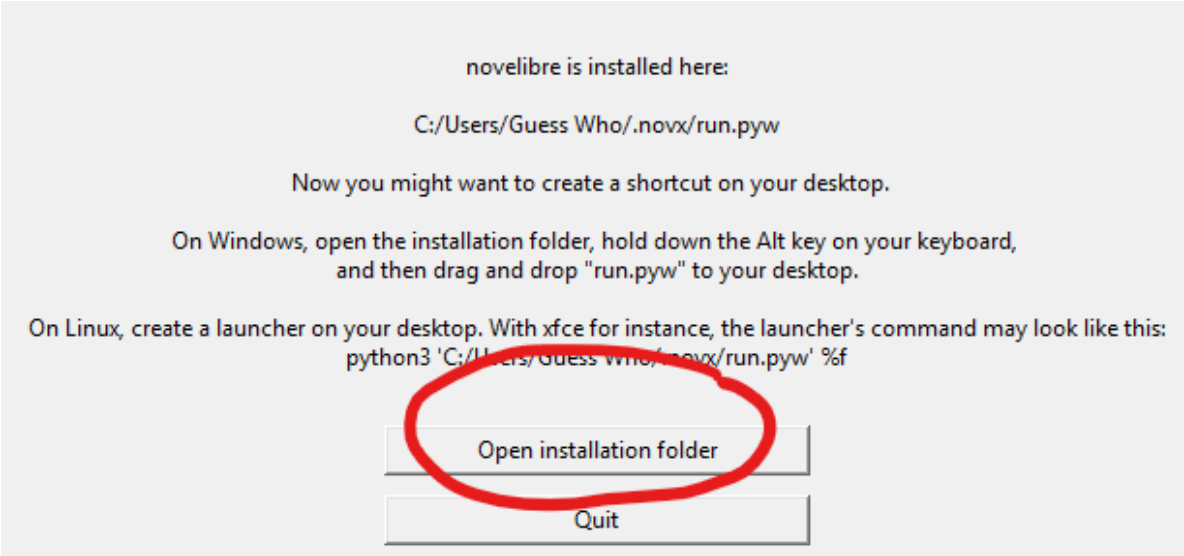


You might have to copy the *novelibre* icons to a dedicated image directory where your program launcher gets the icons from. You also may want to set *novelibre* as standard application for files with the *.novx* extension, and assign them the *novelibre* logo as file icon. With the XFCE desktop, none of this was too difficult for me. In doubt, refer to your desktop documentation.

It's a good idea to register the *novx* extension in the mimetypes as **text/xml**, so it can be opened with your web browser for display, using the novx.css style sheet.

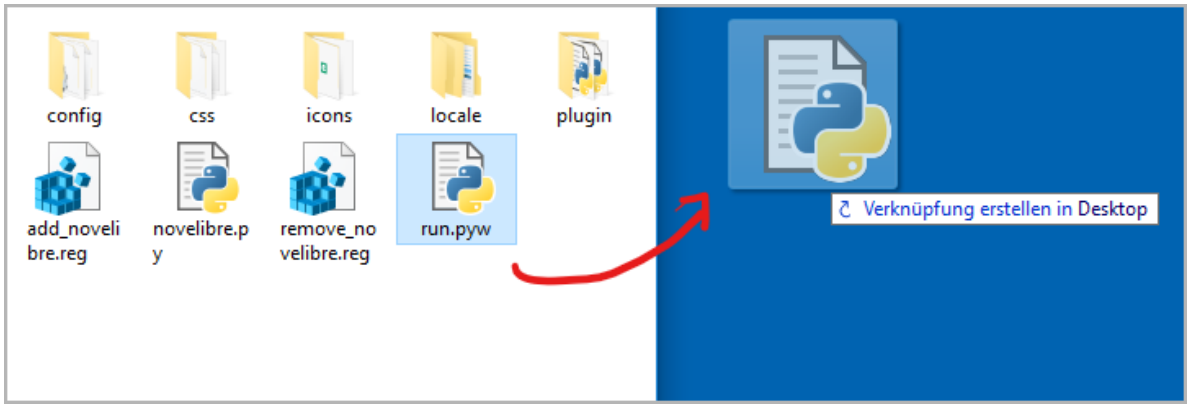
Step 2

Open the installation folder.



Step 3

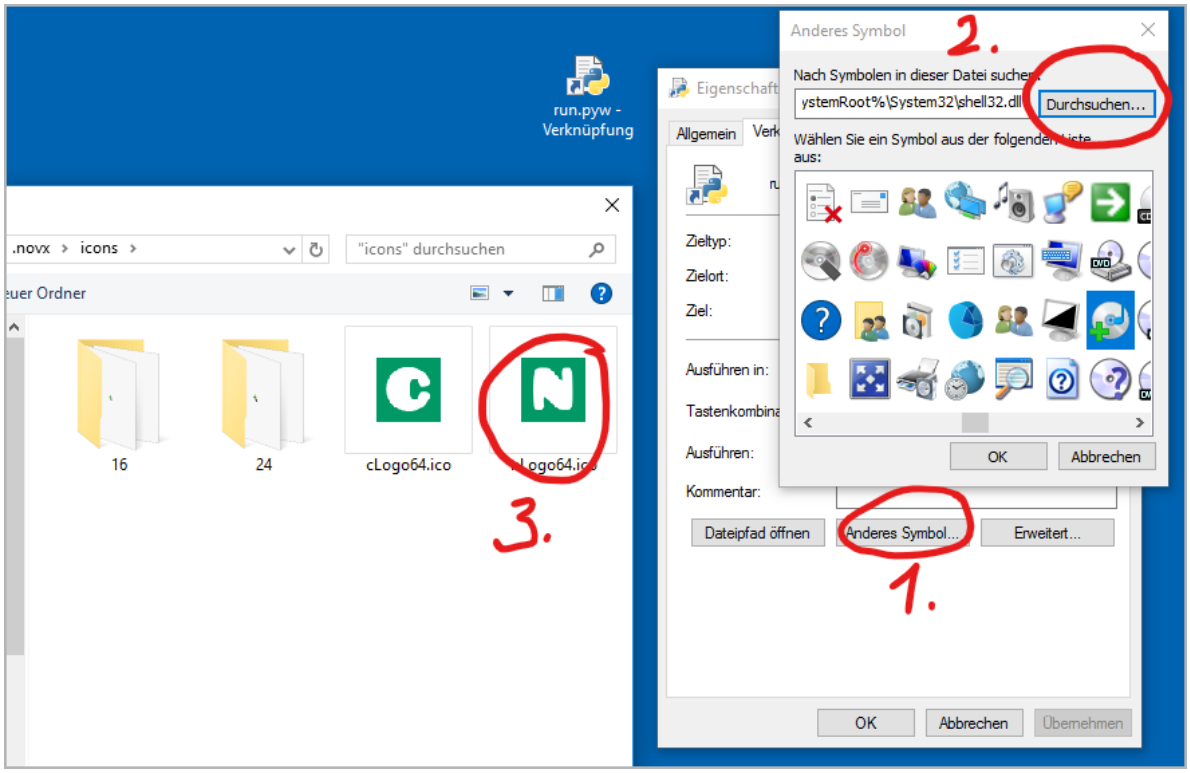
Drag and drop **run.pyw** to the desktop while holding down the `Alt` key. This creates a shortcut to launch *novelibre* from the Windows desktop. Now you can also drag and drop *.novx* project files to this shortcut.



Step 4

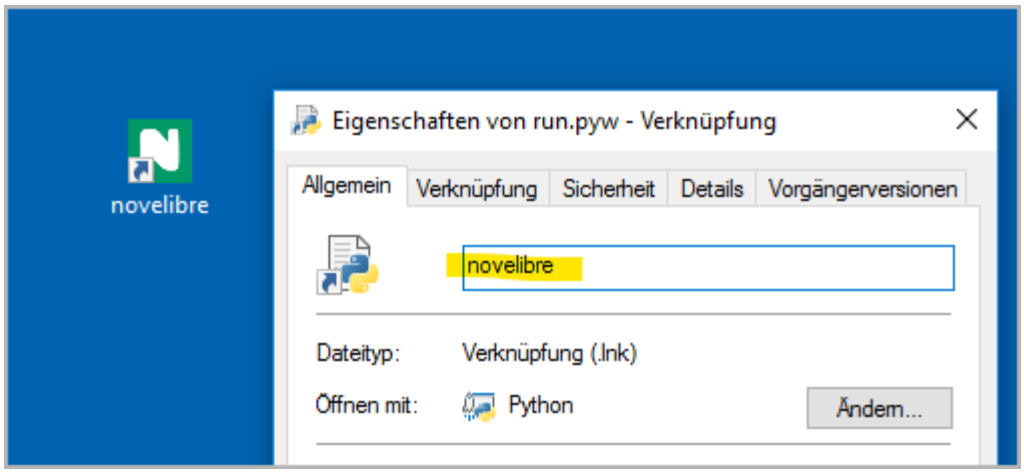
Optionally, you can replace the "Python" icon with the *novelibre* logo you may find in the installation's *icons* subdirectory.

To do this, right-click on the desktop shortcut and open the **Properties** dialog. Select the **Shortcut** Tab and click on the **Change icon** button (1). In the icon selection dialog, click on the **Browse…** button (2). This opens a file selection dialog. Move to `<home>\.novx\icons` and double-click on the "N" logo (3).



Step 5

To rename the shortcut to *novelibre*, right-click on the desktop shortcut and open the **Properties** dialog. In the first tab, replace "Shortcut to run.pyw" with "novelibre".

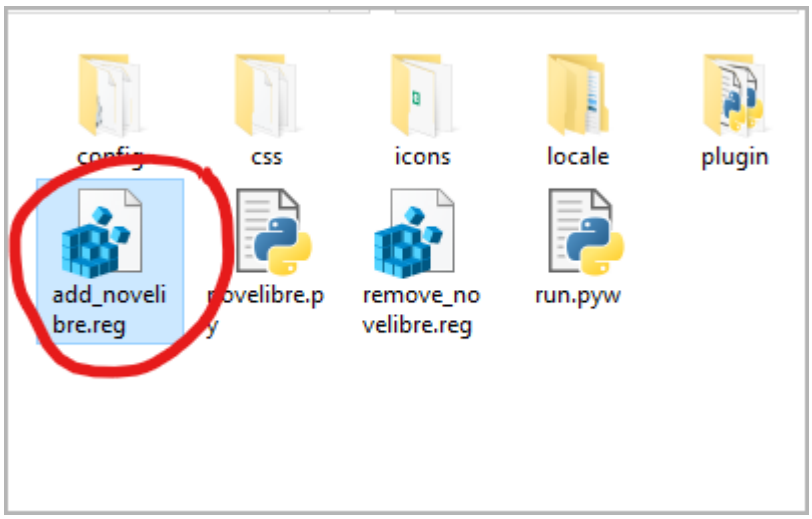


2.1.3 Associating .novx files with novelibre

Step 6

Optionally, you can associate the **.novx** file extension with the *novelibre* application. Then the project files are displayed with the *novelibre* icon in the Explorer, and you can open them with *novelibre* by double-click. Further, you can display *.novx* files with a web browser, using the novx.css style sheet.

Double-click on the **add_novelibre.reg** script. Windows will display a warning and ask you for confirmation. If in doubt, you can inspect the *add_novelibre.reg* file with a text editor or ask an expert you trust.



Hint

You can undo this by executing the **remove_novelibre.reg** script. This removes all the *novelibre*-specific entries from the Windows registry while keeping the application.

To uninstall the application and all its tools, plugins, and configuration data, just delete the `<home>\.novx` folder after executing the **remove_novelibre.reg** script.

Important

Executing the program under Windows by double-clicking on the *.novx* file works under the hood by calling the currently installed version of the Python interpreter.

If you update Python at a later date, you must then re-install *novelibre* afterwards, and execute **add_novelibre.reg** again. Otherwise, Windows will not be able to find the new Python version and will fail when trying to open *.novx* files on double-clicking.

Please keep that in mind, even if it's pretty unlikely that *novelibre* will need a Python update in the near future.

2.1.4 Updating the application or a plugin

Just execute the first step as described above. If there is any further action required, the setup script will give you a message.

2.2 Setting up Writer

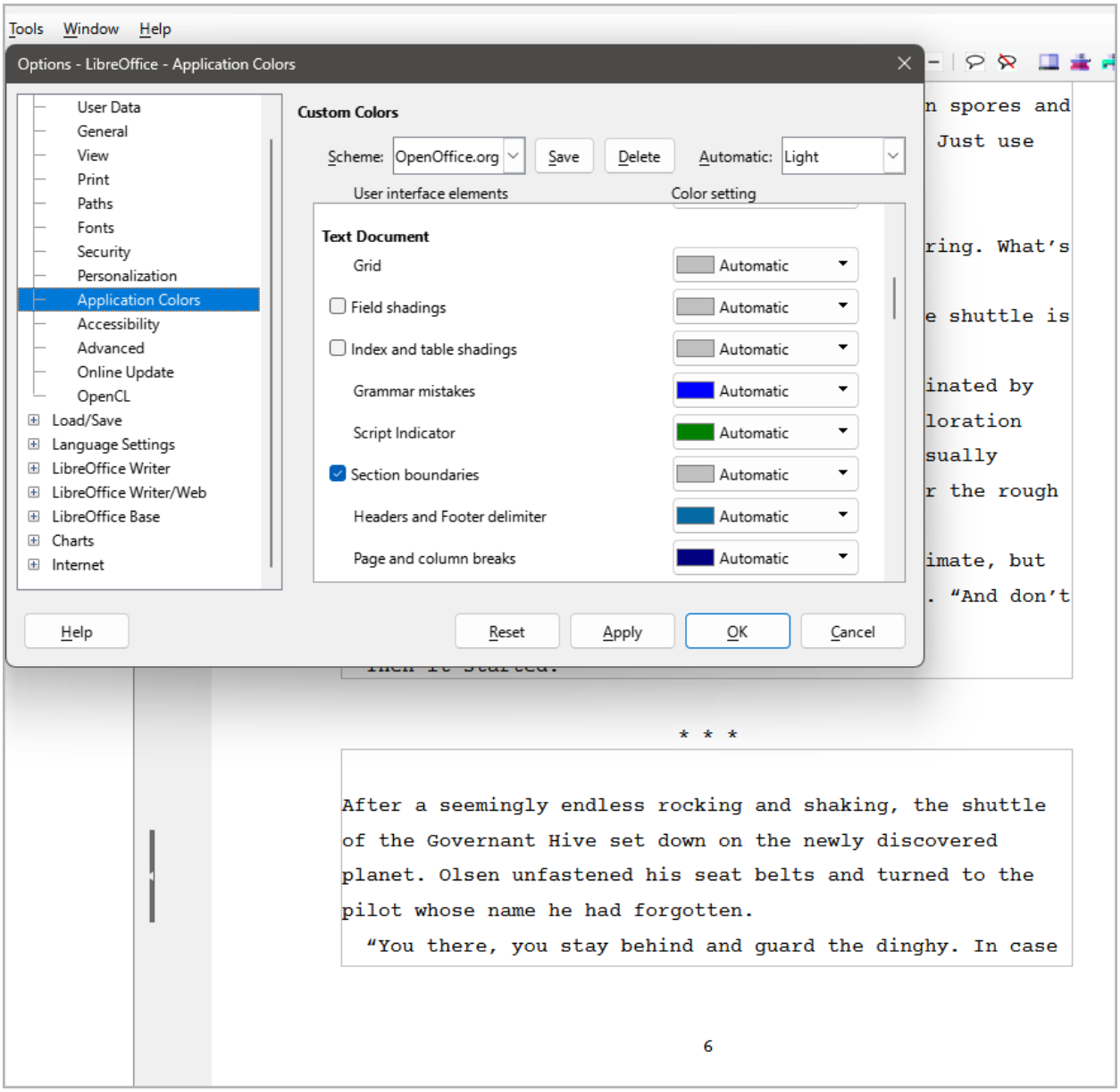
I assume that *novelibre* users are already familiar with LibreOffice or OpenOffice *Writer*. Therefore, I will only give a few brief tips that relate specifically to the interaction with *novelibre*.

2.2.1 Making the sections visible in the manuscript

An essential part of the workflow is writing with the *Writer* word processor. For this, *novelibre* creates editable manuscript files in the *Open Document Text* format that are meant to be temporary. These documents contain structural information that enables *novelibre* to recognize and correctly sort the sections when reading them back.

For the whole thing to work, it is extremely important that you only write within the section boundaries. To do this, you might want to make the section boundaries visible in the *Writer* settings.

The following picture shows a LibreOffice 7.6 screenshot. Make sure the **Section boundaries** box in the **Tools > Options > Application Colors** dialog is ticked. Writing outsides the visible section boundaries has no effect on your *novelibre* project.



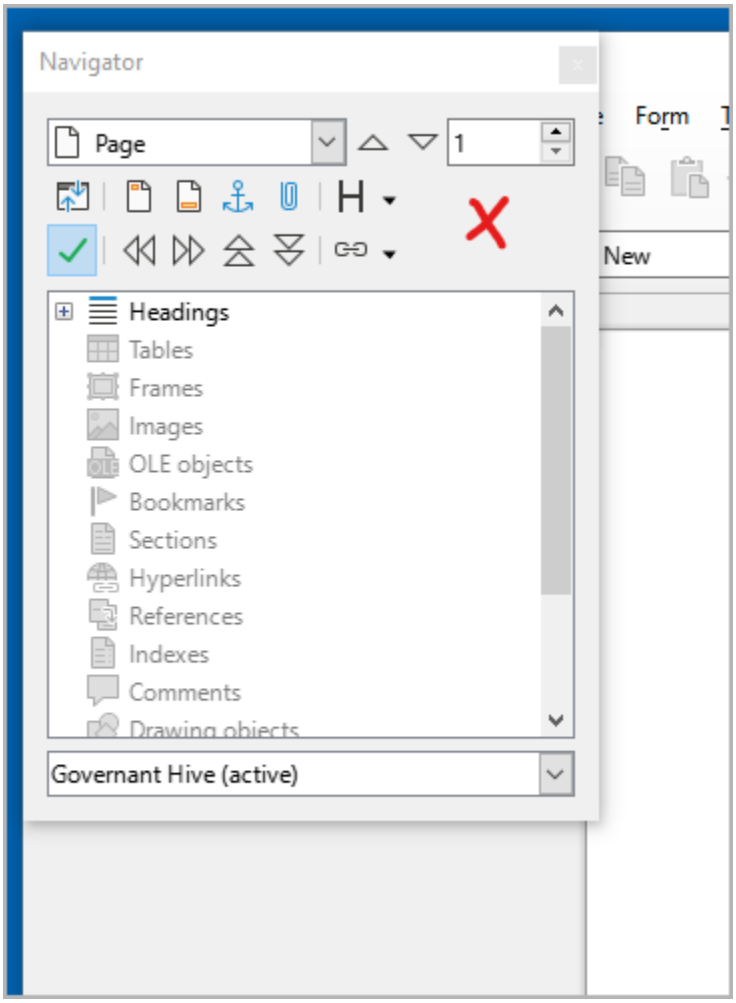
Hint

With OpenOffice and older versions of LibreOffice the dialog may be called "Appearance" instead of "Application Colors".

2.2.2 Docking the Navigator

To quickly find the chapters and sections of your novel in *Writer*, it is best to keep the Navigator in sight. I prefer to dock it to the left of the work area. To do this, first press `F5` to open the Navigator. By default, it appears as a pop-up window that can be placed anywhere on the screen. To dock it, double-click in a free gray space while holding down the `Ctrl` key, as shown in the following image.

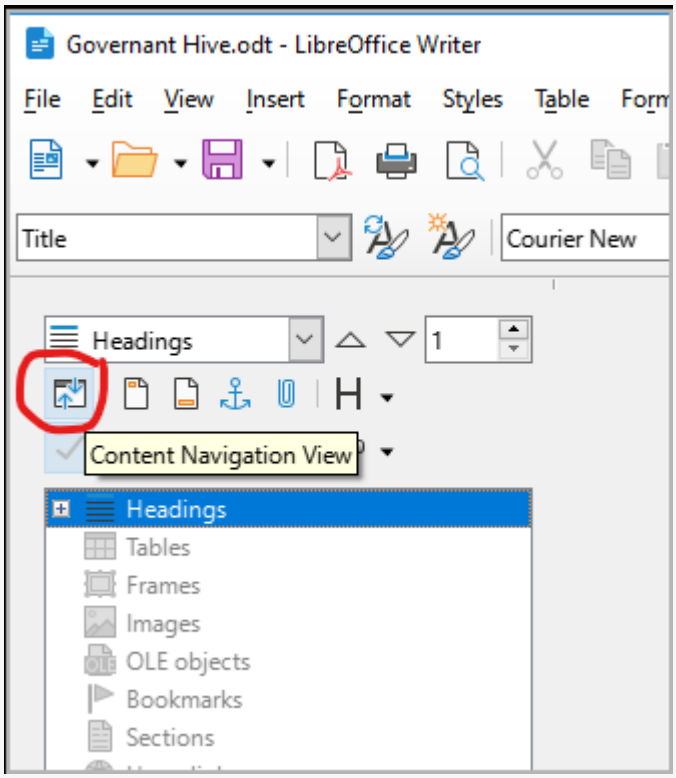
The following picture shows a LibreOffice Writer screenshot. The red "X" indicates the position for double-clicking.



Tip

The Navigator displays a confusing wealth of information. It is best to reduce this to the headings first. To do this, select "Headings" at the top of the tree and then click on the "Content Navigation View" icon. This works if a document containing headings is loaded.

The following picture shows a LibreOffice Writer screenshot. The red "O" indicates the icon to click on.



2.2.3 Customizing the look of your manuscript

The manuscript created by *novelibre* has a layout that is similar to the "standard manuscript format" which is widely used to provide an overview of the total number of pages of a work to be printed.

However, the set font "Courier New" is only available for Windows, and it is not particularly attractive (I, for my part, have installed the free Courier Prime font on Windows and Linux, which gives me a pleasant typewriter feel).

In addition, hyphenation is turned off, and the page size is set to A4, which is not the worldwide standard.

That's not for you? No problem. This is what the **document templates** in *Writer* are for. So if you don't like the look of the generated manuscript, simply apply a template that suits your needs and tastes. Perhaps you have to design your favorite template first, but your knowledge of this technique will pay off when it comes to designing print pages for self-publishing.

In order to minimize circumstances, I recommend my Style switcher extension, that allows you to customize your manuscript with a single mouse click.

Note

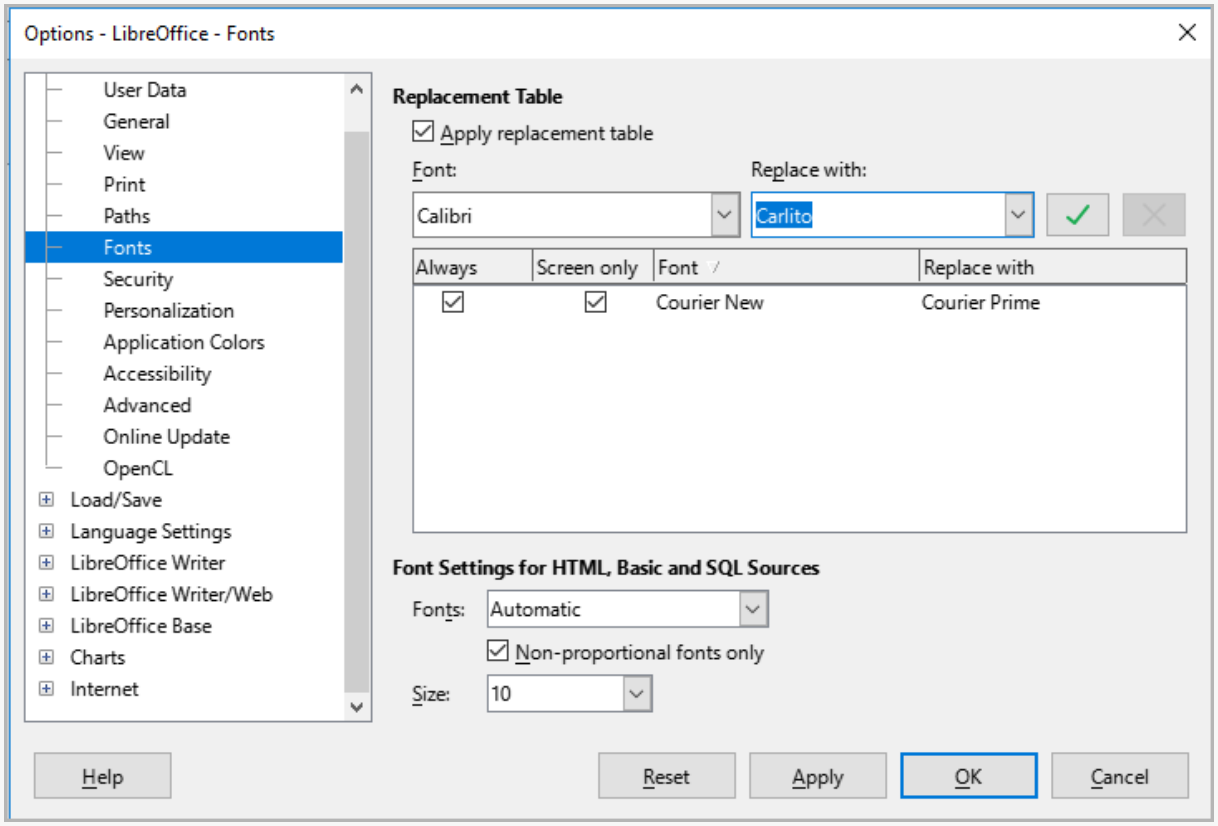
Loading a template or changing the default font and page size has no impact on reimporting the document with *novelibre*.

Tip

If you just want to change the font without applying templates, you can achieve this by having LibreOffice replace it automatically. For this, open the **Options** dialog and go to **Fonts**. Tick the **Apply replacement table** checkbox.

Then enter the fonts of your choice.

novelibre uses “Courier New” for text documents, and “Calibri” for spreadsheets.



Tip

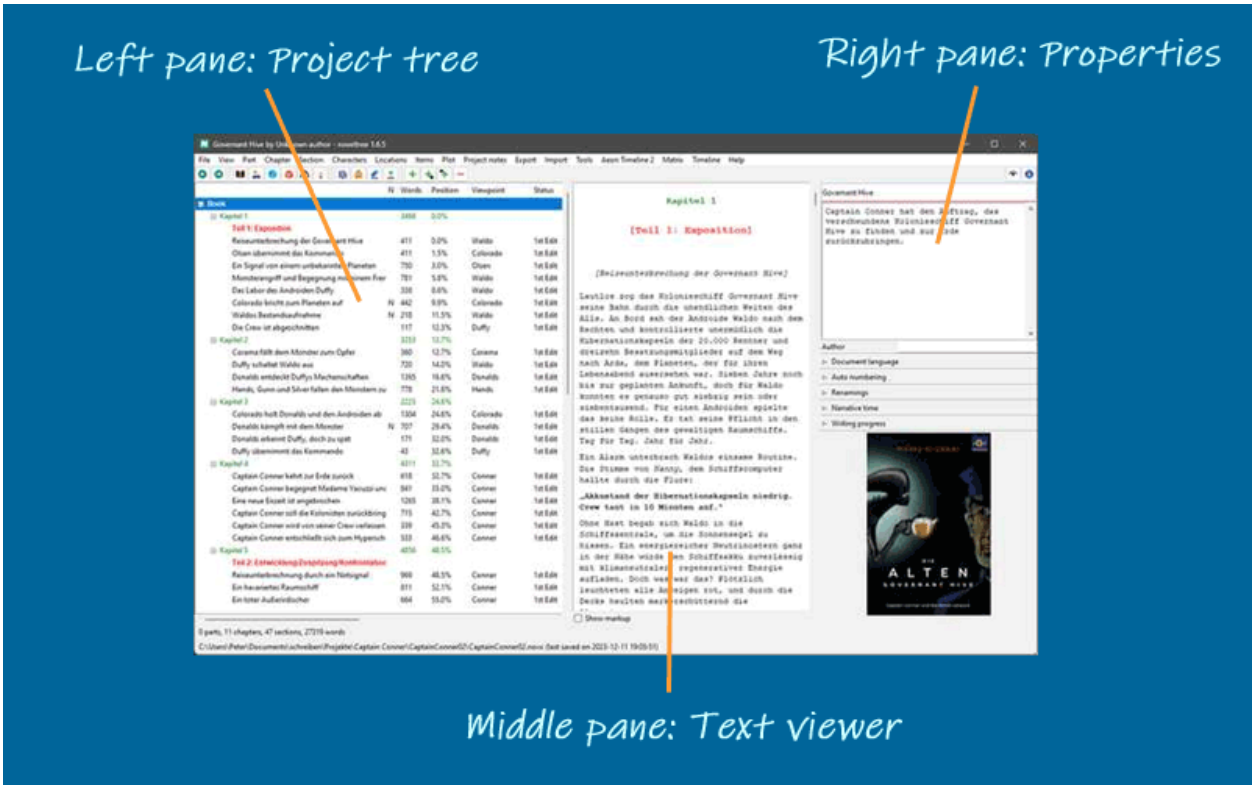
If you prefer simple blank lines instead of the three-asterisks section separators in your final document, you can achieve this using “Find and replace”. This is particularly convenient with a macro that comes with the novelibre-tools extension.

CHAPTER

THREE

DESKTOP OVERVIEW

The *novelibre* desktop is divided into three panes:



3.1 Project tree

The project tree in the left pane shows the organization of the project.

- The tree elements are color-coded according to the section type (see Basic concepts). *Normal* type sections are highlighted according to the selected coloring mode (see *Options* in the View menu).
- The order of the columns can be changed (see *Options* in the View menu).
- Right-clicking on a tree element opens a context menu with several options.
- The type of chapters and sections, as well as the completion status of the sections are color coded and can be changed via context menu.

3.1.1 Project tree structure

- The **Book** branch contains the parts, chapters, and sections that belong to the novel manuscript.
- The **Characters/Locations/Items** branches contain descriptions of the story world's elements that can be associated with the book's sections.
- The **Plot lines** branch contains the plot lines and plot points.
- The **Project notes** branch contains project notes.

3.1.2 Project tree operation

Browsing the tree

novelibre has a browsing history for the selected tree elements. This allows you to go back and forth e.g. between a section and its related characters.

- or `Alt-Left`: Go forward in history.
- or `Alt-Right`: Go back in history.

> **Hint**
>
> On Windows, the "Forward" and "Back" mouse buttons (if any) may also work.

Skipping other kinds of nodes

With the `Alt` key hold down, you can navigate directly to the next or previous tree element on the same level (e.g. section or chapter or character).

- `Alt-Up`: Go to the previous node of the same kind.
- `Alt-Down`: Go to the next node of the same kind.

Move tree elements

Drag and drop while holding down the `Alt` key.

> **Hint**
>
> With some Linux desktops, it may be necessary to first press the mouse button, then the `Alt` key.

> **Caution**
>
> Be aware, there is no "Undo" feature.

Delete tree elements

Select the element to delete and hit the `Del` key.

- Parts and chapters are deleted.
- Sections are marked "unused" and moved to the "Trash" chapter.
- Deleting a part has no effect on its subordinate chapters.
- Deleting a chapter moves its sections to the "Trash" chapter.

- The "Trash" chapter is created automatically, if needed.
- When deleting the "Trash" chapter, all its sections are deleted.

Copy/paste tree elements

You can copy and paste the following tree elements via the system clipboard:

- Parts and chapters,
- sections,
- stages,
- plot lines,
- plot points,
- characters,
- locations,
- items,
- project notes.

Elements can be transferred to and from the clipboard one by one. The element's properties and "children" are copied, except relationships.

Via the clipboard, you can transfer these elements between different *novelibre* projects, or within a project.

3.2 Text viewer

The **Text viewer** in the middle pane shows the part/chapter/section contents with their titles as headings.

- You can open or close the middle pane with the Text viewer with **View > Toggle Text viewer**, or `Ctrl-T`, or clicking on .
- On opening, the text viewer shows the text where the tree is selected.
- When changing the tree selection, the text moves along.
- However, the text can be scrolled independently with the vertical scrollbar, or the mousewheel.
- You can select text with the mouse, and copy it to the clipboard with `Ctrl-C`.
- You cannot edit the text in the viewer. For this, you might want to install an editor plugin, such as nv_editor.
- Section text is color-coded according to the section type (see Basic concepts).
- With the **Show markup** checkbox, XML markup can be shown/hidden.

3.3 Properties

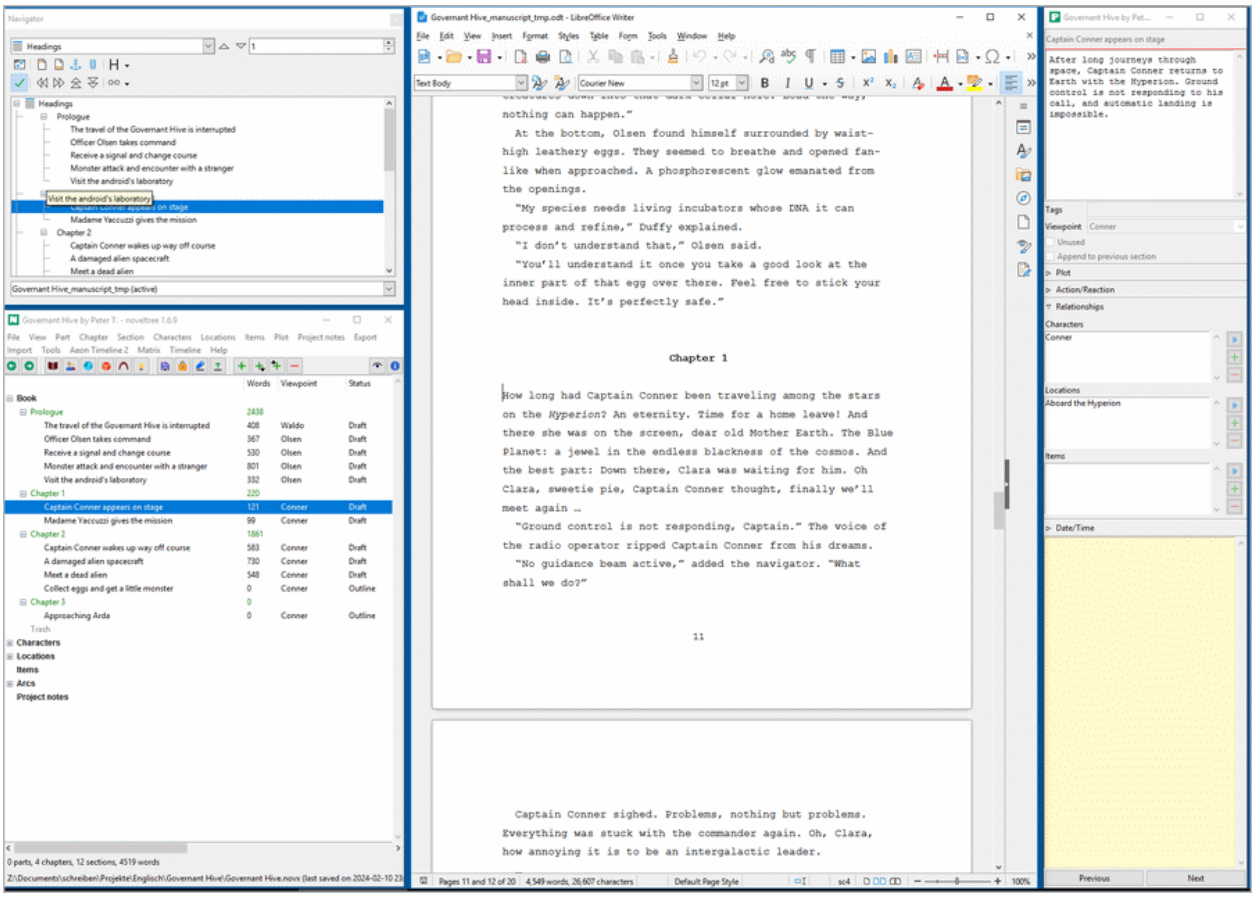
The Properties in the right pane show properties and metadata of the element selected in the project tree.

- The project settings can be made in the *Book* properties view.
- You can open or close the element properties window with **View > Toggle Properties** or `Ctrl-Alt-T`, or clicking on .
- On opening, the windows shows the editable properties of the selected element.

- You can detach or dock the element properties window with **View > Detach/Dock Properties** or `Ctrl-Alt-D`.
- On closing the detached window, the properties are docked again.

On large screens, you can arrange *novelibre* and *Writer* with detached windows.

The following picture shows an example: Arranging LibreOffice (middle) with detached Navigator (upper left), and novelibre (lower left) with detached Properties (right)



3.4 Menu bar

The bar at the top is the menu bar with the main menu, which is documented in the Command reference.

3.5 Toolbar

The second bar from the top is the toolbar with buttons for frequently used actions.

3.6 Status bar

The second bar from the bottom is the status bar. It normally displays project statistics, such as word count. These are overwritten with program messages when necessary.

- Messages on a green background indicate successful actions.
- Messages on a yellow background indicate notifications or warnings.

- Messages on a red background indicate errors.

> **Tip**
>
> You can restore the normal view at any time by clicking on the status bar.

3.7 Footer bar

The footer bar at the bottom displays the project file path and the file date.

Change notification
: If there are unsaved changes, the footer bar is highlighted in goldenrod.

Project lock
: If the project is locked, the footer bar is displayed in reversed colors.

CHAPTER

FOUR

BASIC CONCEPTS

Summary

- With *novelibre* you can organize your novel on three hierarchical levels.
- If you shorten your novel, you can exclude individual chapters and sections without deleting them immediately. You can also write sections with alternative text so that you can decide later what you want to include in the final version. To do this, change the *type*.
- Part of organizing your writing project is keeping track of the qualitative progress of your work. With *novelibre* you can break this down to the section level using the *section completion status* and section notes.
- *novelibre* offers a limited number of options for highlighting text.
- Comments, footnotes and endnotes that you insert with *Writer* are not lost.
- Language assignments for the spell checker in *Writer* are not lost.
- So that you don't get confused, *novelibre* can lock the project against changes as long as you are working with OpenOffice or LibreOffice.

4.1 The Book hierarchy

4.1.1 Parts

A novel is expected to be divided into chapters and sections. Parts are optional; technically they are first level chapters. However, in the *novelibre* project tree they are on the same level as the chapters, but they produce a heading one level above. Thus, parts are mainly for inserting first level headings between the chapters, if needed.

Hint

You can convert chapters into parts and vice versa by simply changing the level.

Note

A predecessor of *novelibre* was novelyst. There, the parts were on a higher hierarchy level in the project tree than the chapters, as it corresponds to logical perception. It was therefore possible to move parts together with their subordinate chapters, or to mark entire parts as "Unused". In practice, however, this proved to be cumbersome. I find it easier to move only the part boundaries and leave the chapter order unchanged when defining parts.

4.1.2 Chapters

A *novelibre* project must at least have one chapter. In the exported documents, regular chapters have a second level heading.

For *novelibre*, the chapters only serve as containers for sections to which the actual dramaturgical function is assigned. This is why there are only a few chapter properties to be set.

4.1.3 Sections

All body text of a novel in *novelibre* belongs to sections. Sections can be scenes, pieces of exposition, descriptions, narrative summaries—it is entirely up to you how you divide your text into sections. There is a variety of metadata for sections for your free use.

In the text body of the exported documents, sections are separated by section dividers by default, like so:

* * *

However, if you need more fragmented sections when plotting and organizing than the reader should see later, you can also append sections to each other as new paragraphs with no section divider inbetween.

4.2 Part/chapter/section types

Each part, chapter, and section is of a type that can be changed via context menu or Part/Chapter/Section menu. The type can be *Normal* or *Unused*.

Normal

- "Normal" type parts, chapters, and sections are counted. The totals are displayed in the status bar.
- "Normal" type sections are exported to the manuscript and included in the word count.
- "Normal" type parts and chapters can have subelements of each type.
- "Normal" type tree elements are color coded according to the coloring mode settings.

Unused

You can mark parts, chapters, and sections as unused to exclude them from word count totals and export.

- The subelements of unused parts and chapters are unused as well.
- If you mark a section "Unused", its properties are preserved.
- Unused tree elements are displayed in gray.

4.3 Section completion status

You can assign a status to each "Normal" type section via context menu or Section menu. You can choose between *Outline*, *Draft*, *1st Edit*, *2nd Edit*, and *Done*.

- You can choose a coloring mode to display sections in different colors depending on their completion status.
- Optionally, you can declare one of the status to be the current work phase, and choose a coloring mode that highlights sections that are behind schedule.
- Newly created sections are set to "Outline" by default.
- Word counts by status appear in the Book properties.

Hint

The "sticky" section notes are intended for more detailed information on what still needs to be done for a section.

4.4 Characters and story world

You can define characters, locations, and items, and you can relate them to sections to keep track of their place in the story. There is also some metadata stored with *novelibre*, mainly as a quick reference that might come in handy when writing or editing.

Note

novelibre is not meant as a tool for extensive world building. For this, there is a plethora of dedicated applications, online and offline wikis, and notetaking software. However, *novelibre* offers the option of linking images and files with the characters, locations, and items to facilitate access if your external application allows this.

The nv_zim plugin connects the writing project with a **Zim Desktop Wiki**. This allows the elements of the narrative world to be linked to corresponding wiki pages.

Important

If you want to assign **viewpoint characters** to your sections, you first have to create the characters that come into question.

4.5 Formatting text

It is assumed that very few types of text markup are needed for a novel text. When importing from ODT, *novelibre* supports the following formats:

- *Emphasized* style or italics.
- *Strongly emphasized* style or bold.
- *Quotations* (paragraph visually distinguished from body text).
- *Unordered list item* (indented paragraph with a bullet).

4.6 Comments, footnotes, endnotes

ODT comments, footnotes, and endnotes are supported by *novelibre*.

Tip

novelibre has no support for images in the text body. You can instead use comments as placeholders. Replace them with your images (or any other special formatting beyond the capabilities of *novelibre*) at the end, when you prepare your finished novel for publishing.

4.7 About document language handling

ODF documents are generally assigned a language that determines spell checking and country-specific character substitutions. In addition, Office Writer lets you assign text passages to languages other than the document language to mark foreign language usage or to suspend spell checking.

Document overall
The project language (Language code acc. to ISO 639-1 and country code acc. to ISO 3166-2) can be set in the **Book** settings (right pane) under Document language.

Text passages in sections
Paragraph-wise or inline text markup for other languages is supported by *novelibre*.

4.8 Project lock

When exporting a document that can be edited outsides *novelibre*, the project can be automatically locked in order to prevent confusion. This behavior depends on the Export settings.

> **Important**
>
> The project can only be locked if all changes are saved.

In locked state, the project cannot be modified via the user interface. The footer bar is then displayed in reversed colors, the menu entries for changing data or exporting other documents are greyed out, and the widgets in the *Properties* view are disabled.

The project lock state is persistent. This is achieved by automatically creating a lock file named `.LOCK.<project name>.novx#`. If you delete this file while *novelibre* is not running, the project will be unlocked upon next start.

Usually, the project is automatically unlocked after reimporting the externally edited document.

> **Hint**
>
> The project lock is nothing more than a strong reminder. You can unlock the project at any time at your own risk.
>
> You also can manually lock the project, if necessary. The toolbar button toggles the locking state.

CHAPTER

FIVE

SAVING DATA

novelibre saves the entire novel text as well as all metadata in a single text file with the file extension `.novx`. The text and spreadsheet documents created in the work process are considered temporary files, as their contents can be restored from the corresponding *novx* project file as long as it is kept up to date by timely reimport. So if a specific editing status is to be archived, this one project file is sufficient. However, there may also be additional files such as timelines or a project wiki.

5.1 Change notification

If you change the project during a *novelibre* session, the color of the footer bar changes to goldenrod to show that there are unsaved changes. This change notification is retained until you save the project or restore an earlier editing status.

> **Hint**
>
> For technical reasons, the change notification is retained even if you undo all changes. It therefore does not actually show a changed editing status, but that changes were made since last save.

To discard all changes since the last save, you can restore the last saved status via the Reload menu command.

5.2 Backup files

novelibre is designed to secure its data as well as possible. The current files are neither overwritten nor completely deleted, but backup copies with the extension `.bak` are created. In this way, the penultimate editing status is still available and can even be restored via the Restore backup menu command.

> **Hint**
>
> *novelibre* creates such *bak* backup copies not only for *novx* files, but also for the temporary text and spreadsheet documents and for files that are e.g. synchronized via plugins, such as timelines.

Optionally, you can also make *novelibre* create a copy of the project file in a custom backup directory each time it is saved. You should not work in this backup directory, which is why the backup copies are given a file name suffix that you must remove manually when restoring.

5.3 Remarks on the file format

novx files are text files that are human-readable and can in principle be displayed and edited with any text editor. The text and data are structured using XML tags making the file understandable for computers.

The definition of the *novx* XML format can be found here:

https://peter88213.github.io/novxlib-docs/

The information is intended for computer experts who are interested in using the various standard techniques for reading and processing XML files. As a novelist and regular user, you don't have to worry about any of this. However, you can relax in the knowledge that there are no secrets about the storage of your work results.

Anyway, there is one aspect for you to consider, namely the file version. It can happen that *novelibre* is extended by features that make it necessary to extend the *novx* file format as well. This is then noted in the changelog. In such cases, the version number of the *novx* file format is incremented. This version number is stored in the *novx* file and is checked by *novelibre* each time a project is opened. If *novelibre* encounters a file version that was created with a newer program version, this means that this project could contain information that the currently running program does not know and that could therefore be lost when it is saved again. For this reason, *novelibre* will not open such a file and will display a corresponding error message in the status bar.

Important

To avoid such problems, simply make sure that, if you are working on several computers, you have the same program version of *novelibre* installed everywhere. Preferably the latest release.

CHAPTER

SIX

GETTING STARTED

The following are different ways of starting with *novelibre*. If you are starting a new novel project "from scratch", you can create it with *novelibre* and build it up step by step from there. If you have already started a work and the manuscript is available as a *Writer* document, you can import it after appropriate preparation, and *novelibre* will automatically create the chapter and section structure. You can also have *novelibre* import an outline with the summaries of planned chapters or sections.

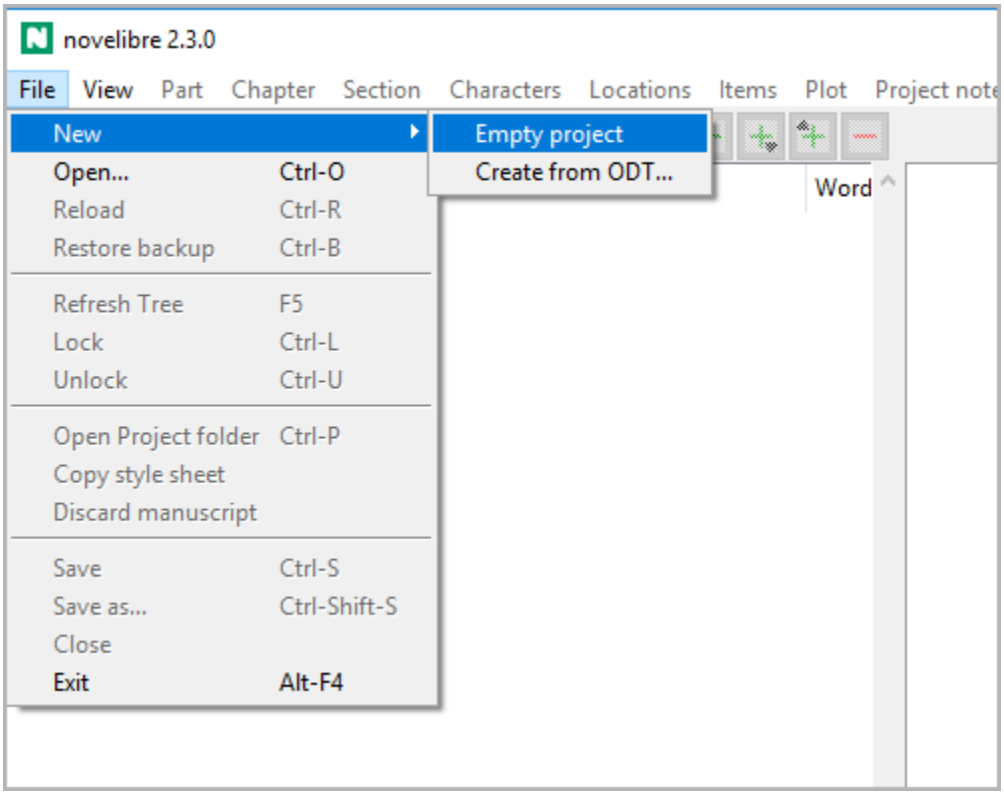
Hint

All of this is also available in the same or similar form in other writing programs. Alternatively, you can also create your novel outline as a timeline using programs such as Timeline or *Aeon Timeline 2*, or as a mind map with Scapple. Using the corresponding plugins or tools, you get a *novelibre* project to work on.

6.1 Starting from scratch

If you start *novelibre* by dragging a *.novx* file onto the icon, that project will be opened. Otherwise, the project from the last session will be automatically reopened, if there is one.

Let's assume that neither is the case, for example when the program is called up for the very first time after installation. Let's also assume that we have not yet made any preparations, i.e. we have neither a Work-in-progress nor an outline of any kind. First of all, we create a new empty project with **File > New > Empty project**.



A file selection dialog opens and asks for the file name and location of the new project. Unlike OpenOffice/LibreOffice, the file selection dialog is not preset to a defined document directory. If you enter a file name for your project, make sure you also select the correct project directory.

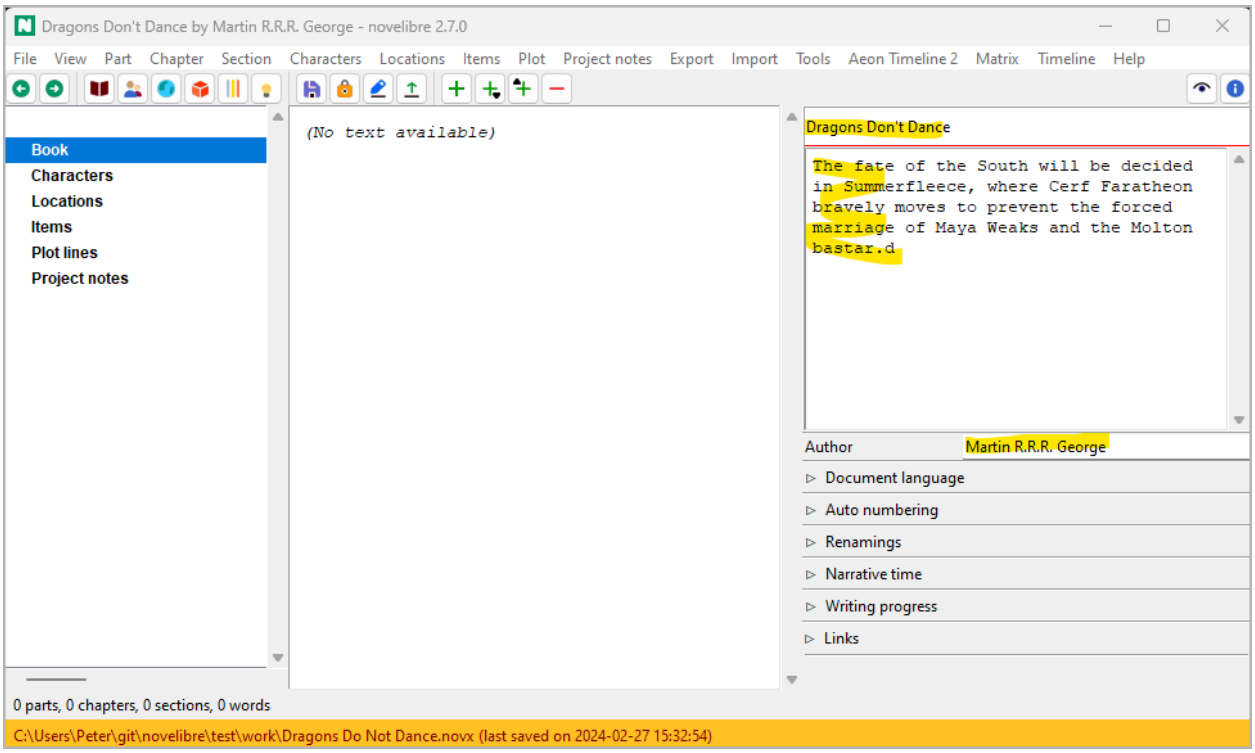
Tip

It is advisable to create a separate folder for the project, as all exported documents are also stored here. This also includes auxiliary files such as timelines or project-related configuration files for tools and plugins.

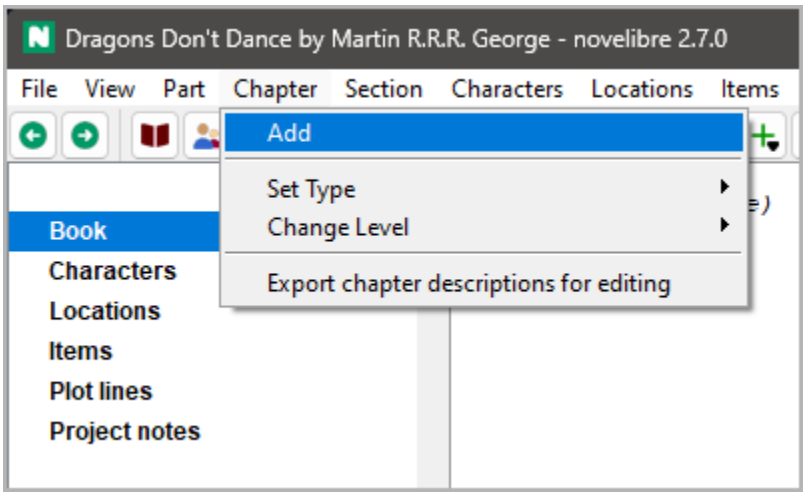
Important

Please make sure that your new project is not in the installation directory.

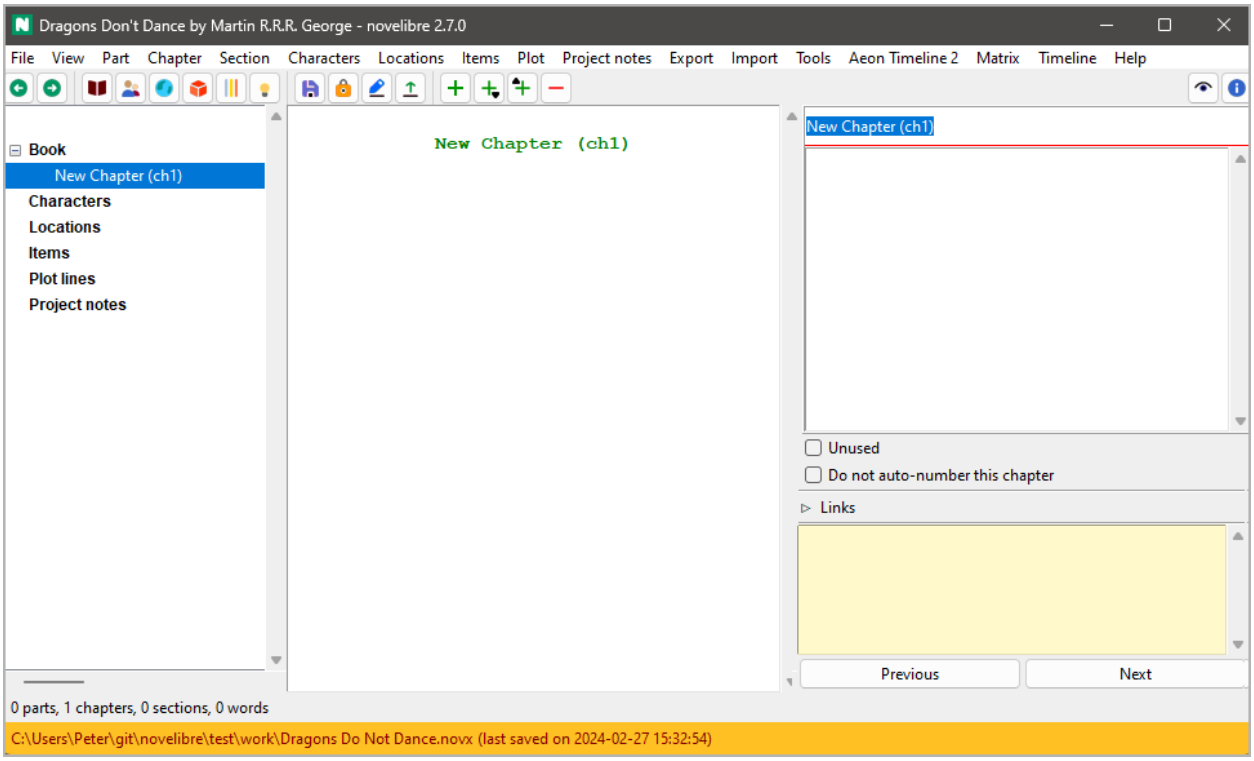
It is not mandatory, but we should then enter a title and the author's name. Perhaps also a description of our idea. To get started right away, we will postpone the remaining project settings until later.



We need at least one section in order to get space to begin writing. And this must belong to a chapter. So we now create the first chapter with **Chapter > Add**.



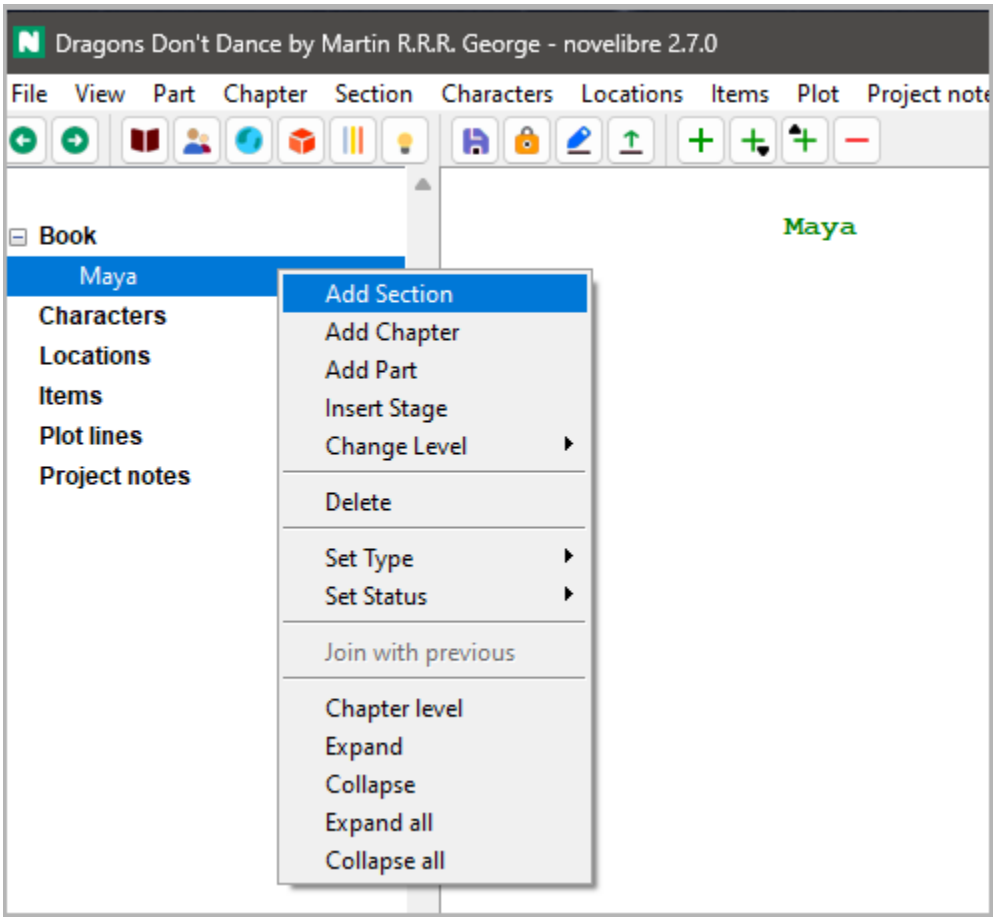
After the chapter is created, *novelibre* sets the focus on the chapter title entry at the top of the right pane. Let's overwrite the default title.



Hint

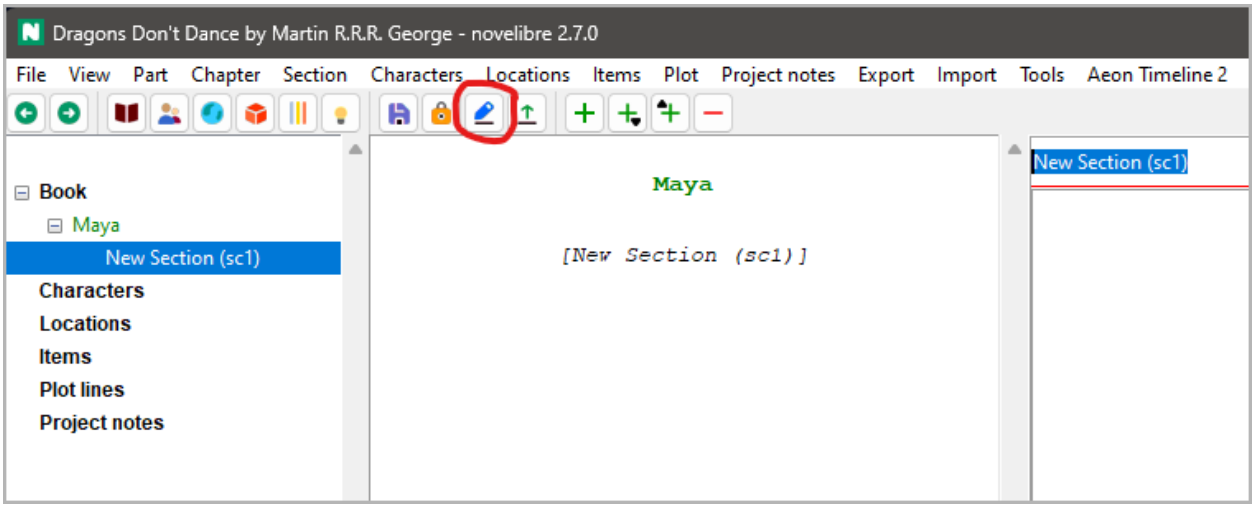
If you decide to have *novelibre* auto-number the chapters, you can skip this and keep the default chapter title.

There are several ways to add a section now. In this example, we right-click on the chapter, and select **Add section**.

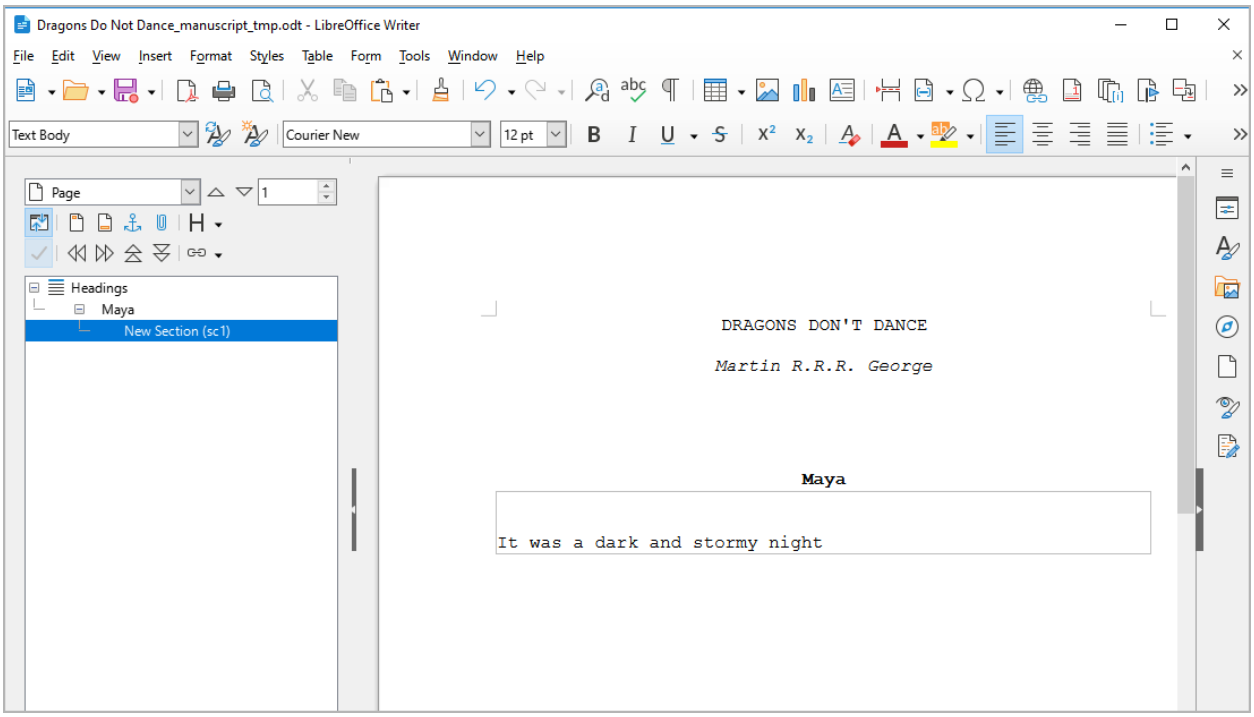


6.1.1 Starting the manuscript immediately

As soon as the new section appears in the tree view, we can export a manuscript. Just click on the toolbar icon.



Done! *Writer* should now appear with the manuscript open. Just start writing your novel within the text boundary.



We can now continue working with *Writer* as described on the next page, creating new sections and chapters as we write.

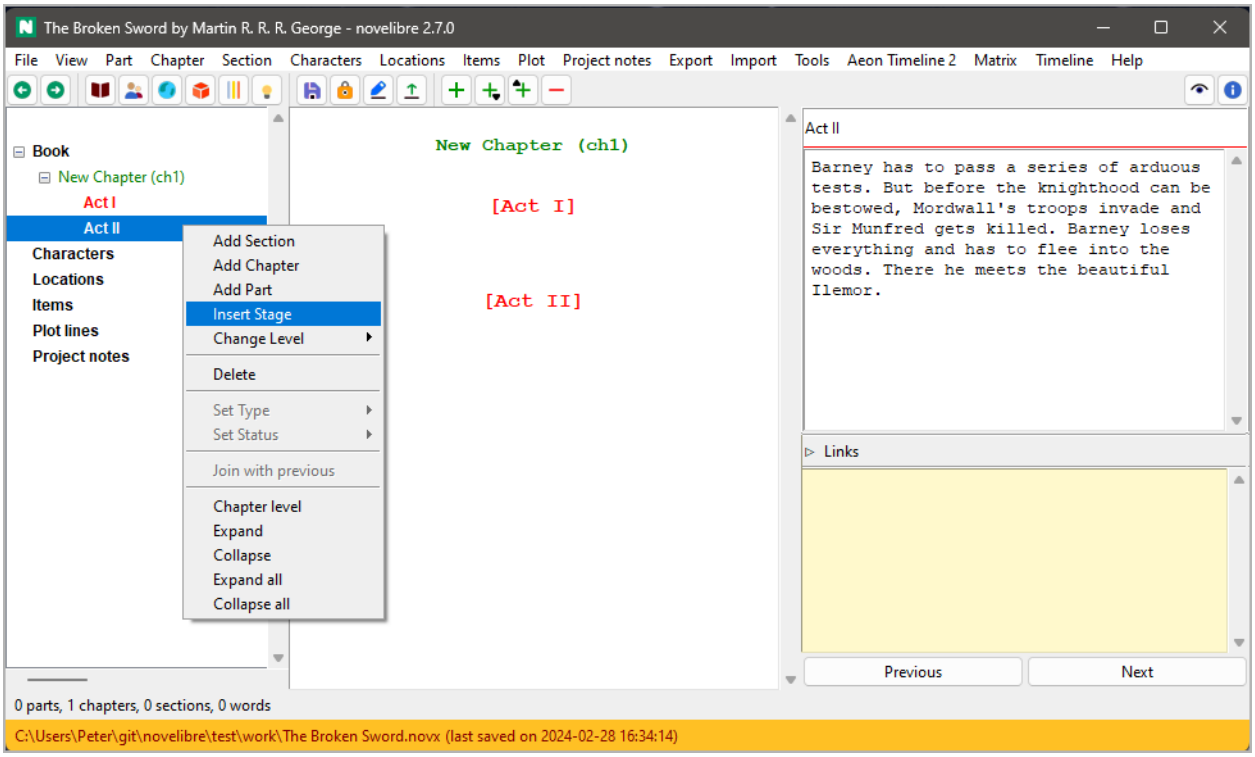
> **Tip**
>
> You can now work on the manuscript document "on the seat of your pants" until it makes sense for you to transfer the whole thing back to *novelibre* in order to create an overview and set up your project organization there.
>
> However, I recommend doing this at least daily at the end of your writing session and exporting a new manuscript document the next day. Then you won't get behind with entering the section titles and content descriptions, and you will get your chapters numbered, if desired. In addition, *novelibre* then saves entries in the daily word count log.

6.1.2 Creating a chapter structure

If you prefer to make a plan first before you start writing, *novelibre* is the right tool for you. Then you don't start *Writer* with an empty manuscript, but first create a framework of empty chapters for which you enter content information. Or you can leave it at one chapter for the time being and create empty sections in it, which you can later distribute to chapters. The results of this preliminary work can be exported as text documents in the form of synopses, e.g on chapter or section level.

6.1.3 Creating a dramatic structure

However, you can also start on a more abstract level and first create and describe stages like acts or steps in order to later insert the sections as scenes. For this, you first create at least one chapter. Then create your stages.



The system is described on the Plotting with novelibre page. There you also can learn how to set up multiple strands or character arcs.

> **Tip**
>
> With the nv_templates plugin you can have *novelibre* set up your new project with a pre-made structure like the "Three Act Model" or "Save The Cat".

6.1.4 Creating a plot grid

If you want to outline your novel using a plot grid, you can do this with *novelibre*:

1. Create an empty new project as described above.
2. Add a single chapter.
3. Select this chapter, then add multiple sections.
4. If you need a number of new sections above the limit, repeat step 3. However, it is recommended to start with a few sections that are easier to distribute to the chapters to be created later. You can extend the plot grid over time.
5. Create the plot lines you need.
6. Export a plot grid and fill the table cells.
7. Import the plot grid.
8. Add more chapters and move the sections to them.

6.2 Starting with a Work-in-progress

Let's assume that you have already written an extensive novel manuscript with *Writer* and now want to continue with *novelibre*. In this case you first make sure to set it up in a way, *novelibre* can recognize its parts, chapters, and sections.

Tip

It is advisable to create a separate folder for the project and move your manuscript there before importing it with *novelibre*.

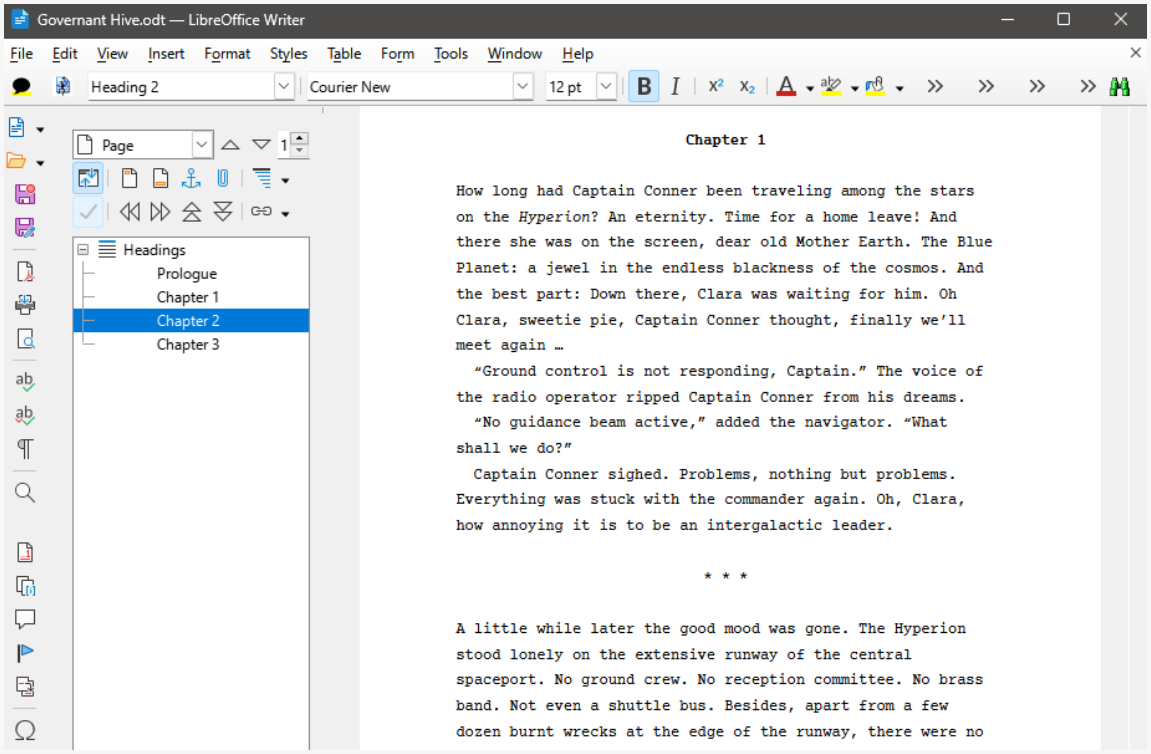
Important

How to set up a Work-in-progress for import

A Work-in-progress must not have any third level heading.

- *Heading 1* → Part title.
- *Heading 2* → Chapter title.
- * * * → Section divider (not needed for the first section in a chapter).
- All other text is considered section content.

The following picture shows a work-in-progress example. Note the blanks between the asterisks of the section divider. It is not necessary to center the section dividers.



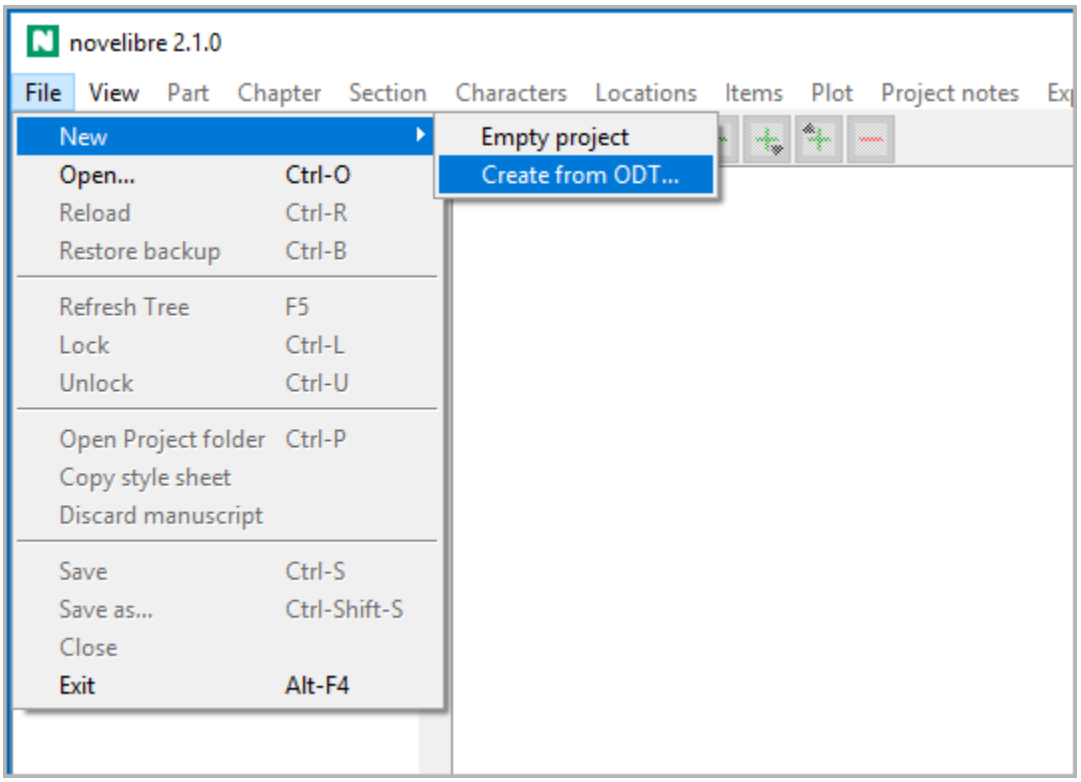
Caution

Formatting that is not supported with novelibre is lost. The same applies to images. So if your work depends on a sophisticated layout that is beyond *novelibre's* capabilities, consider using comments as reminders as you write. That will help you doing the special formatting at the end, when you prepare the finished novel for publication. If this is not enough, *novelibre* may not be the right tool for you.

Tip

The easiest way to create the right section dividers is by using a macro that comes with the novelibre-tools extension.

When your manuscript is ready, create your new project with **File > New > Create from ODT…**.



A file selection dialog opens and asks for the *ODT* document. The new project will be created in the same directory and named after the manuscript file, but with the *.novx* extension.

Caution

Once your novel is imported into *novelibre*, your initial *ODT* document is no longer needed. So if you want to keep it, you best move it elsewhere, so that it is not overwritten by an exported document later on.

Tip

After importing an extensive piece of work, you may have a whole lot of sections that need to be named and described. A plot grid might be a great help for doing this.

6.3 Starting with an outline

Instead of a Work-in-progress, you also can import an outline made with *Writer* into *novelibre* to get a novel project with empty, but named and described chapters and sections. At first glance, an outline looks the same as a Work-in-progress, but it has third level headings for the sections, indicating their titles. If *novelibre* finds third-level headings, it considers all body text to be description. In this case, formatting doesn't matter.

Tip

It is advisable to create a separate folder for the project and move your outline there before importing it with *novelibre*.

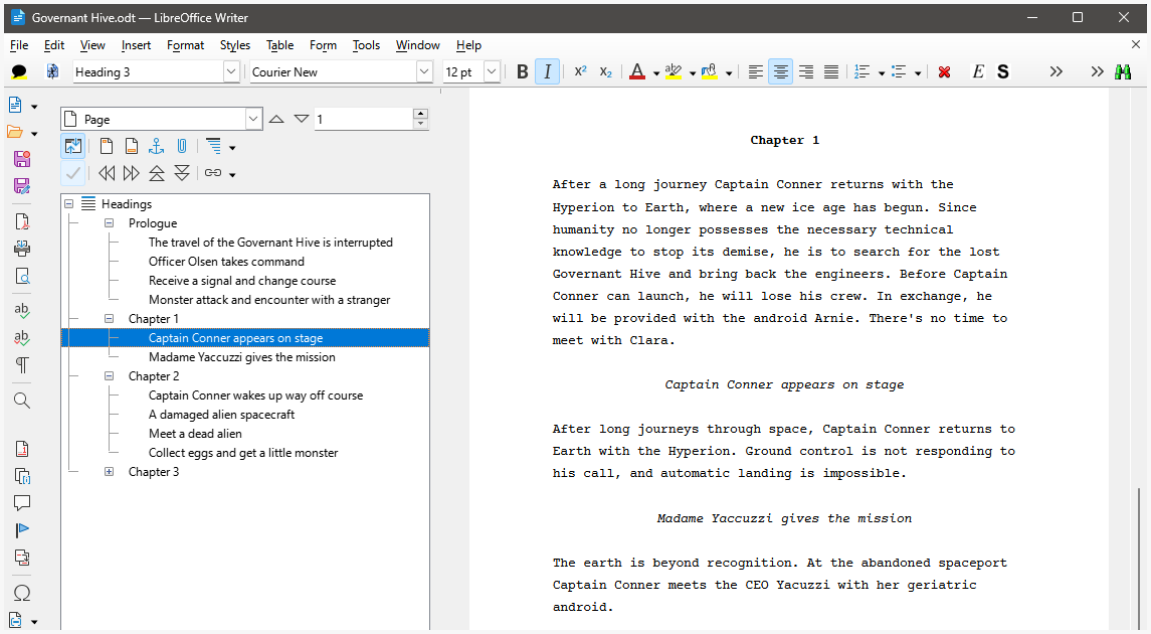
Important

How to set up an outline for import

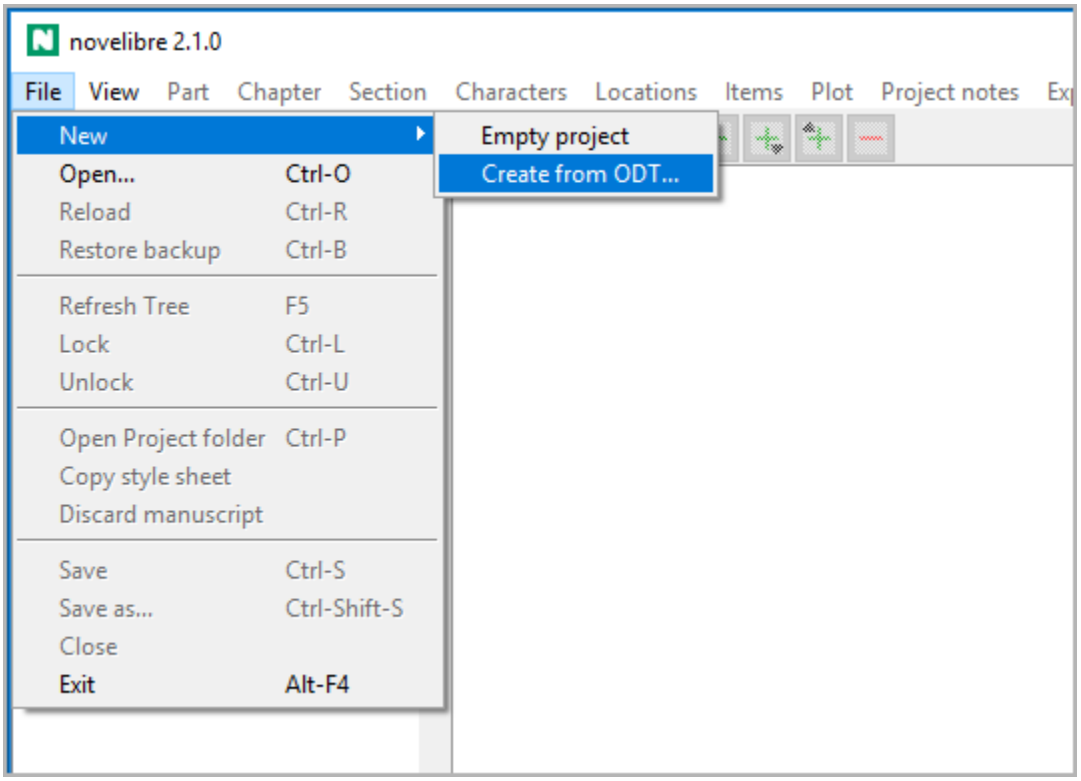
An outline has at least one third level heading.

- *Heading 1* → Part title.
- *Heading 2* → Chapter title.
- *Heading 3* → Section title.
- All other text is considered to be chapter/section description.

The following picture shows an outline example. The body text just below the chapter heading is the chapter description; the body text just below the section heading is the section description. However, the descriptions are optional.



When your outline is ready, create your new project with **File > New > Create from ODT…**.



A file selection dialog opens and asks for the *ODT* document. The new project will be created in the same directory and named after the outline file, but with the *.novx* extension.

Caution

Once your outline is imported into *novelibre*, your initial *ODT* document is no longer needed. So if you want to keep it, you best move it elsewhere, so that it is not overwritten by an exported document later on.

You can export and import the current outline at any time as "Descriptions" separated by parts, chapters and sections.

CHAPTER

SEVEN

WRITING THE MANUSCRIPT

7.1 Starting Writer as text editor

Note

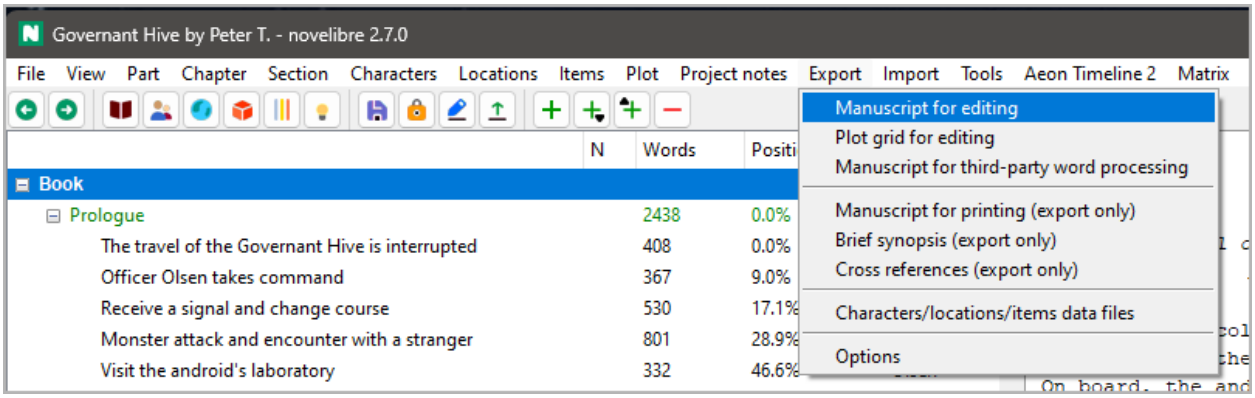
The following example describes the manuscript editing workflow with LibreOffice. The same applies to OpenOffice.

Other word processing programs that claim to support the *ODT* file format are generally not recommended.

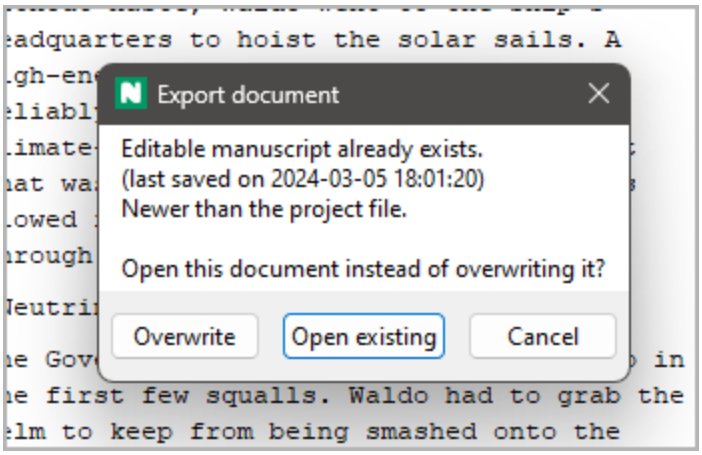
As soon as your novel project has at least one section, you can start writing. For this, you save your project and export your novel to the *Writer* word processor either with **Export > Manuscript for editing**, or by clicking on the toolbar icon.

Hint

- If you use the menu command, you can have *novelibre* create a manuscript, and ask whether it should be opened with *Writer*.
- If you click on the toolbar icon, *Writer* will be launched immediately after export.



If you have done this before and there is still a manuscript document from the previous writing session, you will now be asked whether you want to continue working on this document. If this is the case, answer “Open existing”.

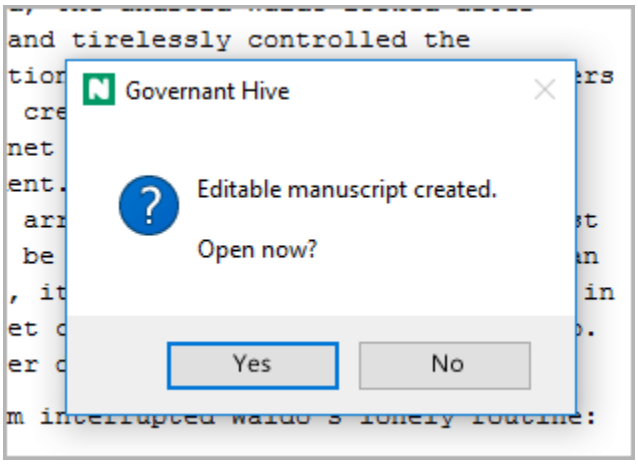


If you answer "Overwrite", *novelibre* creates a new manuscript document. "Cancel" aborts the export process and lets you return to the main window.

Hint

novelibre checks whether an existing manuscript is newer or older than the open project, and suggests a choice by activating the appropriate button. You can accept it by hitting the `Enter` key. If your choice follows the suggestion, you see a message in green at the status bar. Otherwise, the message is displayed in yellow, just as a reminder.

If you started the export using the **Export** menu command, you may be asked whether you want to open the newly created document, depending of your Export settings.



If you answer "yes", *Writer* will be launched with the manuscript document. Otherwise, the document is just kept for future use.

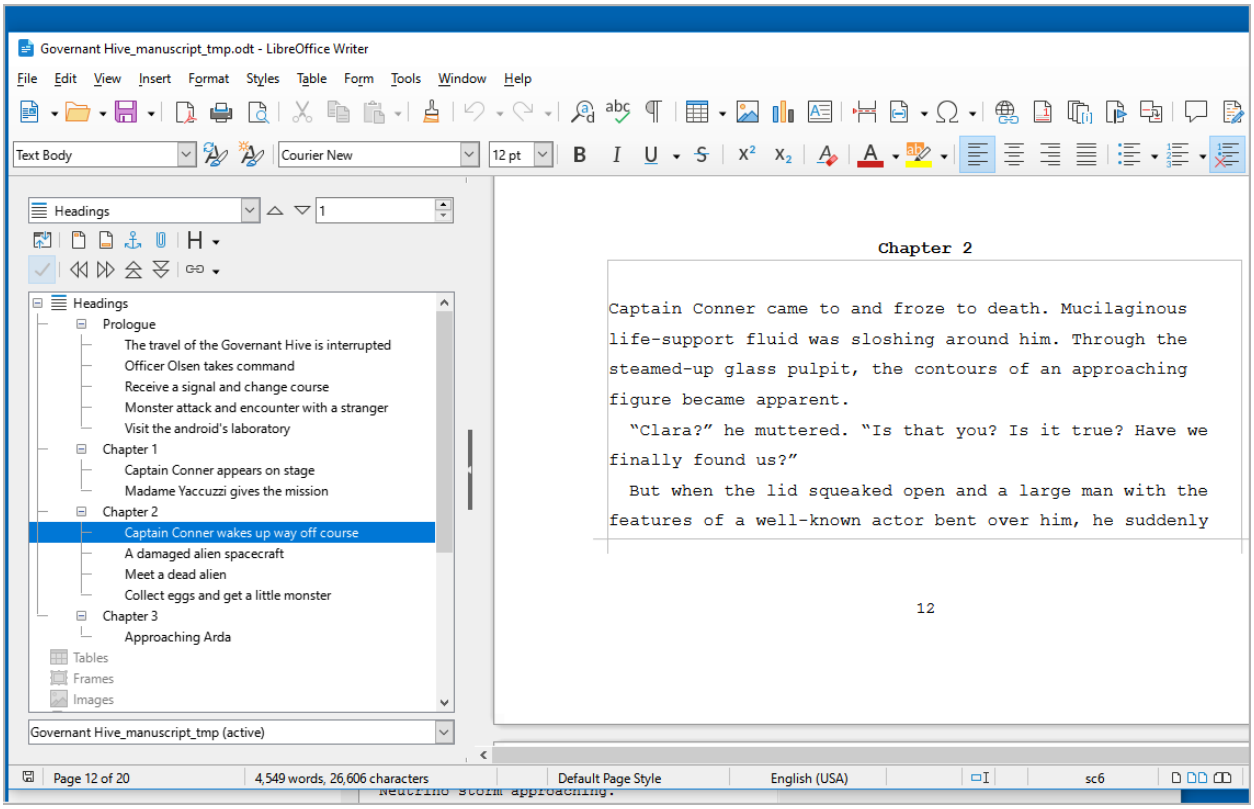
Depending on your Export settings, *novelibre* now may lock the project, so that it can't be accidentally modified with *novelibre* while worked on in *Writer*.

Note

novelibre starts your standard application for files with the *.odt* extension. Usually, the setting is made by LibreOffice or OpenOffice during installation.

After you change to *Writer*, you see the whole novel in a layout that is similar to the "standard manuscript format". The *Navigator* (open with F5) shows the chapter and section titles in the *Headings* area. Double click on a heading to move the cursor to that location. You can now write within the frames that define the sections.

The following picture shows a LibreOffice Writer screenshot. Note that the text boundaries are made visible here, which is highly recommended.



Note

The section titles displayed in the Navigator are invisible in the workspace so that they do not disrupt the flow of writing, and the impression of an original manuscript page is retained.

7.2 Writing changes back to novelibre

At the end of the writing session, save the changes, exit the *Writer* word processor, and return to *novelibre*. Simply click on the toolbar icon, and your latest changes will appear.

Note

The toolbar icon mentioned above is only for the manuscript. If you want to apply changes made in other documents like character sheets or synopses, use the Import menu.

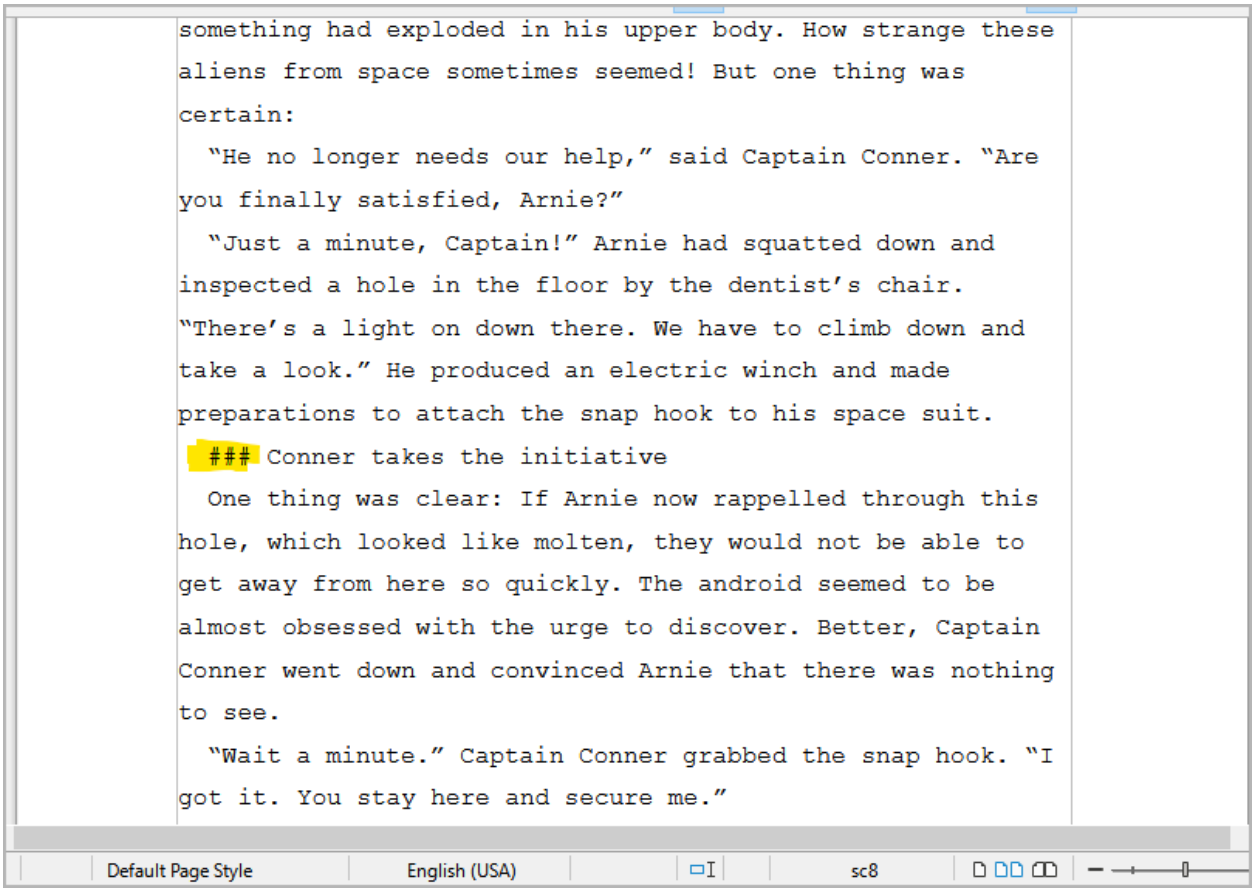
7.3 Creating new sections with Writer

If you need a new section while writing, you don't have to switch to *novelibre*. Simply start a new line with a special marker `###`. Optionally, you can add a section title, and, separated by `|`, a section description. All other metadata is intended to be entered in *novelibre* later.

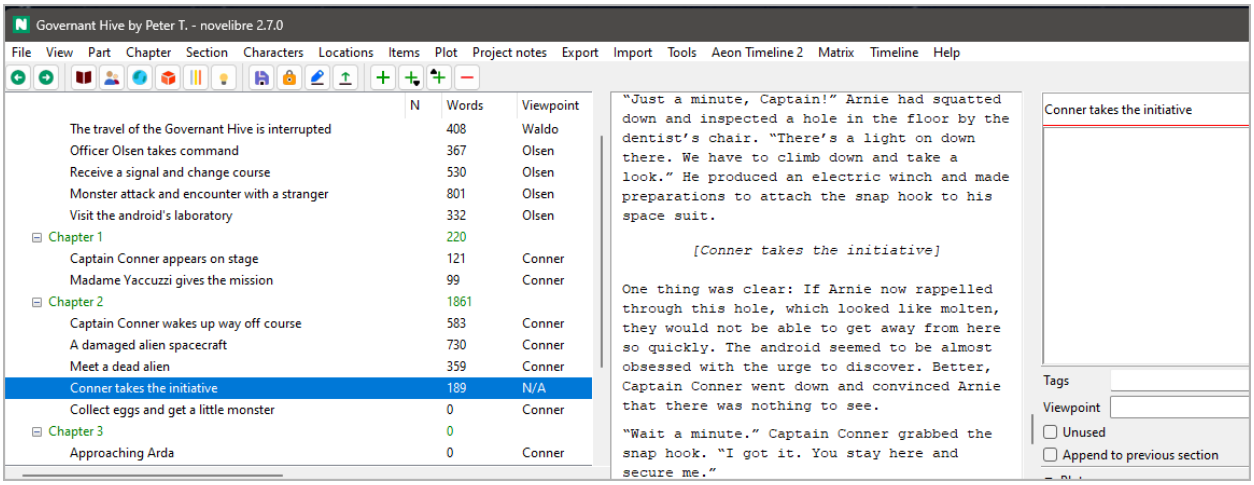
> **Tip**
>
> You can use `####` to create an appended section.

The following example shows how to split an existing section:

The following picture shows a LibreOffice Writer screenshot. Notice the highlighted section marker



Back in *novelibre*, you see the new section. It has got a title, but no other metadata.



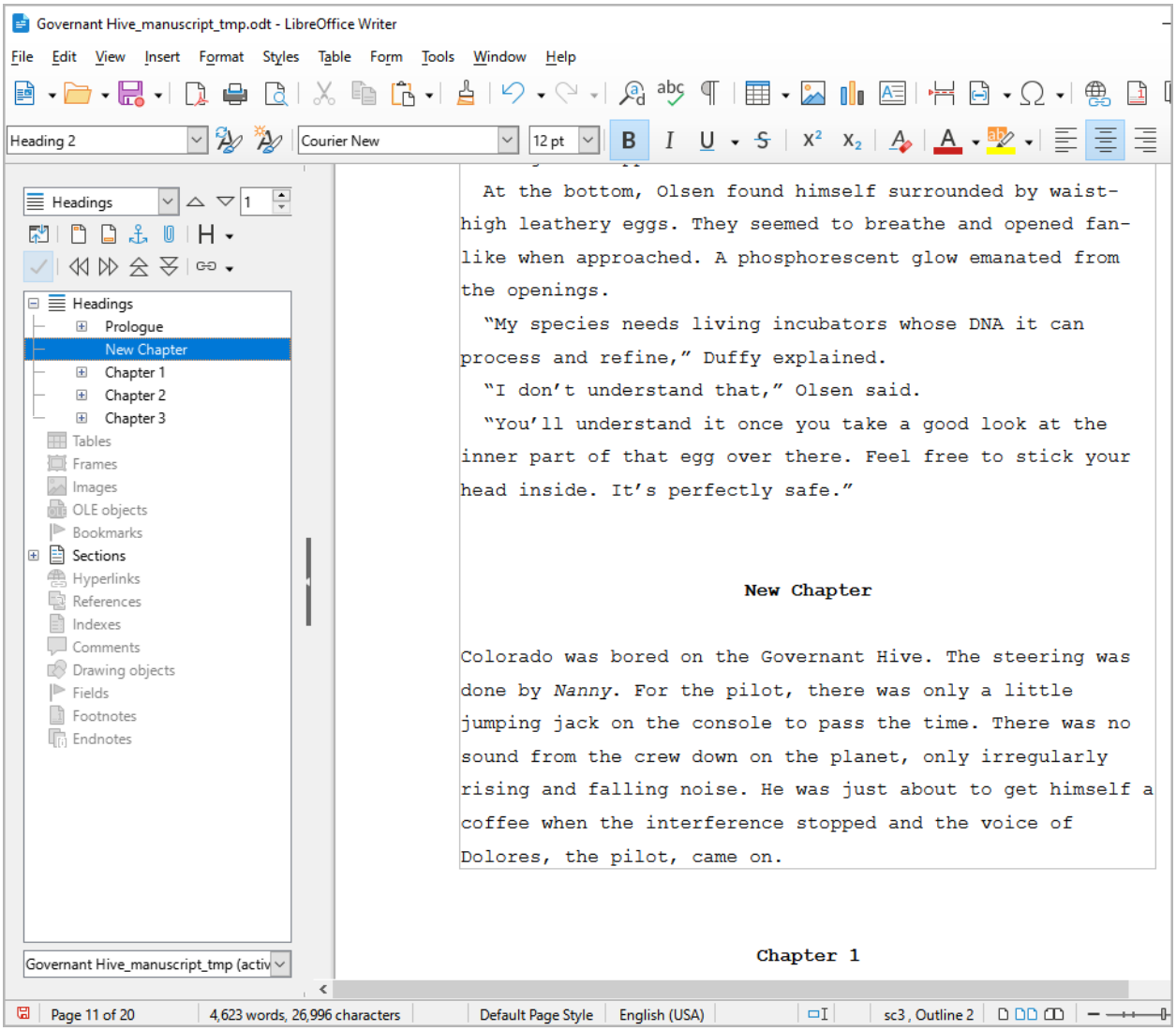
Notice the selected new section in the screenshot.

7.4 Creating new chapters with Writer

If you need a new chapter while writing, you don't have to switch to *novelibre*. Simply assign a new line *within the edited section* the **Heading 2** style.

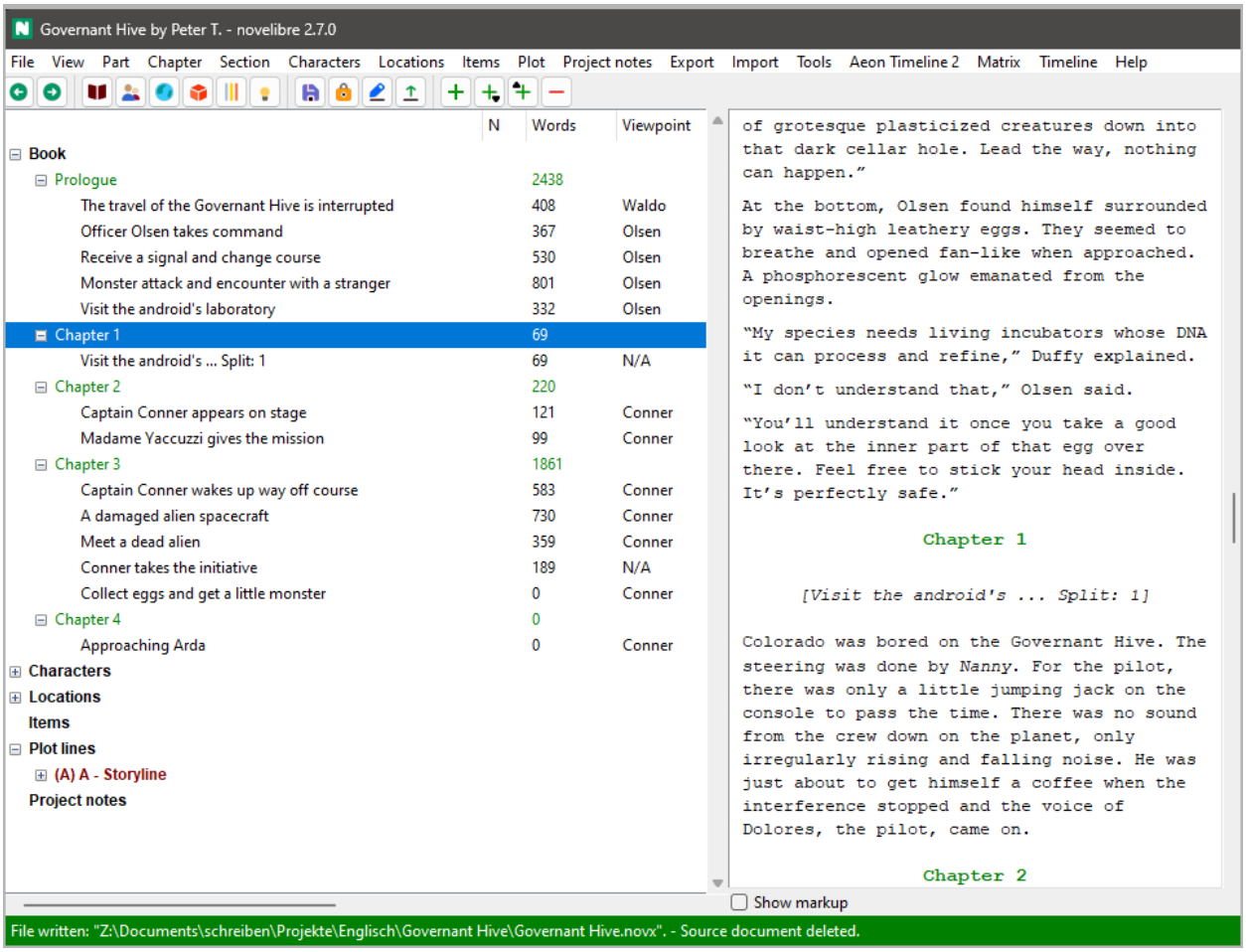
> **Important**
>
> *novelibre* only reimports text within section defining frames. Technically, it always splits sections when creating new chapters or sections from the manuscript.
>
> You also cannot move chapters within *Writer*. If you want to rearrange chapters or sections, do it with *novelibre*.

The following example shows how to add a chapter with *Writer*:



It doesn't matter what the new chapter is titled.

Back in *novelibre*, you see a new chapter and a new section. Since the chapters are auto-numbered in this example project, the new chapter title already fits, while the new section's title should be adjusted manually.


Governant Hive by Peter T. - novelibre 2.7.0
File View Part Chapter Section Characters Locations Items Plot Project notes Export Import Tools Aeon Timeline 2 Matrix Timeline Help
N Words Viewpoint
Book
Prologue 2438
The travel of the Governant Hive is interrupted 408 Waldo
Officer Olsen takes command 367 Olsen
Receive a signal and change course 530 Olsen
Monster attack and encounter with a stranger 801 Olsen
Visit the android's laboratory 332 Olsen
Chapter 1 69
Visit the android's ... Split: 1 69 N/A
Chapter 2 220
Captain Conner appears on stage 121 Conner
Madame Yaccuzzi gives the mission 99 Conner
Chapter 3 1861
Captain Conner wakes up way off course 583 Conner
A damaged alien spacecraft 730 Conner
Meet a dead alien 359 Conner
Conner takes the initiative 189 N/A
Collect eggs and get a little monster 0 Conner
Chapter 4 0
Approaching Arda 0 Conner
Characters
Locations
Items
Plot lines
(A) A - Storyline
Project notes
of grotesque plasticized creatures down into that dark cellar hole. Lead the way, nothing can happen."
At the bottom, Olsen found himself surrounded by waist-high leathery eggs. They seemed to breathe and opened fan-like when approached. A phosphorescent glow emanated from the openings.
"My species needs living incubators whose DNA it can process and refine," Duffy explained.
"I don't understand that," Olsen said.
"You'll understand it once you take a good look at the inner part of that egg over there. Feel free to stick your head inside. It's perfectly safe."
Chapter 1
[Visit the android's ... Split: 1]
Colorado was bored on the Governant Hive. The steering was done by Nanny. For the pilot, there was only a little jumping jack on the console to pass the time. There was no sound from the crew down on the planet, only irregularly rising and falling noise. He was just about to get himself a coffee when the interference stopped and the voice of Dolores, the pilot, came on.
Chapter 2
Show markup
File written: "Z:\Documents\schreiben\Projekte\Englisch\Governant Hive\Governant Hive.novx". - Source document deleted.

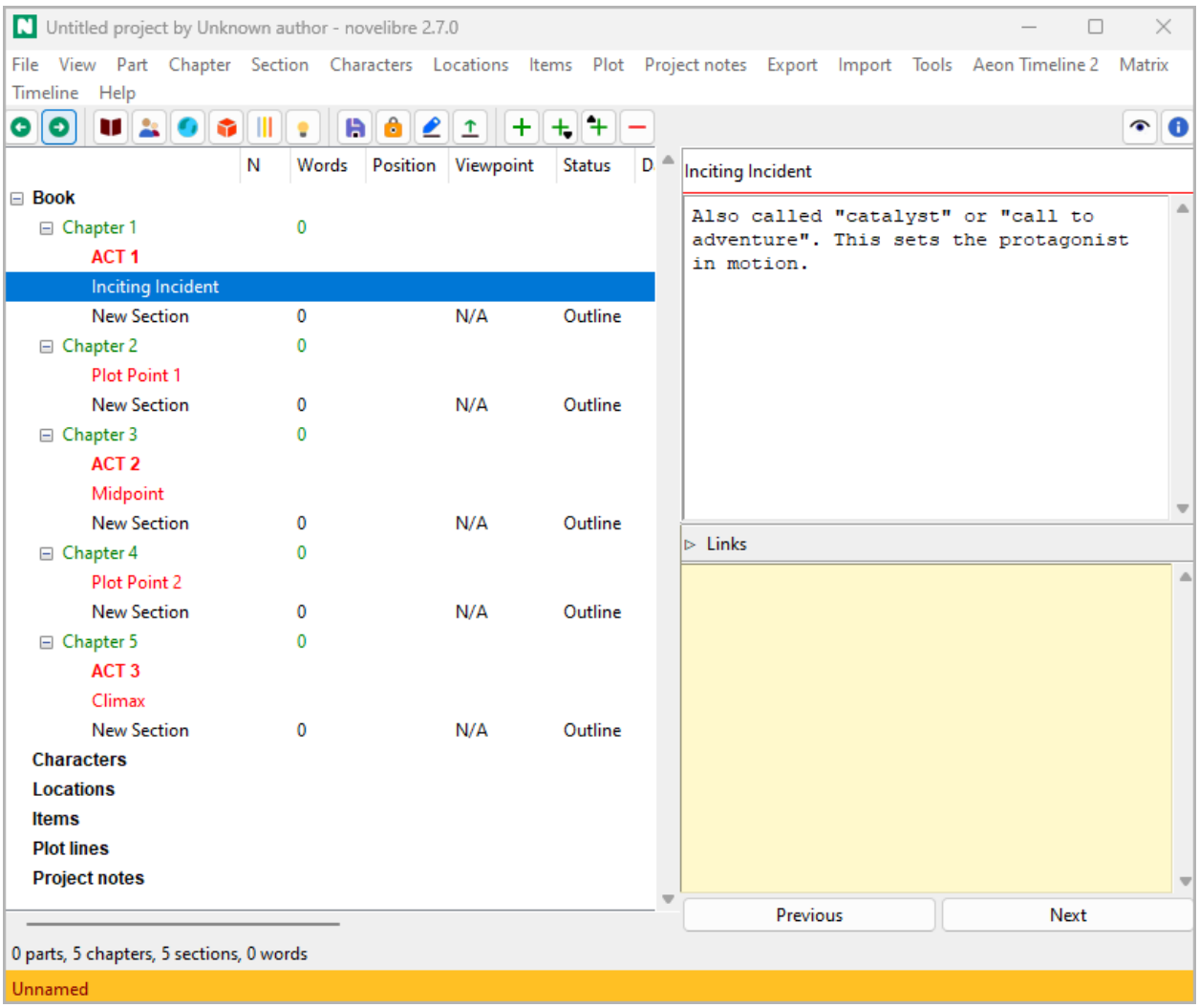
CHAPTER

EIGHT

PLOTTING WITH NOVELIBRE

8.1 Applying a story structure model

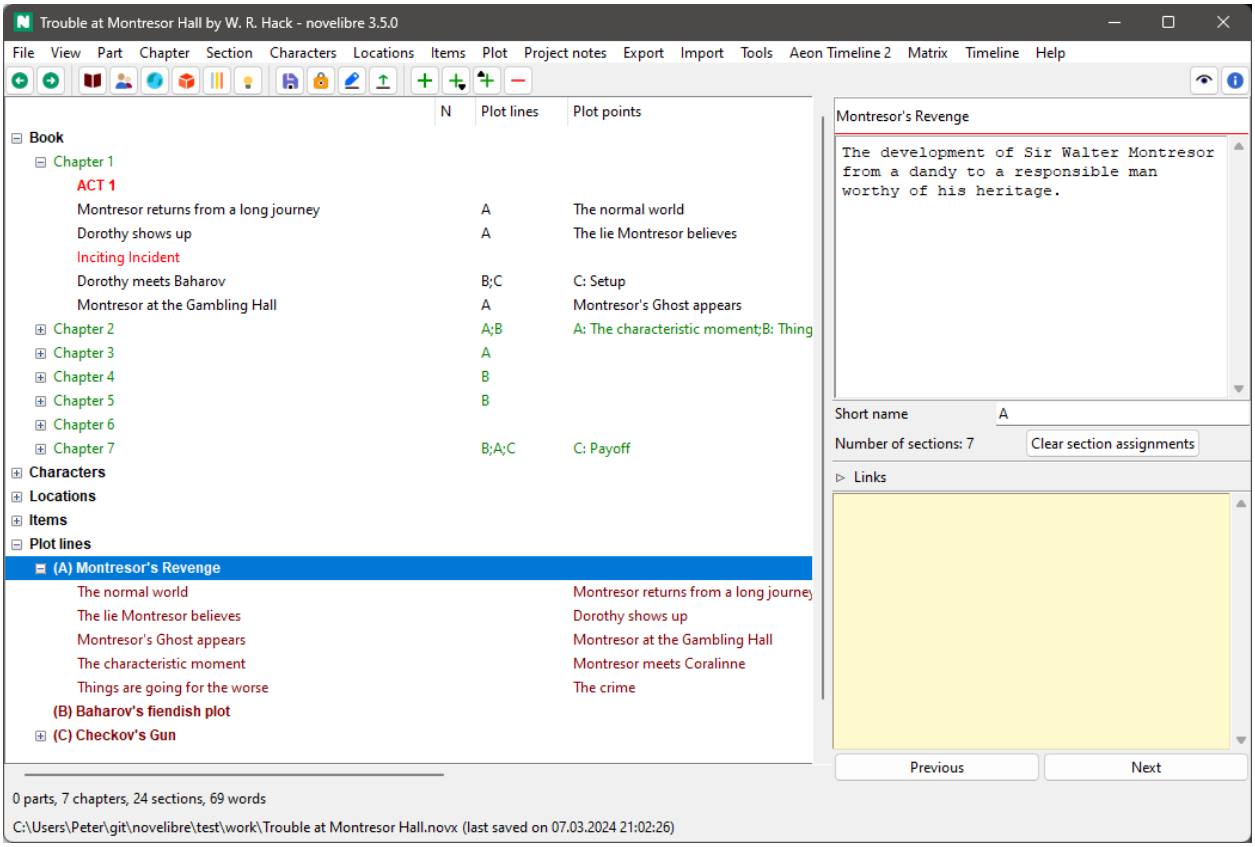
If you want to divide a story into stages according to a structure model (e.g. the *Three Act Model*, or the *Save The Cat* beatsheet), just insert the stages between the regular sections at the beginning of each phase. This gives you color-coded subheadings in the tree view.



With the nv_templates plugin you can load pre-made story structure models from Markdown template files, and you can save the story structure of your project for reuse.

8.2 Defining plot lines

novelibre provides *plot lines* as a powerful and flexible concept for plotting.

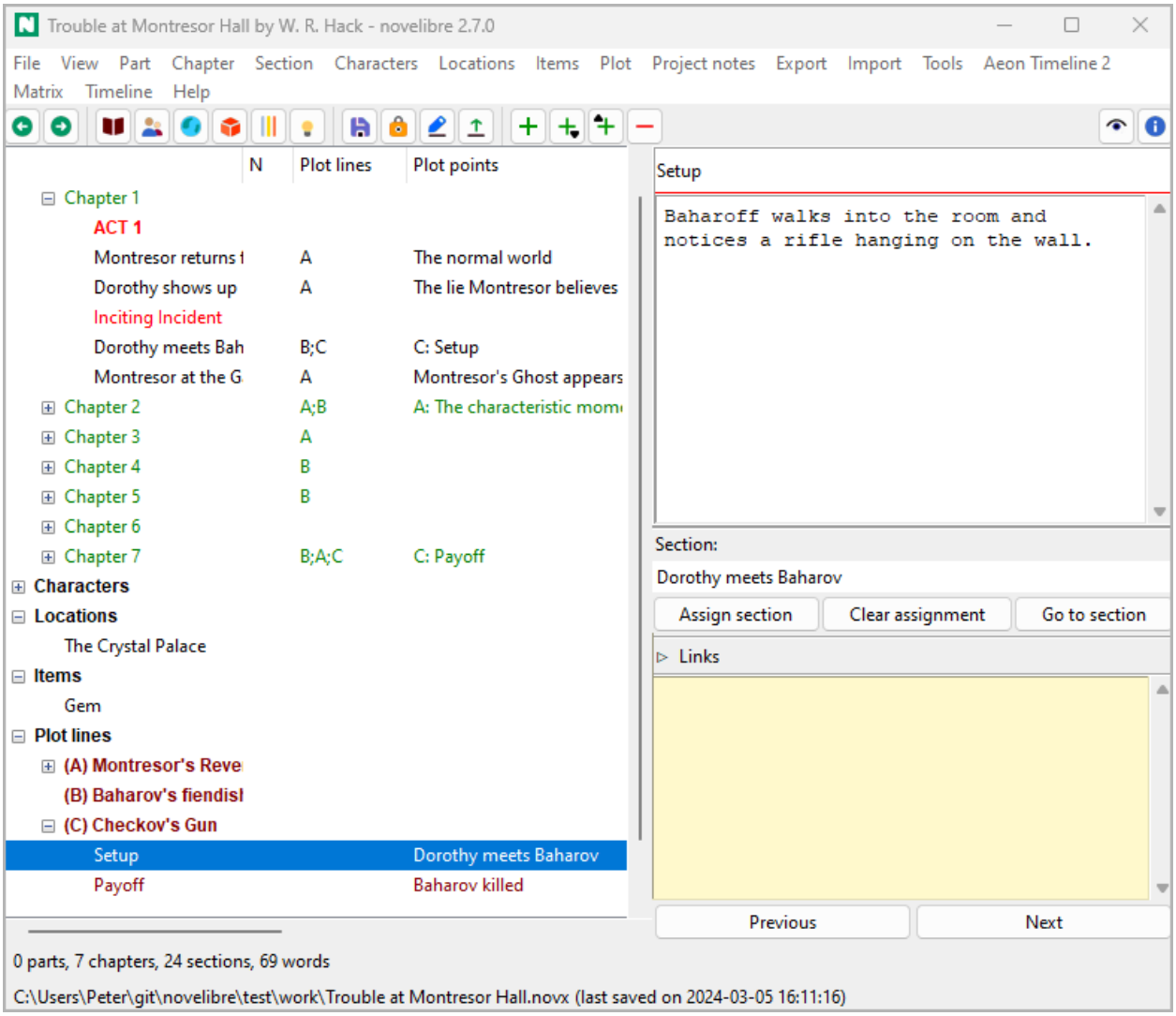


"Plot line" can mean a variety of things: narrative strand, thread, character arc, storyline, subplot, sequence of cause and effect, sequence of setup and payoff, and so on. You can think of a plot line as a line on which plot points are arranged that characterize the progression of the story. These plot points can be assigned to sections to indicate the section's relevance to the plot.

- *novelibre* lets you define any number of plot lines.
- Any number of sections can be assigned to each plot line.
- Any number of plot lines can be assigned to each section.
- Each plot line can contain any number of plot points.
- Each plot point can be assigned to exactly one section.
- Any number of plot points can be assigned to each section.

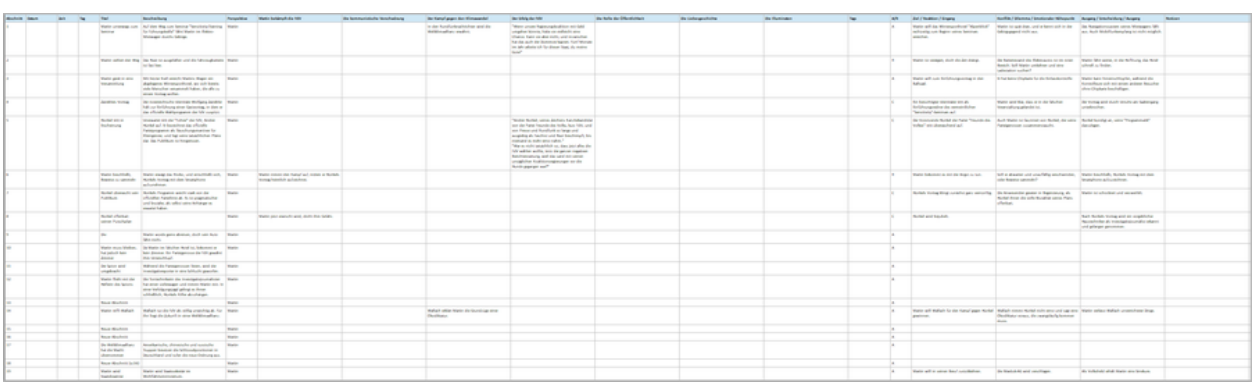
The association of sections and plot points is shown in the "Plot points" column of the tree view.

You can use plot lines to establish named connections between sections, such as *setup* → *payoff*, so you can keep track of this relationship even if the sections are far away from each other.



8.3 Plot grid

The *novelibre* plot grid is a spreadsheet with a row for each section, and a set of plot-relevant section metadata in the columns. The first visible column contains links to the sections in the manuscript. Each plot line has its own column in the plot grid, Where the plot line notes are shown. The plot grid offers you a convenient way to enter the plot line notes by seeing the big pictures of your plot construction.



Hint

You can assign a section to a plot line by entering text in the corresponding *Plot line notes* cell of the plot grid.

CHAPTER

NINE

KEEPING THE METADATA IN SIGHT

During the writing process, it can be useful to keep metadata such as chapter contents, section summaries, character data or location descriptions in sight. With *novelibre* you have various options for this.

9.1 The properties window

The first choice is the properties window. You can drop down the properties you want to edit or view by clicking on the category. Select the element to which the properties relate in the project tree. The properties window can also be detached and placed separatey, e.g. at the edge of the screen.

9.2 Lists in the Web browser

You can display separate lists for characters, locations, items and plot lines in the web browser. In contrast to the properties window, you can see all elements at once, but you cannot edit them.

9.3 Tables

Tables are the classic tool from the time when specialized writing software was not yet widespread. The tables exported by *novelibre* are opened automatically with the *Calc* spreadsheet software. They are—except the section list—editable to be reimported by *novelibre*. The section rows are linked to the sections in the manuscript. Particularly recommended is the plot grid.

The only disadvantage of the tables is that you cannot add new tree elements to *novelibre* with the spreadsheet.

9.4 Description documents

For parts, chapters, sections, characters, locations, items, narrative structure and plot lines, *novelibre* can export text documents that can be edited and reimported. Usually, chapter headings are designed as links, which will take you directly to the relevant place in the manuscript.

9.5 Cross reference

The most powerful tool to create and overview relationships between sections and plot lines, characters, locations and objects with *novelibre*, is the nv_matrix plugin.

It is also possible to export a detailed cross-reference list as a text document containing links to the manuscript and to the description documents.

9.6 Desktop Wiki

The nv_zim plugin can copy a selection of character, location, and item metadata to a project wiki. This can then serve as a worldbuilding reference or "series bible" and is much more powerful for such purposes than *novelibre*. When you create a wiki, it makes sense to keep only the most essential metadata for characters, locations, and items in *novelibre* so that you don't have to maintain this data twice. For example, the characters' date of birth can be helpful for calling up their current age in each section they show up.

CHAPTER

TEN

TAKING NOTES

Organizing a writing project also involves taking notes. *novelibre* supports this on several levels. The bottom level is the continuous text in the manuscript, then come the elements of the *novelibre* project tree, such as chapters, sections, plot lines and characters. The top level is the project itself.

10.1 Comments in the manuscript

While writing the manuscript, you can insert comments into the running text with *Writer*, which then appear as small colored text boxes in the right margin if set accordingly. This is very practical for placeholders or markers, for example. *novelibre* adopts such comments during manuscript import, and the text viewer displays them in color.

10.2 "Sticky notes" for individual elements

When organizing the novel in the *novelibre* workspace, you work with the elements of the project tree. Most of them have a yellow text input field for notes among their properties. If such a field contains text, an "N" appears in the project tree.

Via the *Tools* menu, the "sticky notes" can be displayed in list form in the web browser. You have a limited export option via the download function of the web browser.

10.3 Project notes

For flashes of inspiration, general research results and miscellaneous, *novelibre* offers its own category of project notes. A project note is listed in the project tree and consists of an index card with title and content, as well as an optional collection of links.

The project notes can also be displayed in list form in the web browser. You have a limited export option via the download function of the web browser.

10.4 Project Wiki

If the project notes are not enough for you, you can use the nv_zim plugin to link the writing project to a Zim Desktop Wiki, which offers much more extensive options, from hierarchical pages to to-do lists and a writing journal.

Tip

Wiki pages are text files that can be linked to the project tree elements, i.e. also to the project notes. If the *nv_zim* plugin is installed, *novelibre* recognizes if a linked text file belongs to a Zim wiki and opens such a page with the *Zim* application.

CHAPTER

ELEVEN

WORD COUNT AND WRITING PROGRESS

In *novelibre*, the number of words is used as a metric for the amount of text and the position within the overall text. *novelibre* counts words following the rules of LibreOffice Writer The word totals displayed in *novelibre*, however, only include the contents of the sections. Chapter headings and titles are not taken into account. It is therefore quite possible that the number of words shown in *Writer* may differ from the number of words displayed.

Other quantities such as the number of characters and typewritten pages can be obtained very conveniently in *Writer* using an exported manuscript. This is also helped by the format of the manuscript exported by *novelibre*, which corresponds to the standard manuscript page with 30 lines of 60 characters.

The amount of text written is interesting in two respects. On the one hand, you can monitor your writing progress. For this, you can enter the size of the planned book, or a temporary goal, for instance for NaNoWriMo. If you activate the logging, you can call up the history with the help of the nv_progress plugin. Further you get information on the completion status, taking the sections' status into account. Details can be found in the book properties description.

On the other hand, you have an overview of the balance of the story in terms of chapter length, the distribution of narrative perspectives, or the position of plot points, to name just a few examples. The numbers can be seen in the corresponding columns of the tree view. Those wo like it more comfortable, may want to install the nv_statistics plugin.

CHAPTER

TWELVE

GOING OUTSIDE

If you are working with partners, for example with editors or proofreaders, it may be necessary to exchange versions of the manuscript with each other. Even if you incorporate suggested changes into your manuscript by hand, you can keep the option open to continue working directly with an externally edited document. In this case you may want to export a Manuscript for third-party word processing. This export format has the advantage that you can import it back to *novelibre* even after it has been converted to a foreign file format such as *docx* and converted back to *odt*. Even if your partner also uses LibreOffice or OpenOffice, this format minimizes the risk of accidentally losing the section markers for the import to *novelibre*.

Important

If you want to re-import a revised document to *novelibre*, which has been converted to other document formats in the meantime, make sure that it has the same file name at the end as the original export.

Comments that your partner inserts into the document are retained when the document is imported back to *novelibre*. This should also apply if your partner uses *Word* and you use a reasonably up-to-date version of LibreOffice.

Change tracking information from *Word* should also be retained for LibreOffice. However, you should accept or reject such changes before importing them to *novelibre*, as *novelibre* will accept all changes and delete the markings.

Hint

If your partner has specific wishes regarding the layout of the working manuscript, i.e. wants a certain font, line spacing or margins, you should ideally use a suitable document template before converting the document into the agreed exchange format. However, if your partner makes such changes personally, this will generally not cause any problems.

CHAPTER

THIRTEEN

NARRATIVE TIME

If date and time are of importance in the novel, *novelibre* offers a variety of support for this. If you set up your writing project carefully, you will have useful information at your disposal when writing, from the current day of the week and the phase of the moon to the ages of the characters involved.

You can assign a date, a time, and a duration to each section. The date may be unspecific or specific, where unspecific means the number of days since the start of the story. According to this count, the story begins on day zero. For the specific date, *novelibre* uses the Gregorian calendar. You can only enter positive dates with years between 0001 and 9999.

The names of weekdays and months are given to *novelibre* by the operating system, so the system language is used. By default, dates are output as is usual in the system language. If you do not like this, you can change a Setting to display the date in ISO format, just as you enter it.

Date and time specifications are optional; you can assign each section either a specific date, an unspecific date or no date at all. *novelibre* can convert specific dates into unspecific ones and vice versa, if you enter a reference date for the day zero in the book properties. Even if you don't need specific dates for your story, specifying a reference date might be helpful. Thus, a day of the week can be displayed, and ages can be calculated for related characters. You can also have the moon phase displayed, which is calculated fairly accurately, at least for the 20th and 21st centuries.

By default, you type date, time, and duration in the corresponding entry fields of the Section properties. If the previous section already has a date and time, you can have *novelibre* generate a start date and time witht the click of a button, so that the action of the section immediately follows the action of the previous section. If the subsequent section has a date and time, you can have *novelibre* automatically generate a duration so that the subsequent section follows on seamlessly from the current one.

Even more convenient is the use of dedicated timeline software such as the free Timeline or the commercial *Aeon Timeline 2*. This allows you to treat sections like events and arrange, move, lengthen and shorten them on a timeline. There are plugins for the two software applications mentioned above, which can synchronize the timelines with *novelibre*, create new timelines, and create new novel projects from existing timelines.

If you do not want to use a timeline software, the nv_tlview plugin provides a graphical timeline display for the sections with date and time.

You can also display dated sections in a time table.

CHAPTER

FOURTEEN

MANAGING MULTIPLE BOOKS

If the book projects accumulate over time, the nv_collection plugin may be a useful aid. This allows you to create collections of books, which you can then conveniently open with *novelibre*. With *nv_collection* you can also group the books into series.

14.1 Organizing book series

With a book series, multiple books are sharing their characters and story world. There also can be overarching plot lines. If you want to transfer characters, locations, items, or plot lines of a book project into another one, *novelibre* supports this via the XML export.

In case you maintain a "series bible" with Zim Desktop Wiki, you can connect it as a "project wiki" with multiple *novelibre* projects via the nv_zim plugin.

14.2 Splitting books

If you want to split a large book into two or more books, you can use *novelibre* to move the relevant chapters to a new project. All characters, locations, items and plot lines that are related to the moved sections are copied to the new project, and the relationships are retained.

14.3 Joining contents of different books

You also can move chapters, sections, and other tree elements to other *novelibre* projects via the clipboard. However, relationships are lost.

CHAPTER

FIFTEEN

COMMAND REFERENCE

15.1 File menu

File operation

15.1.1 New

Create a new novel project

With **File > New**, you can create a new project. This will open a submenu.

> **Note**
>
> The submenu can be extended by plugins to add more file types from which a *novelibre* project can be created.

Empty project

- This will close the current project and create a blank project.
- A file select dialog asks for the new project's file name. If you cancel the dialog, you can select the file name later when saving the project.

Create from ODT…

- This will close the current project and open a file dialog asking for an ODT document to create the new projec from.
- The newly created project is saved automatically in the same directory as the ODT document, using its file name and the extension *.novx*.
- If a project with the same file name as the ODT document already exists in the directory, no new project will be created.
- If you select a previously exported document belonging to an existing project, this project will be updated and loaded.
- The ODT document can either be a Work-in-progress, i.e. a regular novel manuscript with chapter headings and section contents, or an outline containing the chapter and section structure with titles and descriptions.

15.1.2 Open…

Open a novel project

With **File > Open** or `Ctrl-O`, you can open an existing project file.

> **Note**
>
> When opening a project, the current project will be closed. If there are unsaved changes, you will be asked for saving.

15.1.3 Reload

Reload the novel project

With **File > Reload** or `Ctrl-R`, you can overwrite the project in the memory with the last saved version.

> **Tip**
>
> This way you can undo changes made in the current session.

> **Note**
>
> If the project has changed on disk since last opened or saved, you will get a warning.

15.1.4 Restore backup

Restore the latest backup file

With **File > Restore backup** or `Ctrl-B`, you can load the penultimate version of the project file. This will overwrite the last saved project file. You will get a warning, because changes may be lost.

> **Note**
>
> "Backup file" means the file with the `.bak` extension in the project directory.
>
> After restoring the backup, a backup copy is no longer available in the project directory. A new backup copy is created when saving the project.

15.1.5 Refresh tree

Enforce tree refresh after making changes

With **File > Refresh tree** or `F5`, you can refresh the tree.

- "Normal" sections that have been moved to an "Unused" chapter are made "Unused".
- Parts and chapters are renumbered according to the Auto numbering settings.
- The "Trash" chapter is moved to the end of the book, if necessary.

15.1.6 Lock

Protect the project while edited outsides

With **File > Lock** or `Ctrl-L`, you can lock the project.

> **Note**
>
> All changes must be saved before locking the project.

15.1.7 Unlock

Make the project editable

With **File > Unlock** or `Ctrl-U`, you can unlock the project.

15.1.8 Open Project folder

Launch the file manager

With **File > Open Project folder** or `Ctrl-P`, you can launch the file manager with the current project folder. This might come in handy, if you e.g. wish to delete files or edit configuration files.

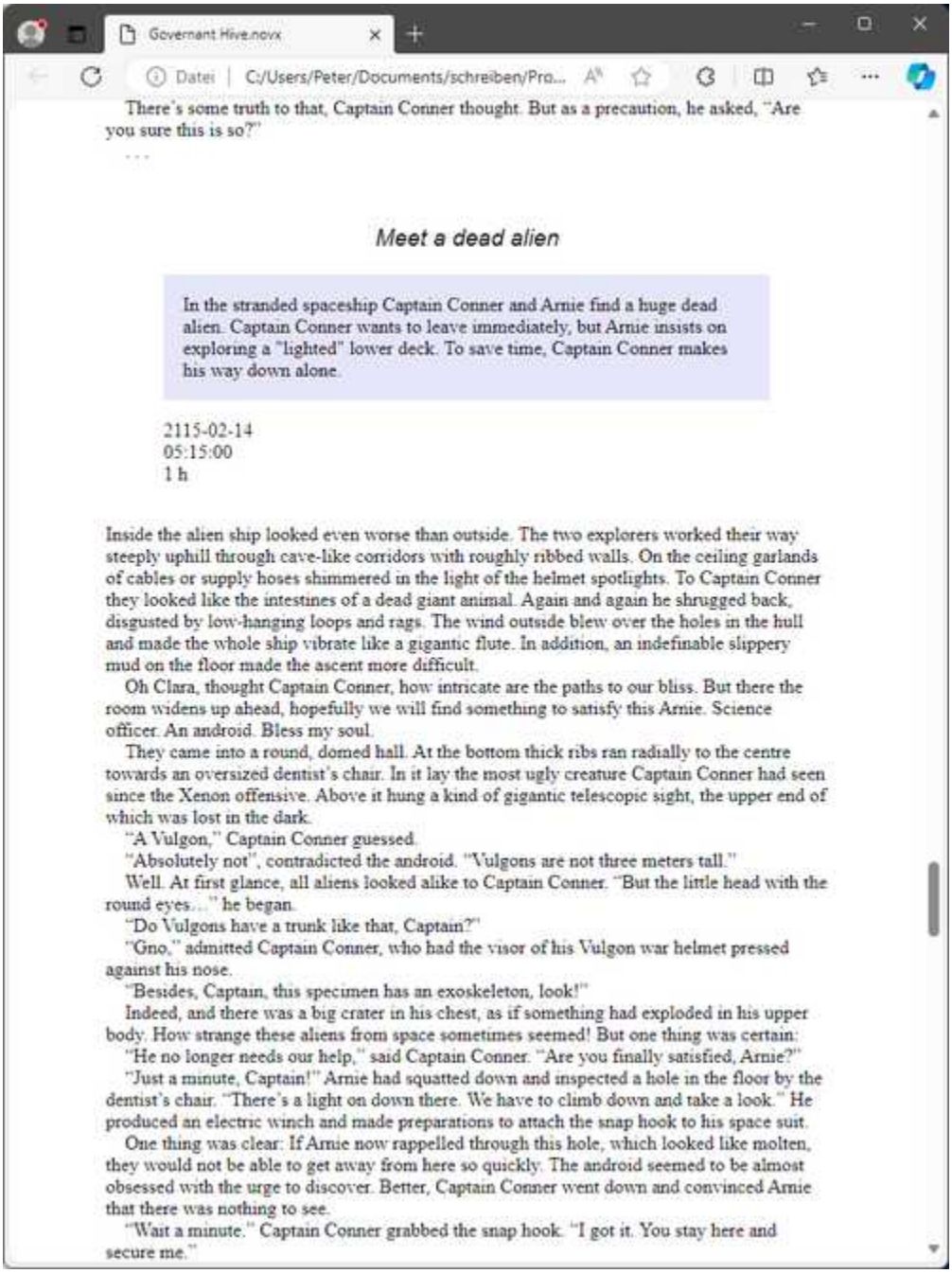
> **Hint**
>
> In case you edit the project "outsides", consider locking it before.

15.1.9 Copy style sheet

Provide a css style sheet in the project folder

With **File > Copy style sheet**, you can copy the style sheet *novx.css* into the current project folder. This allows you to view the *.novx* project file with a web browser.

The following picture shows an Edge browser screenshot: *novelibre* project, displayed using the style sheet.



Hint

Depending on your web browser and your operating system, the *content type* resp. *MIME type* of *.novx* files must be registered as *"text/xml"*. Under Windows, you can do this by running the `<home>\.novx\add_novelibre.reg` script.

15.1.10 Discard manuscript

Discard the current manuscript by renaming it

With **File > Discard manuscript**, you can add the *.bak* extension to the current manuscript. This may help to avoid confusion about changes made with *novelibre* and *Writer*.

> **Hint**
>
> You can also discard any previously exported document "for editing" via the Import dialog.

15.1.11 Save

Save the project

With **File > Save** or `Ctrl-S`, you can save the project. A backup copy is then automatically created.

> **Note**
>
> If the project has changed on disk since last opened, you will get a warning.

15.1.12 Save as…

Save the project with another file name/at another place

With **File > Save as…** or `Ctrl-Shift-S`, you can save the project with another file name/at another place. Then a file select dialog opens to specify the new path and file name.

> **Note**
>
> Your current project remains as saved the last time. Changes since then apply to the new project.

15.1.13 Close

Close the novel project

With **File > Close**, you can close the project without exiting the program. When closing the project, you will be asked for saving the project, if it has changed.

> **Note**
>
> If you open another project, the current project is automatically closed.

15.1.14 Quit/Exit

Exit the program

- Under Windows you can exit with **File > Exit** or `Alt-F4`.
- Otherwise you can exit with **File > Quit** or `Ctrl-Q`.

> **Note**
>
> When exiting the program, you will be asked for saving the project, if it has changed.

15.2 View menu

Control the display

15.2.1 Chapter level

Hide the sections

With **View > Chapter level** or `Ctrl-Alt-C`, you can collapse the tree, so that only parts and chapters are visible.

15.2.2 Expand selected

Show a whole branch

With **View > Expand selected**, you can expand a selected tree element.

15.2.3 Collapse selected

Hide child elements

With **View > Collapse selected**, you can collapse a selected branch.

15.2.4 Expand all

Show the whole tree

With **View > Expand all**, you can expand the whole tree.

15.2.5 Collapse all

Hide child elements

With **View > Collapse all**, you can hide all tree elements except the main categories.

15.2.6 Show Book

Go to the "Book" branch and expand it

With **View > View Book**, you can select and open the "Book" branch.

15.2.7 Show Characters

Go to the "Characters" branch and expand it

With **View > View Characters**, you can select and open the "Characters" branch.

15.2.8 Show Locations

Go to the "Locations" branch and expand it

With **View > View Locations**, you can select and open the "Locations" branch.

15.2.9 Show Items

Go to the "Items" branch and expand it

With **View > View Items**, you can select and open the "Items" branch.

15.2.10 Show Plot lines

Go to the "Plot lines" branch and expand it

With **View > Show Plot lines**, you can select and open the "Plot lines" branch.

15.2.11 Show Project notes

Go to the "Project notes" branch and expand it

With **View > View Planning**, you can select and open the "Project notes" branch.

15.2.12 Toggle Text viewer

Show/hide the novel text

With **View > Toggle Text viewer** or `Ctrl-T`, you can open or close the text viewer window, showing part/chapter/section titles and section content.

> **Hint**
>
> - On reopening, the windows shows the text, where the tree is selected.

15.2.13 Toggle Properties

Show/hide the selected element's properties

With **View > Toggle Properties** or `Ctrl-Alt-T`, you can open or close the element properties window.

> **Hint**
>
> On reopening, the window shows the properties of the currently selected element.

15.2.14 Detach/Dock Properties

Show the selected element's properties either in the main window or in its own window

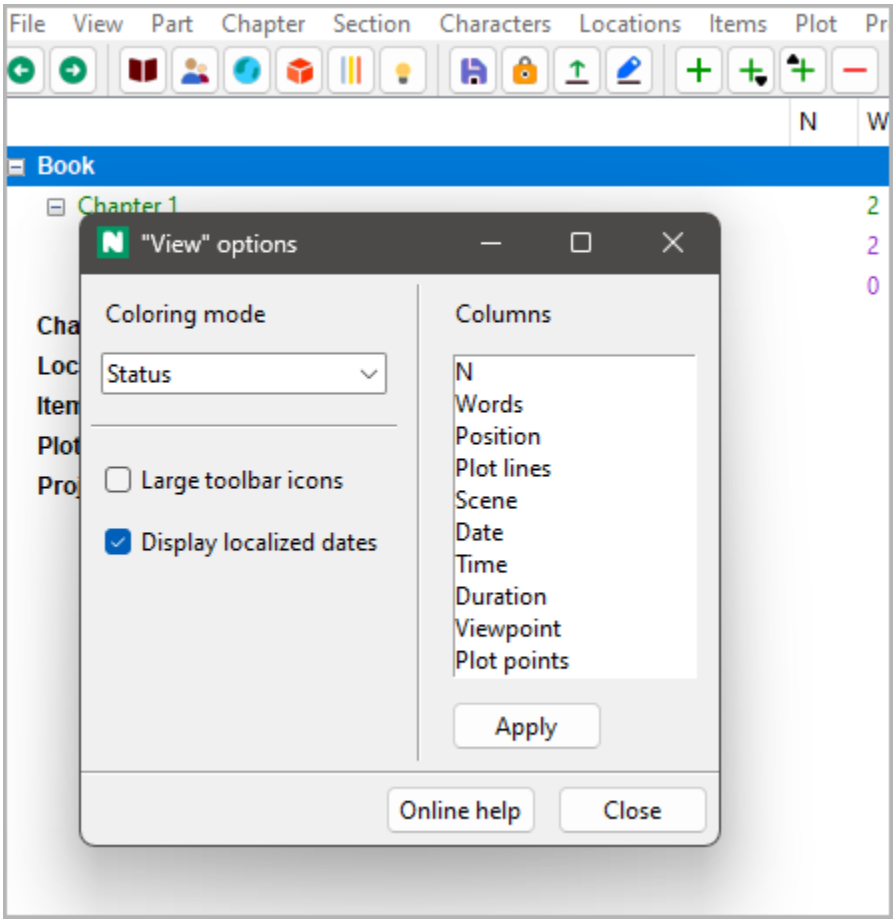
With **View > Detach/Dock Properties** or `Ctrl-Alt-D`, you can detach or dock the element properties window .

> **Hint**
>
> On closing the detached window, the properties are docked again.

15.2.15 Options

Project independent program settings

With **View > Options**, you can open a dialog for settings concerning the display.



Coloring mode

Set criteria according to which normal sections are colored in the tree

None
: Normal sections are black on white by default.

Status
: Normal sections are colored according to their completion status (*Outline*, *Draft*, *1st Edit*, *2nd Edit*, or *Done*).

Work phase
: Normal sections are highlighted if their completion status does not match the work phase defined in the Book properties.

Large toolbar icons

By default, the icon size is 16x16 pixels. If the *Large toolbar icons* checkbox is ticked, 24x24 icons are used after the next program startup.

> **Note**
>
> This applies not only to the toolbar, but also to all other icons that decorate the application's control elements.

Display localized dates

- If ticked, localized dates are displayed.
- If unticked, dates are displayed like *YYYY-MM-DD*, according to ISO 8601.

Columns

Change the column order

- From top to bottom in the list means from left to right in the tree.
- Just drag and drop to change the order.

Click the **Apply** button to apply changes.

15.3 Part menu

Part operation

15.3.1 Add

Add a new part

With **Part > Add**, you can add a part to the tree.

- The new part is placed at the next free position on the chapter level after the selection, if possible.
- Otherwise, the new part is placed at the last position on the chapter level.
- The new part has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

15.3.2 Export part descriptions for editing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Part > Export part descriptions for editing**, you can create a text document that contains a **very brief synopsis** with part headings and part descriptions. File name suffix is `_parts_tmp`.

15.4 Chapter menu

Chapter operation

15.4.1 Add

Add a new chapter

With **Chapter > Add**, you can add a chapter to the tree.

- The new chapter is placed at the next free position after the selection, if possible.
- Otherwise, the new chapter is placed at the end of the "Book" branch.
- The new chapter has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

15.4.2 Set Type

Set the type of the selected chapters

With **Chapter > Set Type**, you can set the type of the selected chapter to *Normal* or *Unused* .

> **Note**
>
> Setting the type of a chapter to *Unused* will also make its sections *Unused*.

15.4.3 Change Level

Change the level of the selected chapters

With **Chapter > Change Level**, you can turn chapters into parts and vice versa.

- **1st Level** converts the selected chapters into parts.
- **2nd Level** converts the selected parts into chapters.

15.4.4 Move selected chapters to new project

Split one book in two

With **Chapter > Move selected chapters to new project** you can create a new project containing the moved chapters/sections and all related elements and plot lines/plot points. The selected chapters are removed from the current project and pasted into an auto-generated project whose file path you define with a file selection dialog. All relationships of the moved sections are retained.

15.4.5 Export chapter descriptions for editing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Chapter > Export chapter descriptions for editing**, you can create a text document that contains a **brief synopsis** with part/chapter headings and chapter descriptions that can be edited and reimported. File name suffix is `_chapters_tmp`.

15.5 Section menu

Section operation

15.5.1 Add

Add a new section

With **Section > Add**, you can add a section to the tree.

- The new section is placed at the next free position after the selection, if possible.
- Otherwise, no new section is generated.
- The new section has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

Properties of a new section:

- *Normal* type
- *Outline* completion status
- No viewpoint character assigned

- No plot line or tag assigned
- No date/time set

15.5.2 Add multiple sections

Add new sections in bulk

With **Section > Add multiple sections**, you can add up to 20 sections to the tree.

- You will be prompted to enter the number of new sections.
- The number of sections to be added at once is limited to 20.
- The new sections are placed at the next free position after the selection, if possible.
- Otherwise, no new section is generated.

15.5.3 Set Type

Set the type of the selected section

With **Section > Set Type**, you can set the type of the selected section to *Normal* or *Unused* .

> **Hint**
>
> **Type change for multiple sections:**
>
> - Either select multiple sections, or
> - select a chapter.

15.5.4 Set Status

Set the section completion status

With **Section > Set Status**, you can set the completion status of the selected section to *Outline*, *Draft*, *1st Edit*, *2nd Edit*, or *Done*.

> **Hint**
>
> **Status change for multiple sections:**
>
> - Either select multiple sections, or
> - select a parent node (chapter or Book)

15.5.5 Export section descriptions for editing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Section > Export section descriptions for editing**, you can create a text document with a **full synopsis** containing part/chapter headings and section descriptions that can be edited and reimported. File name suffix is `_sections_tmp`.

15.5.6 Section list (export only)

Export an ODS document

With **Section > Section list (export only)**, you can create a spreadsheet with a row per section, containing the following data:

- Section ID (hidden)
- Section number (link to manuscript)
- Title
- Description
- Viewpoint
- Date
- Time
- Day
- Duration
- Tags
- Section notes
- Scene
- Goal
- Conflict
- Outcome
- Status
- Words total
- Word count
- Characters
- Locations
- Items

> **Note**
>
> Only "normal" sections appear in the section list. Sections of the "Unused" type are omitted.

File name suffix is `_sectionlist`.

Clicking on a section number with `Ctrl` pressed, you can jump to the corresponding section in the manuscript. However, if you edit this spreadsheet, you cannot apply the changes with *novelibre* (in contrast to the plot grid). The section list is more intended for extracting the metadata of the writing project, for example, in the case of abandoning *novelibre*.

15.5.7 Show Time table

Show an HTML report with a time table

With **Section > Show Time table**, you can create a list-formatted HTML file that contains a time table, and launch your system's web browser for displaying it.

In the time table, the dated "normal" sections are listed in chronological order. In addition to date/time and duration, the columns include the section title, description, locations and characters as well as plot lines with plot notes.

> **Note**
>
> The report is a temporary file, auto-deleted on program exit. If needed, you can have your web browser save or print it.

15.6 Characters menu

Character operation

15.6.1 Add

Add a new character

With **Characters > Add** you can add a character to the tree.

- If a character is selected, the new character is placed after the selected one.
- Otherwise, the new character is placed at the last position.
- The new character has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.
- The status of newly created characters is *minor*.

15.6.2 Set Status

Set the character status

With **Characters > Set Status**, you can make the selected character *major* or *minor*. Major characters are highlighted in the tree view.

> **Note**
>
> The character status is only for visual distinction. It has no influence on the program functions. Nevertheless, you can use it to mark viewpoint characters or characters with their own arcs.

15.6.3 Import

Import characters from another project

With **Characters > Import**, you can import a selection of characters from another project. First you select an XML file containing the character data. Then you select the characters you want to add to the current project.

> **Hint**
>
> To create an XML character data file for the current project, use **Export > XML data files**.

15.6.4 Export character descriptions for editing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Characters > Export character descriptions for editing**, you can create a text document that contains character descriptions, bio, goals, and notes that can be edited in Office Writer and reimported. File name suffix is `_characters_tmp`.

15.6.5 Export character list (spreadsheet)

Export an ODS document that can be imported again after editing

With **Characters > Export character list (spreadsheet)**, you can create a spreadsheet that contains a character list that can be edited with *Calc* and reimported. File name suffix is `_charlist_tmp`.

> **Note**
>
> You can reorder, hide or delete columns and rows without affecting the reimport. Only the first column and the first row, which are hidden by default, must not be changed as they contain the structural information for the import.

15.6.6 Show list

Show an HTML report with characters data

With **Characters > Show list**, you can create a list-formatted HTML file that contains a character list, and launch your system's web browser for displaying it.

> **Note**
>
> The report is a temporary file, auto-deleted on program exit. If needed, you can have your web browser save or print it.

15.7 Locations menu

Location operation

15.7.1 Add

Add a new location

With **Locations > Add**, you can add a location to the tree.

- If a location is selected, the new location is placed after the selected one.
- Otherwise, the new location is placed at the last position.
- The new location has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

15.7.2 Import

Import locations from another project

With **Locations > Import**, you can import a selection of locations from another project. First you select an XML file containing the location data. Then you select the locations you want to add to the current project.

> **Hint**
>
> To create an XML location data file for the current project, use **Export > XML data files**.

15.7.3 Export location descriptions for editing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Items > Export location descriptions for editing**, you can create a text document that contains location descriptions that can be edited with *Writer* and reimported. File name suffix is `_locations_tmp`.

15.7.4 Export location list (spreadsheet)

Export an ODS document that can be imported again after editing

With **Items > Export location list (spreadsheet)**, you can create a spreadsheet that contains a location list that can be edited with *Calc* and reimported. File name suffix is `_loclist_tmp`.

> **Note**
>
> You can reorder, hide or delete columns and rows without affecting the reimport. Only the first column and the first row, which are hidden by default, must not be changed as they contain the structural information for the import.

15.7.5 Show list

Show an HTML report with locations data

With **Locations > Show list**, you can create a list-formatted HTML file that contains a location list, and launch your system's web browser for displaying it.

> **Note**
>
> The report is a temporary file, auto-deleted on program exit. If needed, you can have your web browser save or print it.

15.8 Items menu

Item operation

15.8.1 Add

Add a new item

With **Items > Add**, you can add an item to the tree.

- If an item is selected, the new item is placed after the selected one.
- Otherwise, the new item is placed at the last position.
- The new item has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

15.8.2 Import

Import items from another project

With **Items > Import**, you can import a selection of items from another project. First you select an XML file containing the item data. Then you select the items you want to add to the current project.

> **Hint**
>
> To create an XML item data file for the current project, use **Export > XML data files**.

15.8.3 Export item descriptions for editing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Items > Export item descriptions for editing**, you can create a text document that contains item descriptions that can be edited with *Writer* and reimported. File name suffix is `_items_tmp`.

15.8.4 Export item list (spreadsheet)

Export an ODS document that can be imported again after editing

With **Items > Export item list (spreadsheet)**, you can create a spreadsheet that contains an item list that can be edited with *Calc* and reimported. File name suffix is `_itemlist_tmp`.

> **Note**
>
> You can reorder, hide or delete columns and rows without affecting the reimport. Only the first column and the first row, which are hidden by default, must not be changed as they contain the structural information for the import.

15.8.5 Show list

Show an HTML report with items data

With **Items > Show list**, you can create a list-formatted HTML file that contains an item list, and launch your system's web browser for displaying it.

> **Note**
>
> The report is a temporary file, auto-deleted on program exit. If needed, you can have your web browser save or print it.

15.9 Plot menu

Plot elements operation

15.9.1 Add Plot line

Add a new plot line to the story

With **Plot > Add plot line**, you can add a project note to the tree.

- If a plot line is selected, the new plot line is placed after the selected one.
- Otherwise, the new plot line is placed at the last position.

- The new plot line has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

15.9.2 Add Plot point

Add a new Plot point to the selected plot line

With **Plot > Add Plot point**, you can add a plot point to a plot line.

- If a plot point is selected, the new plot point is placed after the selected one.
- If a plot line is selected, the new plot point is placed at the last position.
- Otherwise, no new plot point is generated.
- The new plot point has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

15.9.3 Insert Stage

Insert a stage between the sections

With **Plot > Insert Stage**, you can insert a stage after the selected chapter or section.

> **Hint**
>
> By default, the new stage is on the second level. You can change the level to first (see below).

15.9.4 Change Level

Change the level of the selected stages

With **Plot > Change Level**, you can change the level of the selected stages.

- **1st Level** is displayed in bold face.
- **2nd Level** is displayed in regular font.

> **Note**
>
> The stage level is only for visual distinction. It has no influence on the program functions.

15.9.5 Import plot lines

Import plot lines with plot points from another project

With **Plot > Import plot lines**, you can import a selection of plot lines from another project. First you select an XML file containing the plot lines. Then you select the plot lines you want to add to the current project.

> **Hint**
>
> To create an XML plot lines file for the current project, use **Export > XML data files**.

15.9.6 Export plot grid for editing

Export an ODS document that can be imported again after editing

With **Plot > Export plot grid for editing**, you can create a spreadsheet as described in the Plotting with novelibre chapter, with a row per section, containing the following data:

- The sequential section number as a hyperlink to the section in the manuscript (if any)
- Narrative date
- Narrative time
- Day
- Duration (<days>d <hours>h <minutes>min)
- Section title
- Section description
- Viewpoint character
- One column per plot line with the section's plot line notes
- Tags
- Scene
- Goal/Reaction/(custom)
- Conflict/Dilemma/(custom)
- Outcome/Decision/(custom)
- Section notes

The plot line titles are linked to the plot line descriptions (see below).

> **Note**
>
> Only "normal" sections appear in the plot grid. Sections of the "Unused" type are omitted.

File name suffix is `_grid_tmp`.

- Clicking on a section number with `Ctrl` pressed, you can jump to the corresponding section in the manuscript.
- Clicking on a plot line title in the headline with `Ctrl` pressed, you can jump to the corresponding plot line description, if any (see below).

> **Note**
>
> You can reorder, hide or delete columns and rows without affecting the reimport. Only the first column and the first row, which are hidden by default, must not be changed as they contain the structural information for the import.

15.9.7 Export story structure description for editing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Plot > Export story structure description for editing**, you can create a text document that contains all stages, each with description. File name suffix is `_structure_tmp`.

> **Hint**
>
> This is also a full synopsis, with the emphasis on the dramaturgical structure.

15.9.8 Export plot line descriptions for editing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Plot > Export plot Export plot line descriptions for editing**, you can create a text document that contains stages, plot lines, and plot points, each with description. The plot points are linked to the manuscript and to the section descriptions. File name suffix is `_plotlines_tmp`.

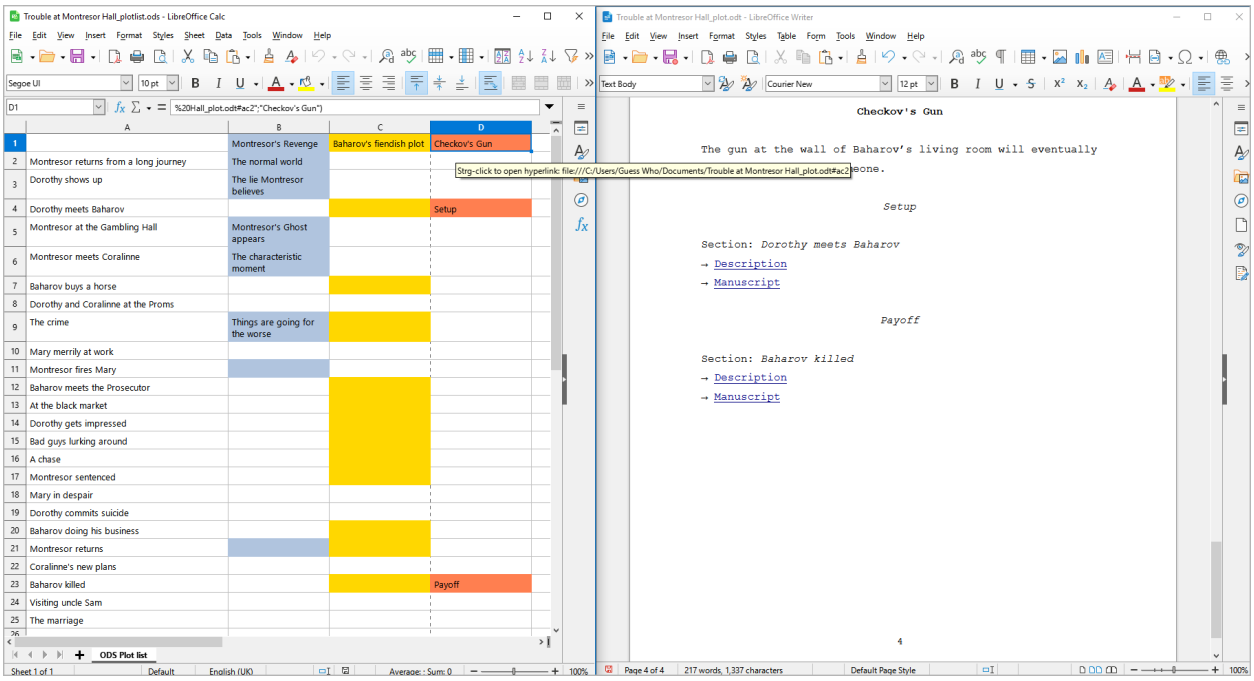
15.9.9 Export plot list (spreadsheet)

Export an ODS document

With **Plot > Export plot list (spreadsheet)**, you can create a spreadsheet with a row for each section and a column for each plot line. Associations between plot lines and sections are color-highlighted. Plot point titles are displayed. File name suffix is `_plotlist`.

> **Hint**
>
> The plot line titles and the section titles are hyperlinked to the respective descriptions in other exported documents, if any.

The following picture shows a LibreOffice screenshot. Note the hyperlink from the plot line title in the plot list (left) to the plot line in the plot description (right).



> **Important**
>
> Hyperlinks in ODS spreadsheets are absolute within the file system, so they might not work after moving the location of your project file to another folder or computer. In this case, you will have to export the spreadsheet anew.

15.9.10 Show Plot list

Show an HTML report with plot elements

With **Plot > Show Plot list**, You can create a list-formatted HTML file that contains a plot list similar to the ODS plot list (see above), but without any hyperlinks, and launch your system's web browser for displaying it.

> **Note**
>
> The report is a temporary file, auto-deleted on program exit. If needed, you can have your web browser save or print it.

15.10 Project notes menu

Project notes operation

15.10.1 Add

Add a new project note

With **Project notes > Add**, you can add a project note to the tree.

- If a project note is selected, the new project note is placed after the selected one.
- Otherwise, the new project note is placed at the last position.
- The new project note has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

15.10.2 Show list

Show an HTML report with project notes

With **Project notes > Show list**, you can create a list-formatted HTML file that contains title and content of all project notes, and launch your system's web browser for displaying it.

> **Note**
>
> The report is a temporary file, auto-deleted on program exit. If needed, you can have your web browser save or print it.

15.11 Export menu

File export

15.11.1 Manuscript for editing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Export > Manuscript for editing**, you can create a text document that is split into sections (to be seen in the Navigator). File name suffix is `_manuscript_tmp`.

- Only "normal" chapters and sections are exported. Chapters and sections marked "unused" are not exported.
- Section titles are invisible, but appear in the *Navigator*.
- Chapters and sections can neither be rearranged nor deleted.
- With *Writer*, you can split sections by inserting headings or a section divider:
  - *Heading 1* → New part title. Optionally, you can add a description, separated by `|`.
  - *Heading 2* → New chapter title. Optionally, you can add a description, separated by `|`.
  - `###` → Section divider. Optionally, you can append the section title to the section divider. You can also add a description, separated by `|`.

> **Important**
>
> Documents with split sections are automatically discarded after the *novelibre* project is updated.

- Text markup: Bold and italics are supported. Other highlighting such as underline and strikethrough are lost.
- Change tracking: All changes are accepted on import. Change tracking data is lost.

15.11.2 Manuscript for third-party word processing

Export an ODT document that can be imported again after editing

With **Export > Manuscript for third-party word processing**, you can create a text document with visible section markers. File name suffix is `_proof_tmp`.

> **Note**
>
> This document retains its section information even if it is converted to other formats and back again. This may work with popular commercial word processors and even with web-based word processors such as Google Docs.

- Only "normal" chapters and sections are exported. Chapters and sections marked "unused" are not exported.
- The document contains chapter and section headings. However, changes will not be reimported.
- The document contains section `[scx]` markers. **Do not touch lines containing the markers** if you want to be able to write the document back to *novelibre* format.
- Chapters and sections can neither be rearranged nor deleted.
- When editing the document, you can split sections by inserting headings or a section divider:
  - *Heading 1* → New part title. Optionally, you can add a description, separated by `|`.
  - *Heading 2* → New chapter title. Optionally, you can add a description, separated by `|`.
  - `###` → Section divider. Optionally, you can append the section title to the section divider. You can also add a description, separated by `|`.

  > **Important**
  >
  > Documents with split sections are automatically discarded after the *novelibre* project is updated.

- Text markup: Bold and italics are supported. Other highlighting such as underline and strikethrough are lost.
- Change tracking: All changes are accepted on import. Change tracking data is lost.

15.11.3 Final manuscript document (export only)

Export an ODT document

With **Export > Final manuscript document (export only)**, you can create a text document for further use, e.g. a final document when you are finished with *novelibre*.

> **Hint**
>
> In contrast to the manuscript for editing, this document is not divided internally into sections, which could facilitate further processing and reformatting.

- The document is placed in the same folder as the project.
- Document's **filename**: `<project name>.odt`.

- Only "normal" chapters and sections are exported. Chapters and sections marked "unused" are not exported.
- Part titles appear as first level heading.
- Chapter titles appear as second level heading.
- Sections are separated by `* * *`. The first line is not indented.
- Starting from the second paragraph, paragraphs begin with indentation of the first line.
- Sections marked "attach to previous section" appear like continuous paragraphs.
- Text markup: Bold and italics are supported. Other highlighting such as underline and strikethrough are lost.
- The first paragraph of each chapter is assigned the paragraph style *Chapter beginning* which is by default like the body text without indentiation. By modifying this paragraph style you can give a special look to the beginnings ot the chapters, e.g. with initials.

Tip

If you prefer simple blank lines instead of the three-asterisks in your final document, you can achieve this using "Find and replace". This is particularly convenient with a macro that comes with the novelibre-tools extension.

15.11.4 Brief synopsis (export only)

Export an ODT document

With **Export > Brief synopsis (export only)**, you can create a text document containing a brief synopsis with part, chapter, and sections titles only. File name suffix is `_brf_synopsis`.

- Only "normal" chapters and sections are exported. Chapters and sections marked "unused" are not exported.
- Part titles appear as first level heading.
- Chapter titles appear as second level heading.
- Section titles appear as plain paragraphs.

15.11.5 Cross references (export only)

Export an ODT document

With **Export > Cross references (export only)**, you can create a text document containing navigable cross references. File name suffix is `_xref`.

The cross references are:

- Sections per character,
- sections per location,
- sections per item,
- sections per tag,
- characters per tag,
- locations per tag,
- items per tag.

15.11.6 XML data files

Export XML files that can be imported into other projects

With **Export > XML data files**, you can create a set of XML files containing the project's characters, locations, items, and plot lines with all their properties. These files can be used to transfer the elements to another projects.

> **Hint**
>
> To import XML data files from another project, use the **Import** command in the **Characters**, **Locations**, **Items**, or **Plot** menu.

15.11.7 Options

Project independent program settings

With **Export > Options**, You can open a dialog for settings concerning the document export.

Ask before opening exported documents

This checkbox controls the behavior on document export.

- If ticked, you will be asked whether you want to have *novelibre* launch *Writer* or *Calc* with the newly created document opened.
- If unticked, *novelibre* will launch *Writer* or *Calc* with the newly created document opened right away.

Lock the project after document export for editing

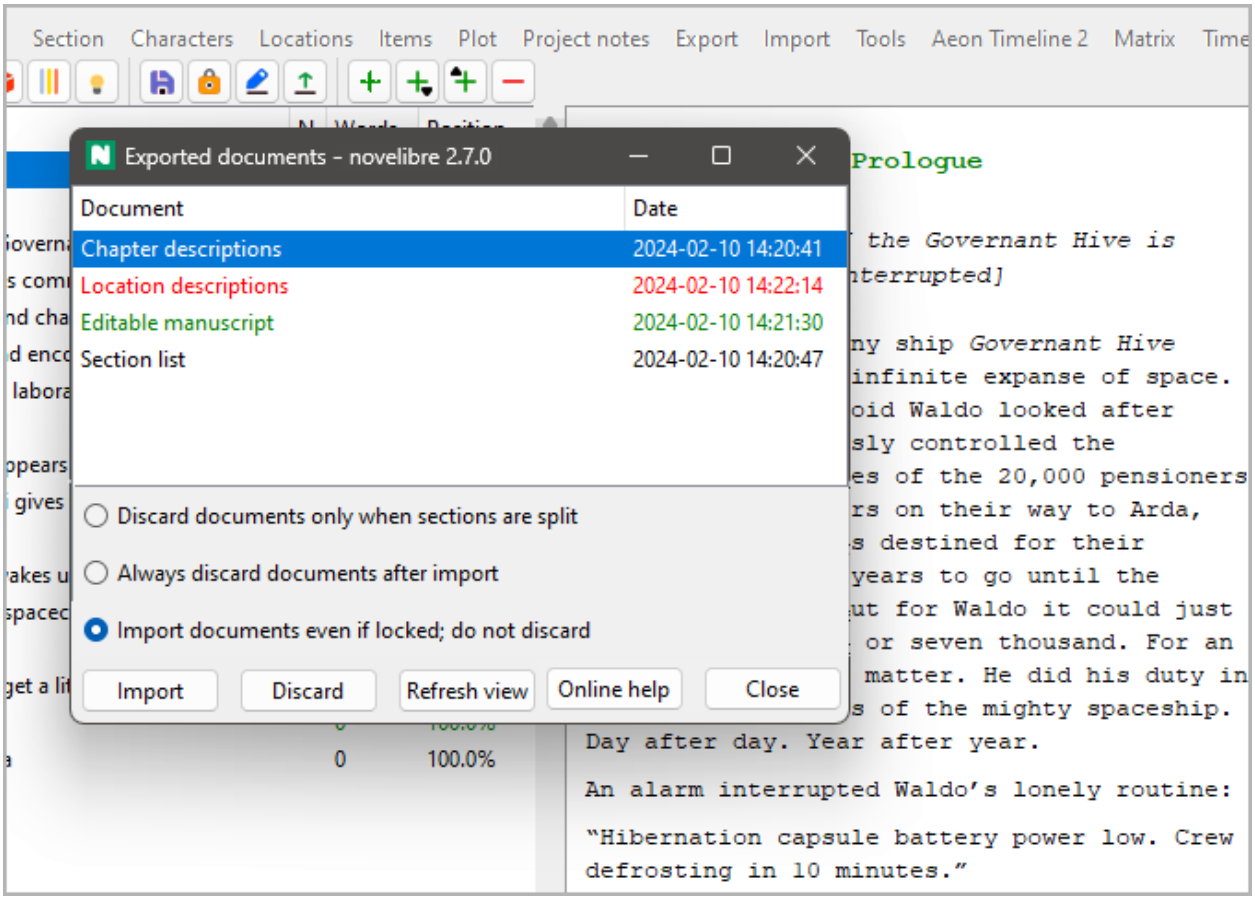
This checkbox controls the behavior on opening documents for editing.

- If ticked, *novelibre* will lock the project when launching *Writer* or *Calc*.
- If unticked, *novelibre* won't lock the project when launching *Writer* or *Calc*.

15.12 Import menu

Update the project from a previously exported ODF document

With the **Import** main menu entry, you can open a pop-up window with a list containing previously exported ODF documents that can be reimported, thus updating the current project.



- The document types and dates are shown.
- Documents that are newer than the project file are highlighted in green.
- Documents that cannot be imported because they are open in *Writer* are highlighted in red.
- You can update the project from a document either by double-clicking on the list entry, or by selecting the document and clicking on the **Import** button.
- You can discard documents by selecting them and clicking on the **Discard** button.

> **Hint**
>
> Discard means: Rename by adding the extension *.bak* to the file name.

- After closing a listed document in *Writer* while the *Exported documents* window is open, you can click on the **Refresh view** button.

15.12.1 Discarding documents after updating the project

Documents with split sections are always automatically discarded after reimport in order to avoid confusion about the changed section or chapter structure. Concerning reimported documents that do not require modifying the project structure, you have three choices:

Discard documents only when sections are split
This is the default behavior. The ODF documents are kept for future use.

Always discard documents after import
After updating the *novelibre* project from an reimported ODF document, this document is automatically discarded.

Import documents even if locked; do not discard
This is for fast and frequent project updates while keeping the ODF documents open in *Writer* or *Calc* for editing.

> **Important**
>
> If you split sections in your ODT document, you cannot import it while open in *Writer*. This is because *novelibre* cannot discard it when locked by *Writer*.

15.13 Tools menu

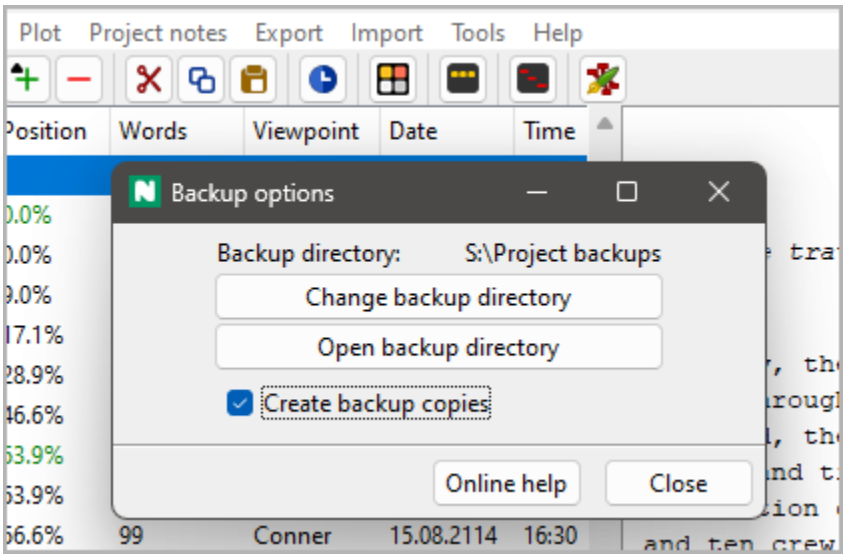
Miscellaneous functions

> **Note**
>
> The *Tools* menu can be extended by plugins to add more features.

15.13.1 Backup options

Project independent program settings

With **Tools > Backup options**, you can open a dialog for settings concerning the backup.



The path to the backup directory is displayed at the top of the window, if one is set.

Change backup directory

This opens a directory selection dialog with which you can select the backup directory.

> **Tip**
>
> To take precautions against hard disk failure, you can also specify an external drive or a USB stick.

Open backup directory

This opens the backup directory with the file manager. This is for quick access if you want to restore a project file.

Create backup copies

If this field is checked, *novelibre* creates a copy of the project file in the set backup directory each time it is saves. To prevent this backup copy from being opened by mistake, the file name extension is given the suffix #.

> **Hint**
>
> This allows you to temporarily switch off the backup, whereby the backup directory remains set.

15.13.2 Open installation folder

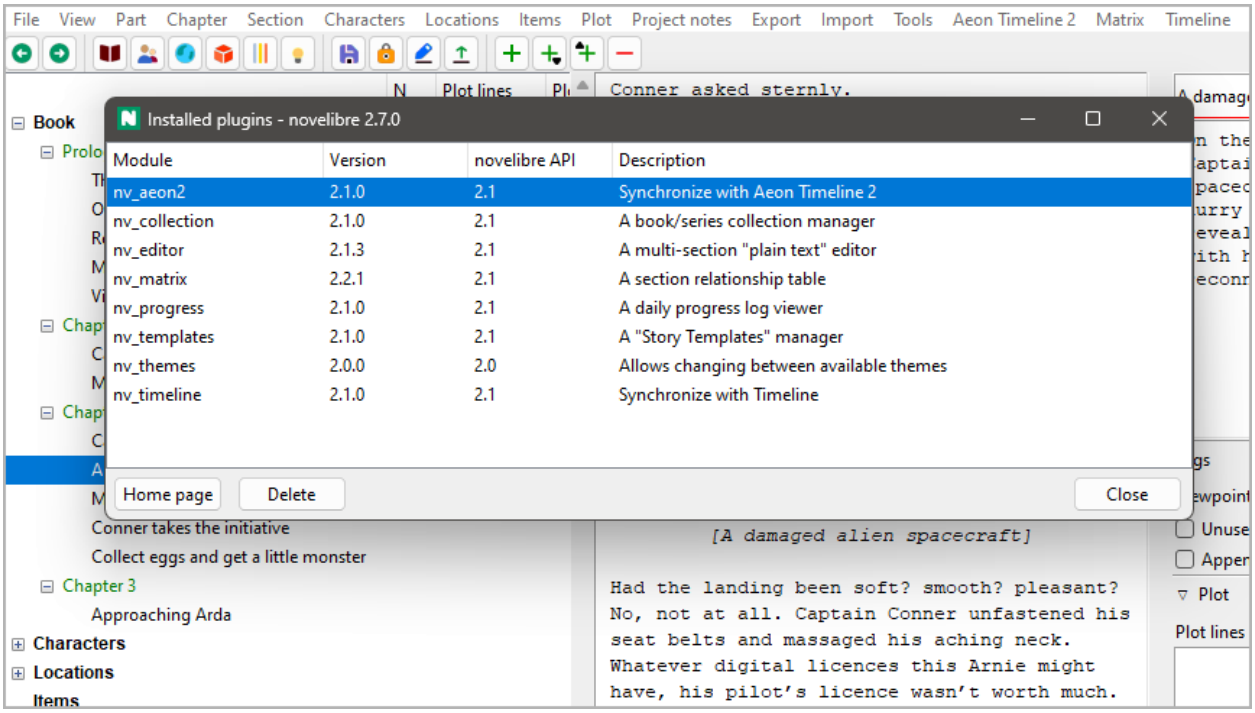
Launch the file manager

With **Tools > Open installation folder**, you can launch the file manager with the *novelibre* installation folder. This might come in handy if you wish to edit configuration files, or install your own plugins.

15.13.3 Plugin manager

Display and manage installed plugins

With **Tools > Plugin manager**, you can open the *Installed plugins* dialog.



- Successfully installed plugins are displayed black on white by default.
- Outdated plugins are grayed out.
- Plugins that cannot run are displayed in red, with an error message.

How to update a plugin

1. Select the plugin you want to update. If the **Home page** button is activated, you can click on it, and your system browser opens the plugin home page. Otherwise, you have to know the source of the plugin yourself.
2. Go to the plugin home page and download the latest release. Install it according to the instructions.

How to uninstall a plugin

Select the plugin, and click on the **Delete** button.

About version compatibility

On the window frame, you see the *novelibre* version, consisting of three numbers that are separated by points.

```
<major version number>.<minor version number>.<patch level>
```

In the **novelibre API** column, you see the plugin's compatibility information, consisting of two numbers that are separated by points.

```
<major version number>.<minor version number>
```

The rule for compatibility

- The plugin's *novelibre API* major version number must be the same as *novelibre's* major version number.
- The plugin's *novelibre API* minor version number must be less than or equal to *novelibre's* minor version number.

Fix incompatibilities

- If the plugin's *novelibre API* major version number is greater than *novelibre's* major version number, *novelibre* needs to be updated.
- If the plugin's *novelibre API* major version number is less than *novelibre's* major version number, the plugin needs to be updated.
- If the plugin's *novelibre API* minor version number is greater than *novelibre's* minor version number, *novelibre* needs to be updated.

15.13.4 Show notes

Show an HTML report with all the "sticky notes"

With **Tools > Show notes**, you can create a list-formatted HTML file that contains all "sticky notes" along with the titles of the tree elements they are associated with, and launch your system's web browser for displaying it.

> **Note**
>
> The report is a temporary file, auto-deleted on program exit. If needed, you can have your web browser save or print it.

15.14 Help menu

Quick access to the help pages for novelibre and its plugins

> **Note**
>
> The *Help* menu can be extended by plugins adding links to their specific help pages.

> **Hint**
>
> With `F1` you can call up a help page corresponding to the context.

15.14.1 Online Help

With **Help > Online Help**, you can launch your system web browser with the *novelibre* online help URL.

15.14.2 About novelibre

With **Help > About novelibre** you can view a legal notice window.

15.14.3 novelibre home page

With **Help > novelibre home page** you can launch your system web browser with the *novelibre* home page URL.

> **Hint**
>
> This is a quick way to get to the download link of the most recent *novelibre* version.

15.15 Tree view context menu

When right-clicking on a tree element in the left pane, a context menu opens that belongs to the type of the selected element.

> **Hint**
>
> Greyed-out entries are not available, e.g. due to "project lock".

15.15.1 Book context menu entries

Add Section

Adds a new section.

- The new section is placed at the next free position after the selection.
- The new section has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

Properties of a new section

- *Normal* type
- *Outline* completion status
- No viewpoint character assigned
- No plot line or tag assigned
- No date/time set

Add Chapter

Adds a new chapter.

- The new chapter is placed at the next free position after the selection.
- The new chapter has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

Add Part

Adds a new part.

- The new part is placed at the next free position after the selection.
- In the tree, the part is at the same level as the chapters, so the chapters are not children of the part. This is to make it easier to move the part boundaries.
- The new part has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

Insert Stage

Inserts a new stage at the next free position at stage level after the selection.

- The new stage has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.
- The new stage is on the second level by default.

Change Level

Changes the level of a chapter or a stage.

- **1st Level** converts a selected chapter into a part.
- **2nd Level** converts a selected part into a chapter.

Export this chapter

Exports a manuscript containing only the selected chapter. If a manuscript already exists, confirmation is required before exporting.

> **Caution**
>
> The exported document has the same file name as the complete manuscript. If you overwrite it before reimporting, changes to other chapters may be lost.

Delete

Deletes the selected tree element and its children.

- Parts and chapters are deleted.
- Sections are marked "unused" and moved to the "Trash" chapter.
- Deleting a part has no effect on its subordinate chapters.
- Deleting a chapter moves its sections to the "Trash" chapter.
- The "Trash" chapter is created automatically, if needed.
- When deleting the "Trash" chapter, all its sections are deleted.

Set Type

Sets the type of the selected chapter or section. This can be *Normal* or *Unused*.

> **Note**
>
> Setting the type of a chapter to *Unused* will also make its sections *Unused*.

Set Status

Sets the completion status of the selected section.

> **Hint**
>
> Select a parent node to set the status for multiple sections.

Join with previous

Joins two sections, if within the same chapter, of the same type, and with the same viewpoint.

- New title = title of the prevoius section & title of the selected section
- The section contents are concatenated, separated by a paragraph separator.

- Descriptions are concatenated, separated by a paragraph separator.
- Goals are concatenated, separated by a paragraph separator.
- Conflicts are concatenated, separated by a paragraph separator.
- Outcomes are concatenated, separated by a paragraph separator.
- Notes are concatenated, separated by a paragraph separator.
- Character lists are merged.
- Location lists are merged.
- Item lists are merged.
- Plot line assignments are merged.
- Plot point associations are moved to the joined section, if any.
- Section durations are added.

Caution

Be aware, there is no "Undo" feature.

Chapter level

Hides the sections by collapsing the tree, so that only parts and chapters are visible.

Expand

Shows a whole branch by expanding the selected tree element.

Collapse

Hides the child elements of the selected tree element.

Expand all

Shows the whole tree.

Collapse all

Hides all tree elements except the main categories.

15.15.2 Characters/Locations/Items context menu entries

Add

Adds a new character/location/item.

- The new element is placed after the selected one.
- The new element has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.
- The status of newly created characters is *minor*.

Export manuscript filtered by viewpoint

Exports a manuscript with the sections that have the selected character as viewpoint. If a manuscript already exists, confirmation is required before exporting.

> **Caution**
>
> The exported document has the same file name as the complete manuscript. If you overwrite it before reimporting, changes to other sections may be lost.

Export synopsis filtered by viewpoint

Exports the descriptions of the sections that have the selected character as viewpoint. If a synopsis already exists, confirmation is required before exporting.

> **Caution**
>
> The exported document has the same file name as the complete synopsis. If you overwrite it before reimporting, changes to other section descriptions may be lost.

Delete

Deletes the selected character/location/item.

> **Caution**
>
> Be aware, there is no "Undo" feature.

Set Status

Sets the selected character's status. This can be *major* or *minor*. Major characters are highlighted in the tree view.

> **Note**
>
> The character status is only for visual distinction. It has no influence on the program functions. Nevertheless, you can use it to mark viewpoint characters or characters with their own plot lines.

> **Hint**
>
> Select the *Characters* root node to set the status for all characters.

15.15.3 Plot lines context menu entries

Add Plot line

Adds a new plot line

- If a plot line is selected, the new item is placed after the selected one.
- Otherwise, the new plot line is placed at the last position.

- The new plot line has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

Add Plot point

Adds a new Plot point

- If a plot point is selected, the new plot point is placed after the selected one.
- If a plot line is selected, the new plot point is placed at the last position.
- Otherwise, no new plot point is generated.
- The new plot point has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

Export manuscript filtered by plot line

Exports a manuscript with the sections that belong to the selected plot line. If a manuscript already exists, confirmation is required before exporting.

> **Caution**
>
> The exported document has the same file name as the complete manuscript. If you overwrite it before reimporting, changes to other sections may be lost.

Export synopsis filtered by plot line

Exports the descriptions of the sections that belong to the selected plot line. If a synopsis already exists, confirmation is required before exporting.

> **Caution**
>
> The exported document has the same file name as the complete synopsis. If you overwrite it before reimporting, changes to other section descriptions may be lost.

Change sections to Unused

Set all sections that are assigned to the selected plot line to Unused. This excludes the entire plot line from the manuscript.

Change sections to Normal

Set all sections that are assigned to the selected plot line to Normal. This allows a plot line that has been excluded to be reintegrated into the manuscript.

Delete

Deletes the selected plot line/plot point.

> **Caution**
>
> Be aware, there is no "Undo" feature. If you delete a plot line, all its plot points will be deleted, too.

15.15.4 Project notes context menu entries

Add Project note

Adds a new Project note

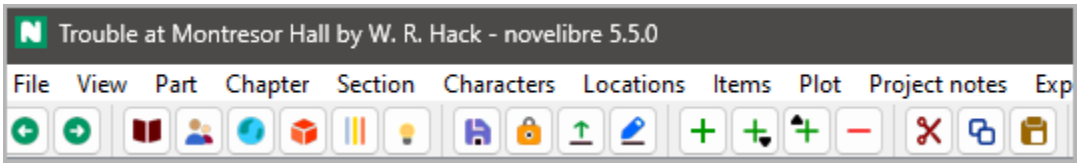
- If a project note is selected, the new project note is placed after the selected one.
- Otherwise, the new project note is placed at the last position.
- The new project note has an auto-generated title. You can change it in the right pane.

Delete

Deletes the selected project note.

15.16 The toolbar

The toolbar provides buttons for common actions in the proposed workflow.



Go back in the browsing history.

Go forward in the browsing history.

Go to the "Book" branch and expand it. Same as **View > Show Book**.

Go to the "Characters" branch and expand it. Same as **View > Show Characters**.

Go to the "Locations" branch and expand it. Same as **View > Show Locations**.

Go to the "Items" branch and expand it. Same as **View > Show Items**.

Go to the "Plot lines" branch and expand it. Same as **View > Show Plot lines**.

Go to the "Project notes" branch and expand it. Same as **View > Show Project notes**.

Save the project. Same as **File > Save** or `Ctrl-S`.

Toggle the lock status of the project.

Import the current manuscript. Same as selecting the manuscript under **Import**.

Export the manuscript for editing. Same as **Export > Manuscript for editing**, but without confirmation for opening the document.

Add element. Same as `Ctrl-N`.

Add child element. Same as `Ctrl-Alt-N`.

Add element on the parent's level. Same as `Ctrl-Alt-Shift-N`.

Delete selected elements. Same as `Del`.

Move the selected element from the tree to the clipboard. Same as `Ctrl-X`.

Copy the selected element to the clipboard. Same as `Ctrl-C`.

Paste the element stored in the clipboard to the tree. Same as `Ctrl-V`.

You can copy and paste the following tree elements via the system clipboard:

- Parts and chapters,
- sections,
- stages,
- plot lines,
- plot points,
- characters,
- locations,
- items,
- project notes.

Hint

If multiple elements are selected, only the first one will be copied. However, if the element has "children", these will also be copied and pasted.

Attention

Relationships are not included when copying to the clipboard. This also applies to the section viewpoint and for plot lines/plot points.

Toggle Text viewer. Same as **View > Toggle Text viewer** or `Ctrl-T`.

Toggle Properties. Same as **View > Toggle Properties** or `Ctrl-Alt-T`.

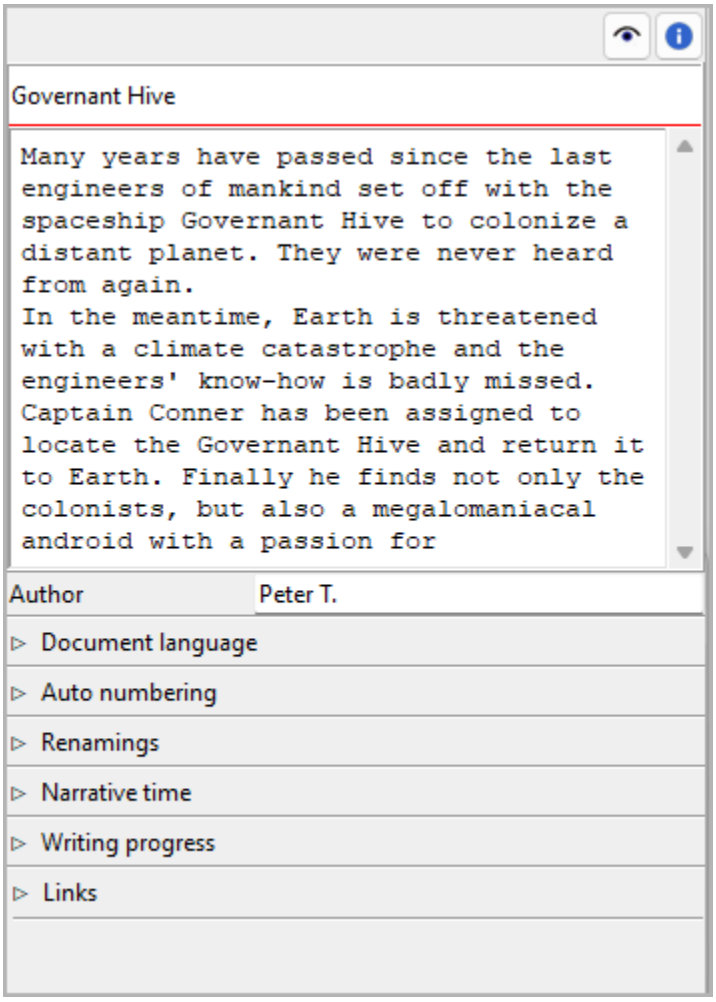
CHAPTER

SIXTEEN

PROPERTIES REFERENCE

16.1 Book properties

The Book properties view opens in the right pane when you select “Book” in the tree, or when you click on the toolbar icon. It is the initial view after opening a *novelibre* project.

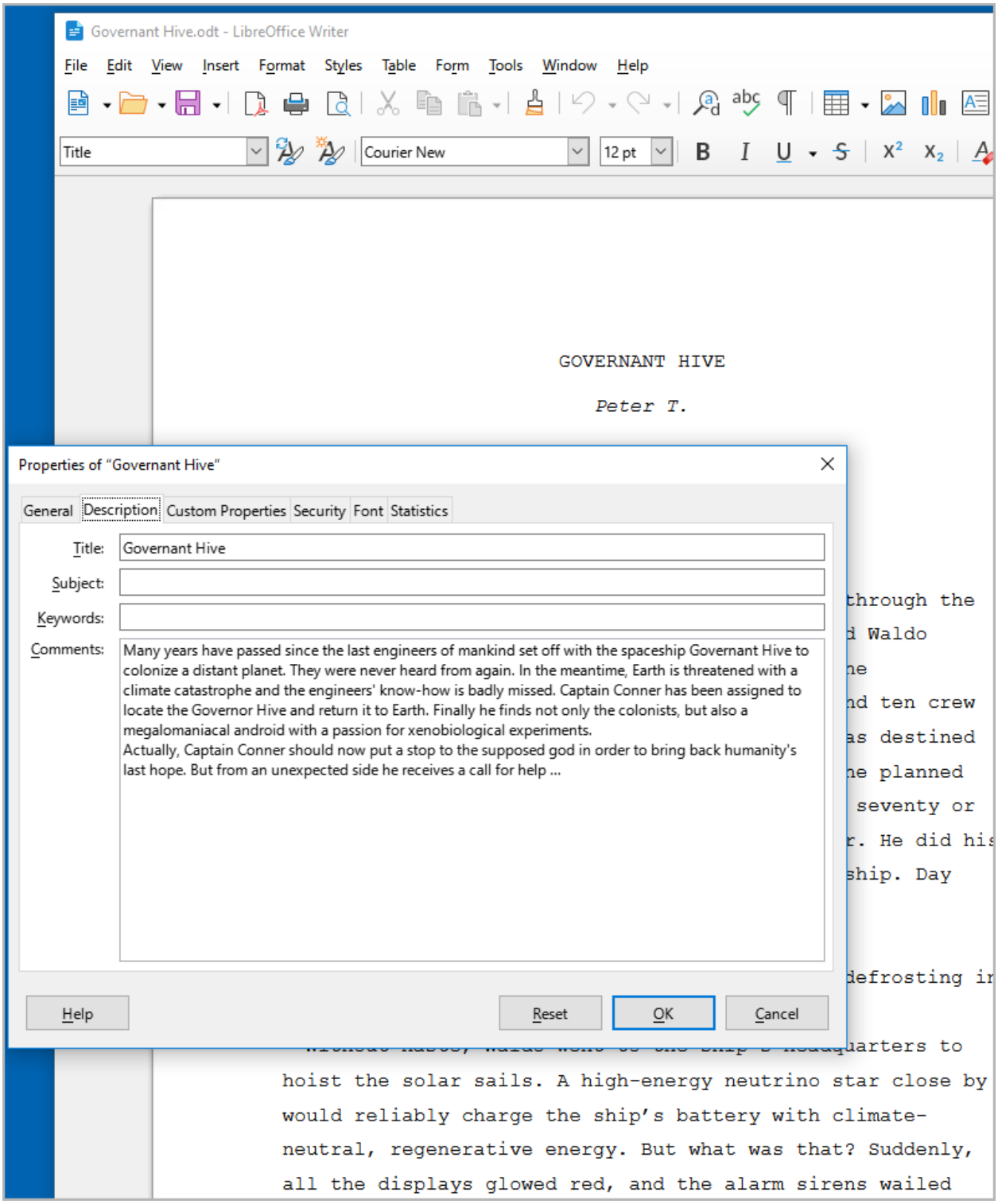


16.1.1 Title, description, and author

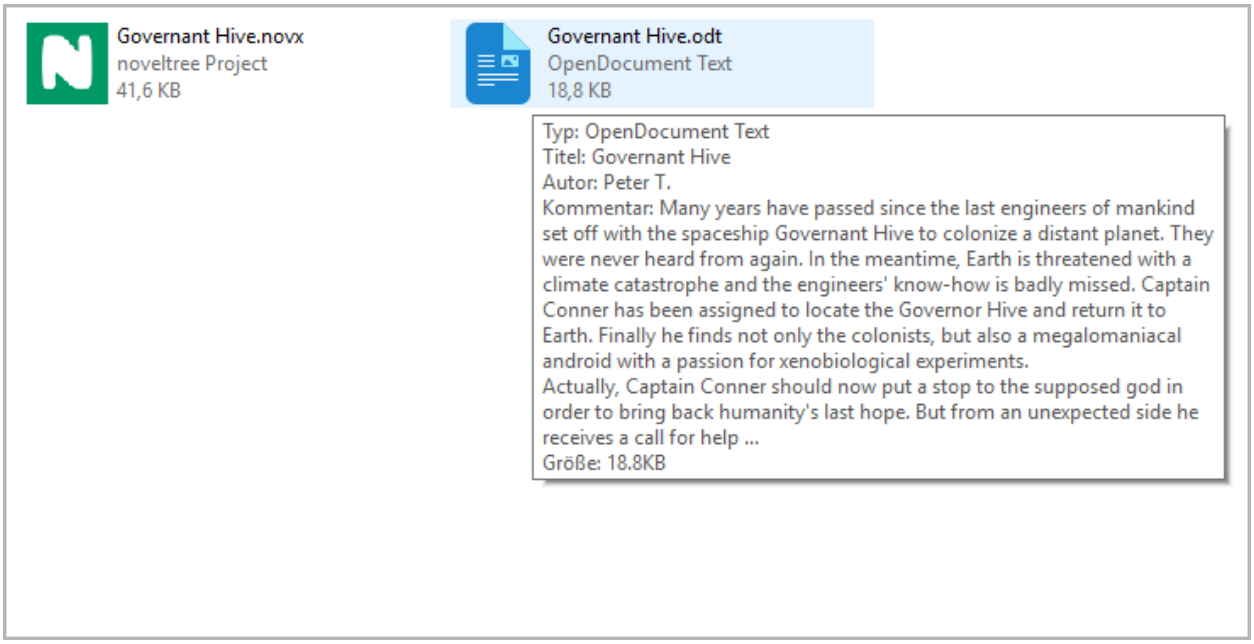
Title and description are displayed in an editable "index card".

The editing of book title and author can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the description are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

After exporting the book to an *ODT* document, title and description appear in the document properties.

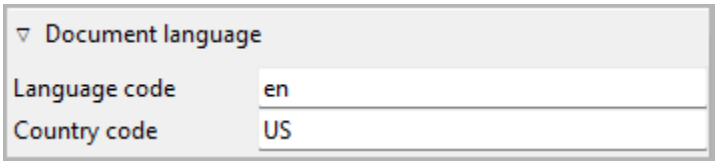


These properties are visible, for example, when the mouse pointer is over the document in the Windows Explorer.



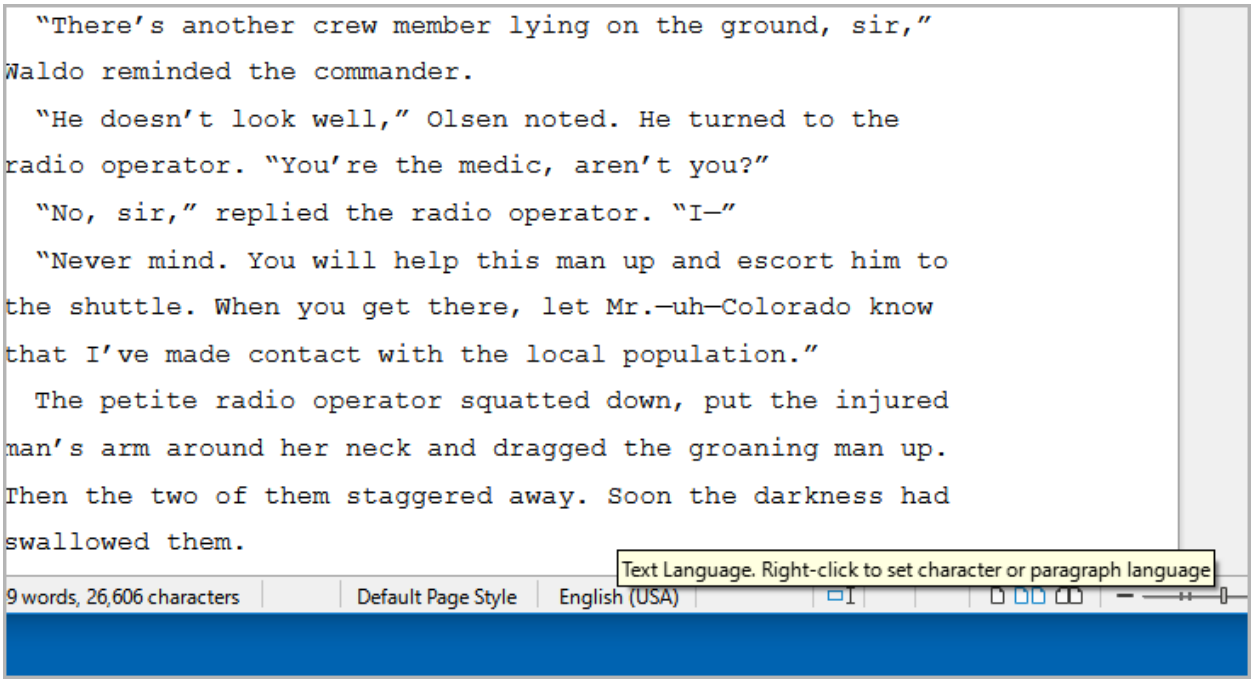
16.1.2 Document language

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



- Language code acc. to ISO 639-1
- Country code acc. to ISO 3166-2

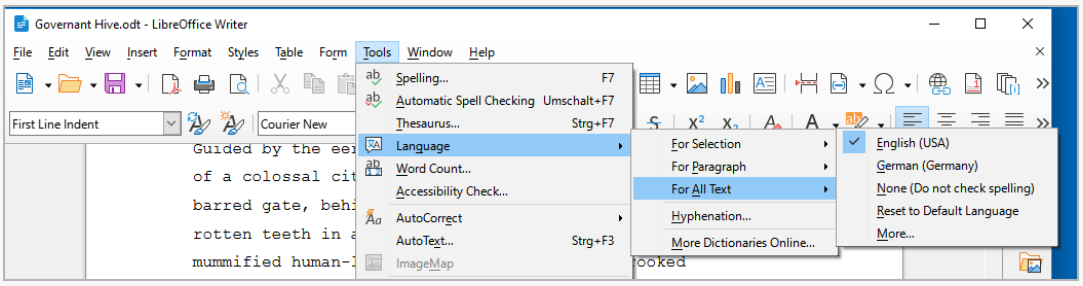
This information controls the spelling checker for export documents.



If not set, the System locale setting will be used as default.

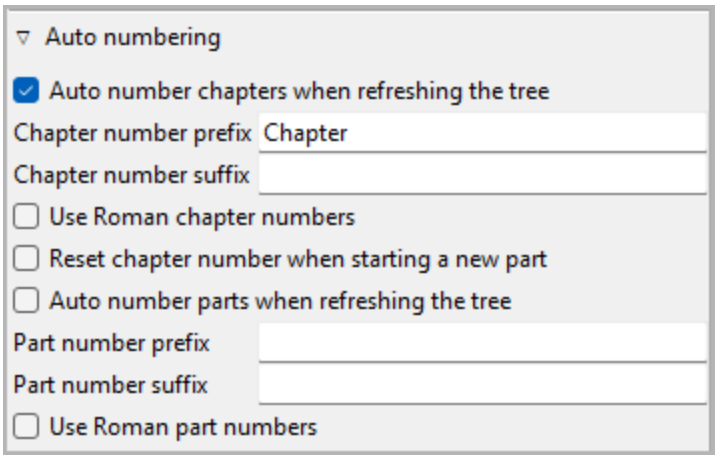
Hint

You can also set or change the document language with *Writer*, then it will be applied on import.



16.1.3 Auto numbering

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



Auto number chapters/parts when refreshing the tree

If this checkbox is ticked, all chapters/parts are automatically numbered each time the tree is refreshed. The chapter titles are replaced with a `prefix-number-suffix` pattern (without the dashes).

> **Hint**
>
> You can optionally exclude individual chapters/parts from auto-numbering in the Chapter/part properties.

Prefix and suffix entries can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

> **Note**
>
> Make sure to add a space character to separate the prefix or suffix from the chapter or part number.

Use Roman chapter numbers

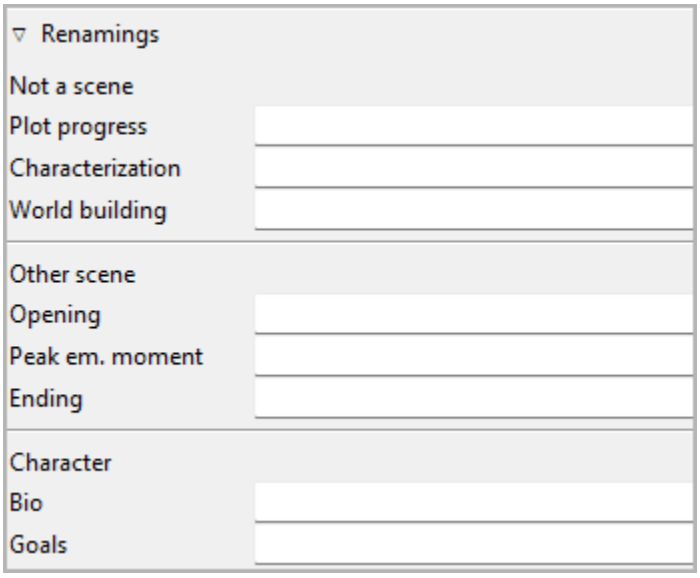
By default, arabic numbers, like "1", "2", "3" … are used for auto-numbering. If this checkbox is ticked, Roman numbers, like "I", "II", "III", "IV" … are used instead.

Restart chapter numbering at part beginning

By default, the chapters are numbered consistently across the parts. If this checkbox is ticked, the chapter numbering starts again with "1" in each part.

16.1.4 Renamings

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



novelibre provides some ready-made fields for sections and characters to store information that should be at hand when writing. If the default categories do not fit into your individual story planning concept, you can rename these fields. Editing the categories can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

"Not a scene" fields
The heading replacements for *Plot progress*, *Characterization*, and *World building* are used when you set the Scene frame to **Not a scene**. These categories then apply to all sections that don't represent scenes.

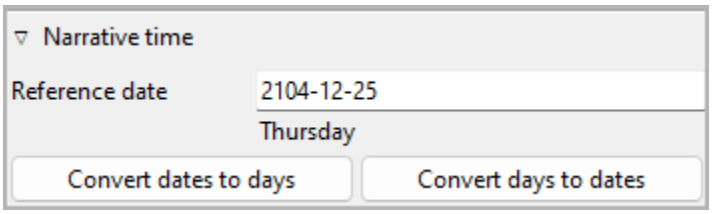
"Other Scene" fields
The heading replacements for *Opening*, *Peak emotional monent*, and *Ending* are used when you set the Scene frame to **Other**. These categories then apply to all sections that represent scenes other than "Action" and "Reaction".

"Character" fields
If you want other categories than Bio and Goals for your characters, you can enter them here. They will then apply to all characters.

> **Note**
>
> If you rename the *Bio* frame, it will keep the Birth/death date entries anyway.

16.1.5 Narrative time

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



To get an overview of the course of the narrative time, you can enter date/time information for each section. The date can be specific *(YYYY-MM-DD)* or unspecific (number of days, e.g. from the beginning of the story).

Reference date
The reference date is optional. It can be used to convert relative dates into absolute dates, or vice versa. The

timeline software plugins may use the reference date for creating events from sections that have no date or an unspecific one.

Format: *YYYY-MM-DD*, according to ISO 8601.

> **Hint**
>
> Even if you don't need specific dates for your story, specifying a reference date might be helpful. Thus, a day of the week can be displayed along with the unspecific date, and ages can be calculated for related characters.

Convert dates to days
This transforms specific section dates into days, related to the reference date.

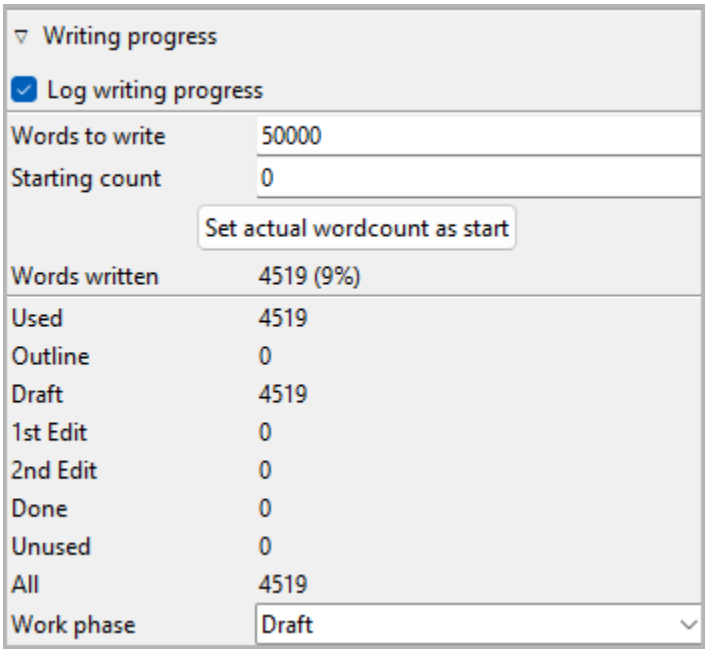
Convert days to dates
This transforms unspecific section dates into specific ones, using the reference date.

> **Note**
>
> For large novels, the conversion may take some time, depending on your system. During the conversion time, the clicked button will display *"Please wait . . . "*.

> **Hint**
>
> The commands above convert all dated sections at once. If you want to do the conversion for single sections, just go to the Section properties view.

16.1.6 Writing progress

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



With *novelibre*, you can set a word count target and track your writing progress.

> **Note**
>
> Regardless of the entries made here, you can see the word count in the status bar at any time.

Log writing progress
By default, *novelibre* stores a log entry with the word counts for each day on which you edit the project. You can prevent this by unticking the **Log writing progress** checkbox.

> **Hint**
>
> For viewing the daily progress log, you may want to install the nv_progress plugin.

Words to write
Here you can enter a number (without decimal points or separators) indicating your writing goal in words. The entry can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

Starting count
Here you can enter a number (without decimal points or separators) indicating the word count you want to start from. The entry can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

Set actual wordcount as start
Click this button to enter your current word count in the **Starting count** field.

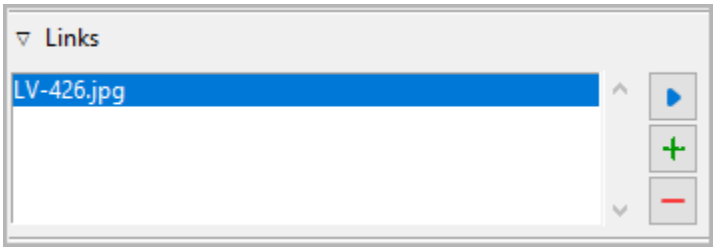
Words written
Here the difference between your actual word count and the starting count is displayed. The percentage refers to the words to write.

Work phase
This setting is for the tree viewer "Work phase" coloring mode.

- Sections with the same completion status as the selected work phase are black.
- Sections that are ahead of the selected work phase are green.
- Sections that are behind the selected work phase are magenta.

16.1.7 Links

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



This is a list for image and research document links.

Although *novelibre* holds some character/location/item data, it is not the right application for extensive world building. For this, you may want to use more powerful software, like Zim Desktop Wiki. In this case, *novelibre* allows you to create links to the text files that will take you quickly to the right places in the wiki.

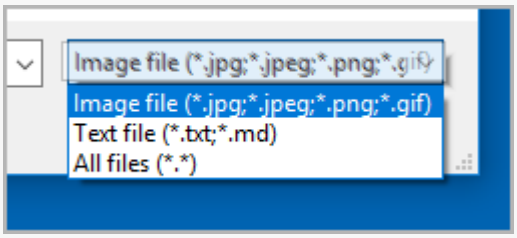
Or you have collected some images that could inspire you when writing. Then simply create links to these images to open them with your system's standard image viewer.

> **Tip**
>
> If you have collected several images for a character in a folder that your standard image viewer can browse through, a single link to any image file is sufficient.

The links are displayed in a list in the order they are entered.

Add Link

When clicking on , a file selection dialog opens. The selected file will be added to the link list.

> **Hint**
>
> By default, the dialog shows image files. For other file types, change the selector in the lower right corner.
>
> 
>

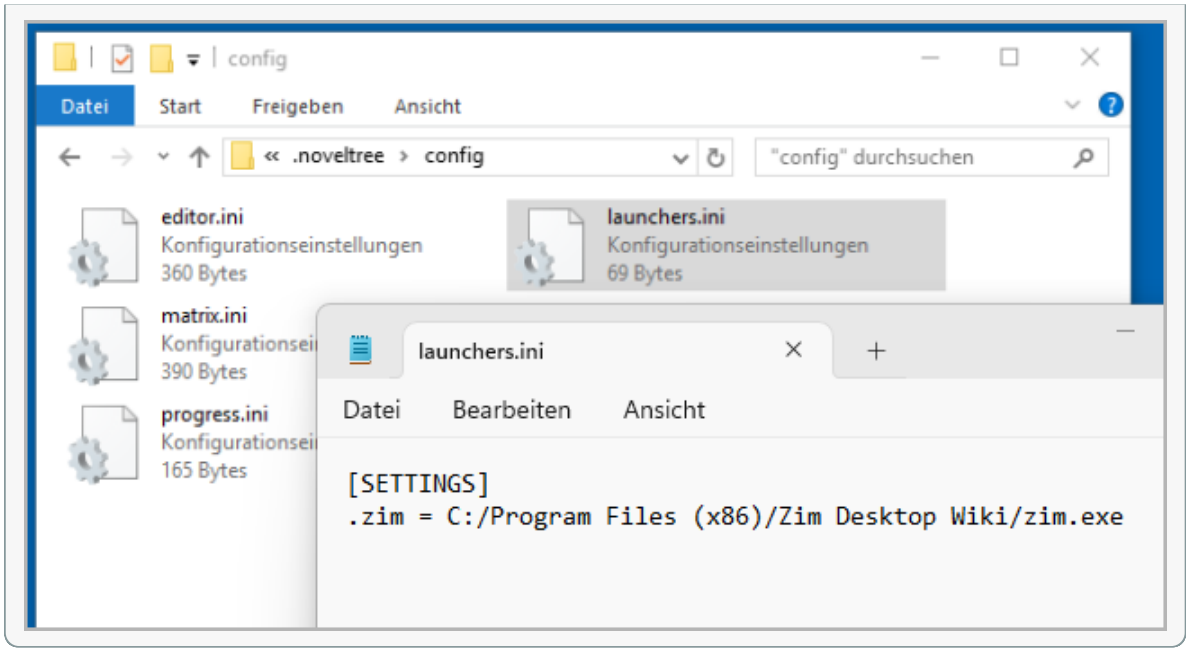
Remove Link

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected link is removed from the list.

Open Link

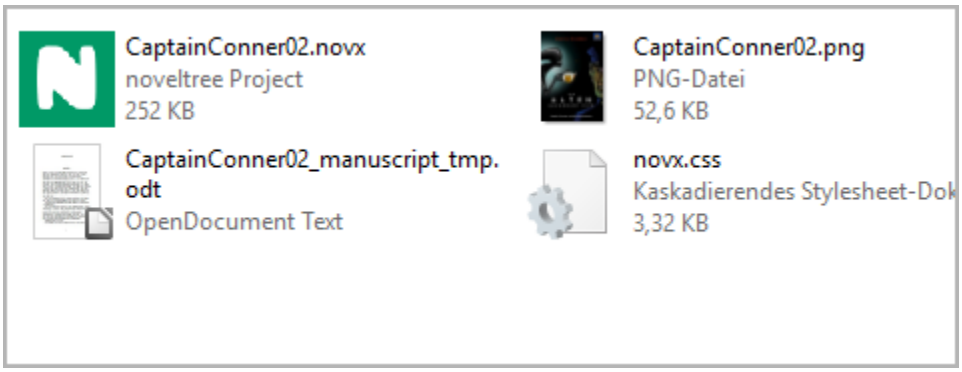
When double-clicking on a link, or clicking on , the link is opened with the standard application for the link's file type.

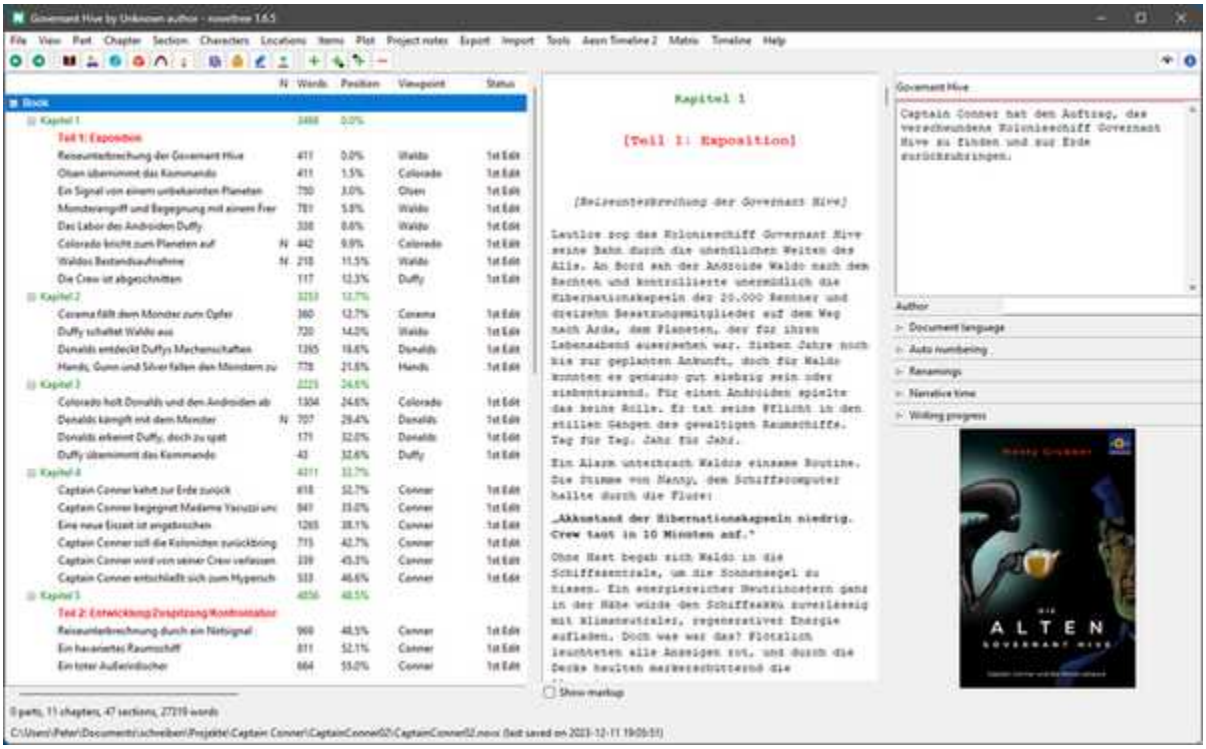
> **Hint**
>
> If you want to open certain linked files with another application than the standard application, you can provide a *novelibre* "launcher" setting. For this, just create a text file named **launchers.ini** in the `.novx/config` directory (where all configuration files are stored). Here you can assign applications to the file extensions.
>
> Zim desktop wiki pages are a special case. For this, the Zim program is assigned to the *.zim* extension.
>
> This example shows a setting that makes *novelibre* open text files with the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application instead of the standard text editor:
>
> ```
> [SETTINGS]
> .zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
> ```



16.1.8 Cover thumbnail

A cover thumbnail is displayed with the book properties if you provide a PNG image file with the project name along with the *.novx* file. The recommended image width is 100 to 200 pixels.

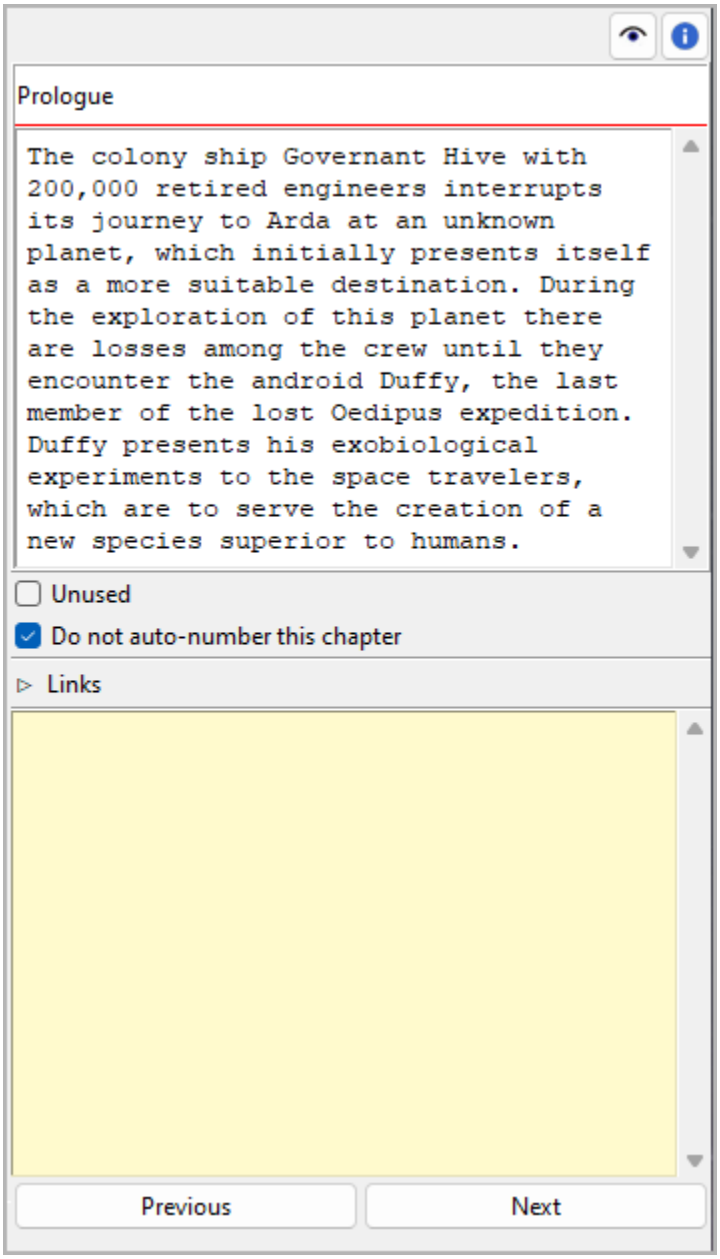




16.2 Chapter/part properties

The Chapter/part properties view opens in the right pane when you select a chapter or a part in the tree. You can edit the properties of the selected chapter or part.

> **Hint**
>
> You can change any chapter into a part or vice versa via the **Change Level** entry in the context menu, the **Part** menu, or the **Chapter** menu.



16.2.1 Title and description

Title and description are displayed in an editable "index card".

The editing of the title can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the description are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

> **Note**
>
> Depending on your Book settings, *novelibre* might overwrite the title the next time the tree is refreshed. Thus, you don't need to edit the capter/part title, if auto numbering is activated and the selected chapter or part is not excluded from auto numbering (see below).

16.2.2 Unused

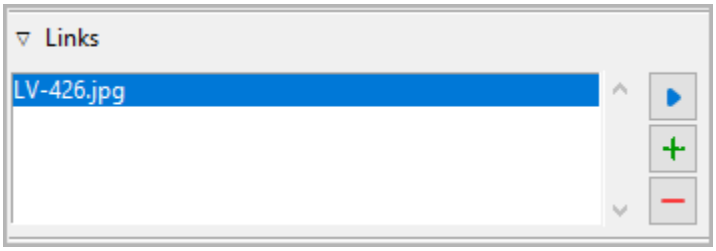
With the **Unused** checkbox, you can change the chapter type.

16.2.3 Do not auto-number this chapter/part

If this checkbox is ticked, the selected chapter or part will be excluded from auto numbering, and the title you enter manually will persist.

16.2.4 Links

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



This is a list for image and research document links.

Although *novelibre* holds some character/location/item data, it is not the right application for extensive world building. For this, you may want to use more powerful software, like Zim Desktop Wiki. In this case, *novelibre* allows you to create links to the text files that will take you quickly to the right places in the wiki.

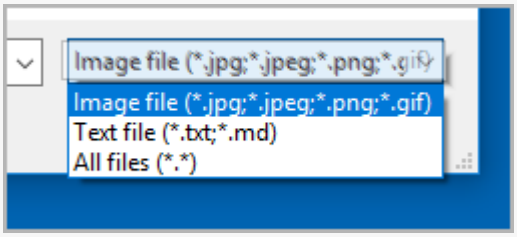
Or you have collected some images that could inspire you when writing. Then simply create links to these images to open them with your system's standard image viewer.

> **Tip**
>
> If you have collected several images for a character in a folder that your standard image viewer can browse through, a single link to any image file is sufficient.

The links are displayed in a list in the order they are entered.

Add Link

When clicking on , a file selection dialog opens. The selected file will be added to the link list.

> **Hint**
>
> By default, the dialog shows image files. For other file types, change the selector in the lower right corner.
>
> 
>

Remove Link

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected link is removed from the list.

Open Link

When double-clicking on a link, or clicking on , the link is opened with the standard application for the link's file type.

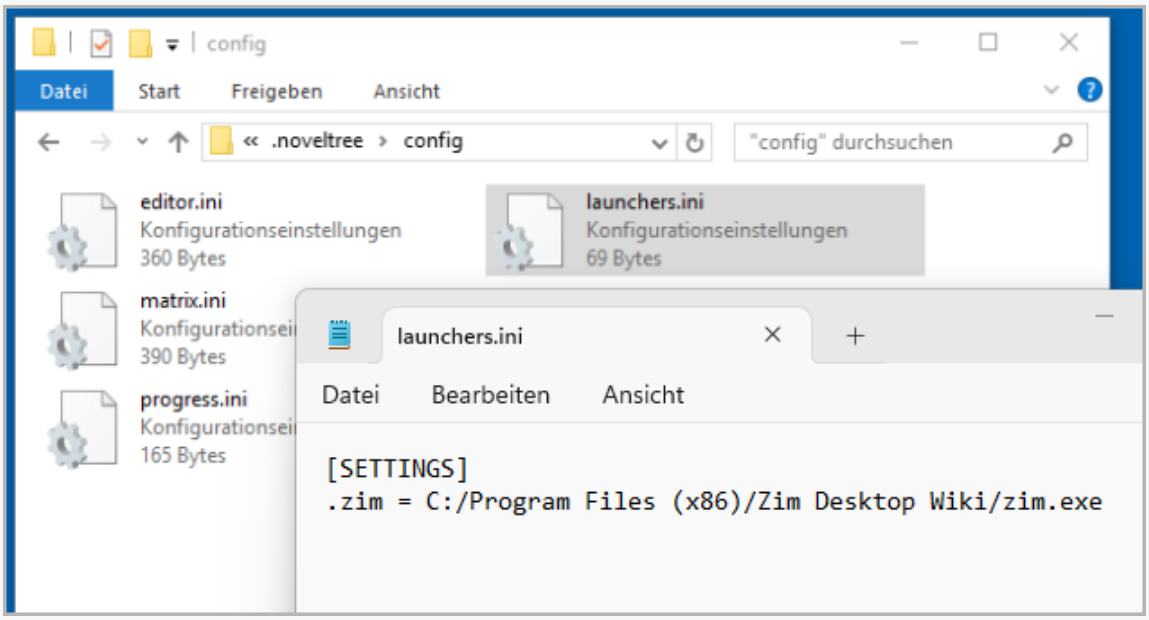
Hint

If you want to open certain linked files with another application than the standard application, you can provide a *novelibre* "launcher" setting. For this, just create a text file named **launchers.ini** in the `.novx/config` directory (where all configuration files are stored). Here you can assign applications to the file extensions.

Zim desktop wiki pages are a special case. For this, the Zim program is assigned to the *.zim* extension.

This example shows a setting that makes *novelibre* open text files with the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application instead of the standard text editor:

```
[SETTINGS]
.zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
```



16.2.5 "Sticky note"

The yellow text area is for notes. Changes are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

When the "sticky note" of a section contains text, "N" is displayed in the tree view as a reminder. If the branch of a chapter with sections containing notes is collapsed, the "N" is displayed in the chapter row.

16.2.6 Navigation buttons

Chapter view

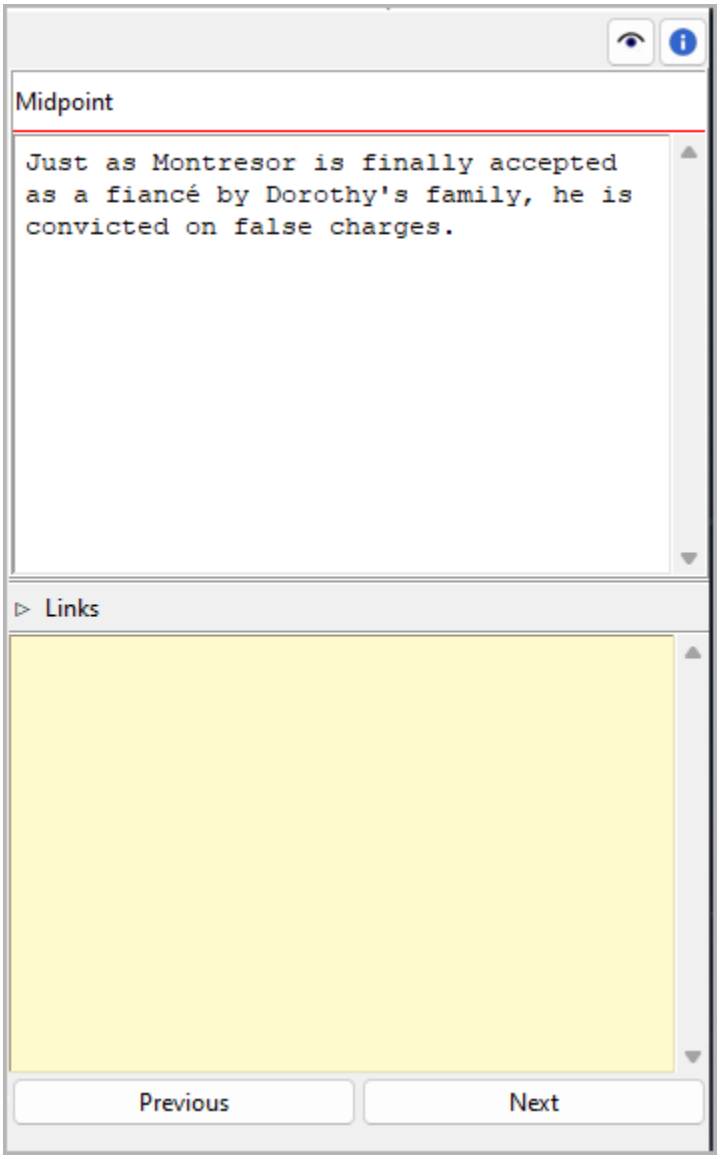
- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous chapter in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next chapter in the tree.

Part view

- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous part in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next part in the tree.

16.3 Stage properties

The Stage properties view opens in the right pane when you select a stage in the tree.



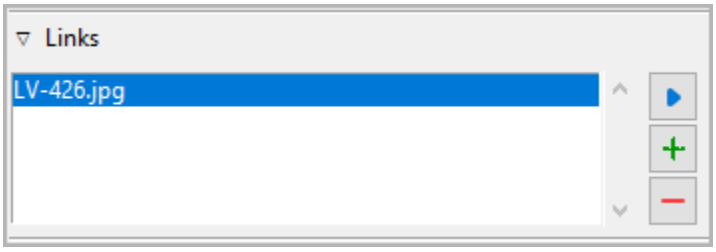
16.3.1 Title and description

Title and description are displayed in an editable "index card".

The editing of the title can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the description are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

16.3.2 Links

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



This is a list for image and research document links.

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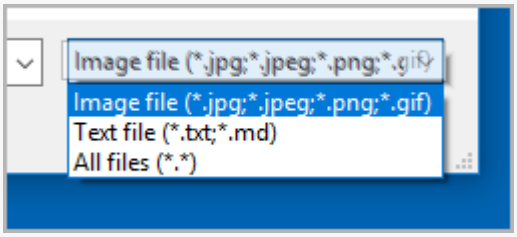
Or you have collected some images that could inspire you when writing. Then simply create links to these images to open them with your system's standard image viewer.

> **Tip**
>
> If you have collected several images for a character in a folder that your standard image viewer can browse through, a single link to any image file is sufficient.

The links are displayed in a list in the order they are entered.

Add Link

When clicking on , a file selection dialog opens. The selected file will be added to the link list.

> **Hint**
>
> By default, the dialog shows image files. For other file types, change the selector in the lower right corner.
>
> 
>

Remove Link

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected link is removed from the list.

Open Link

When double-clicking on a link, or clicking on , the link is opened with the standard application for the link's file type.

Hint

If you want to open certain linked files with another application than the standard application, you can provide a *novelibre* "launcher" setting. For this, just create a text file named **launchers.ini** in the `.novx/config` directory (where all configuration files are stored). Here you can assign applications to the file extensions.

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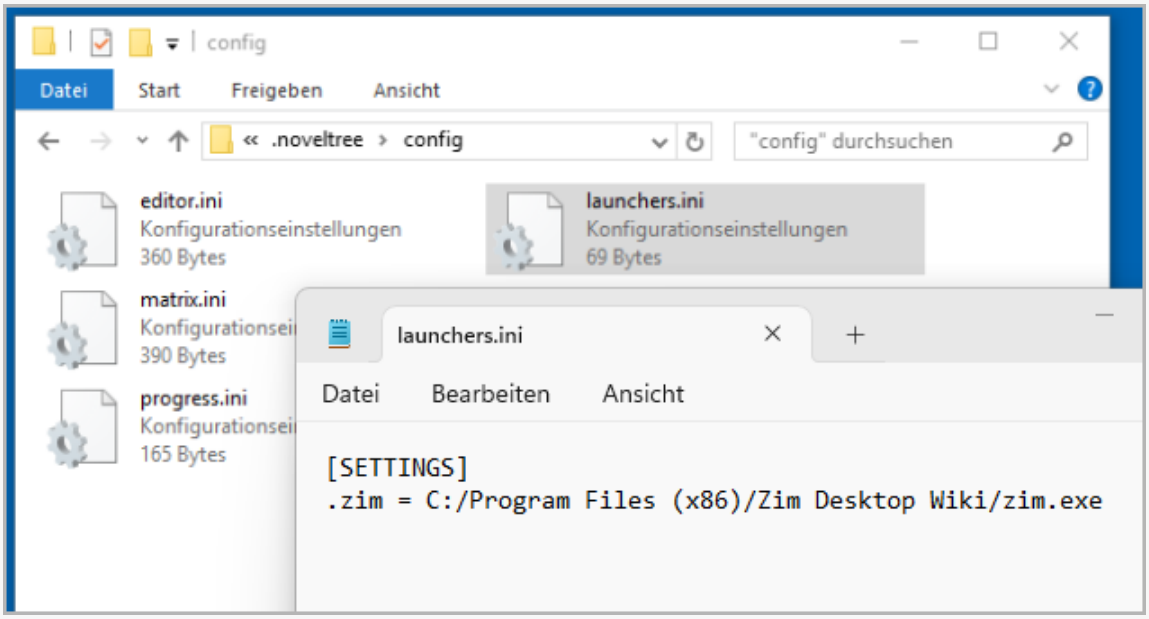
This example shows a setting that makes *novelibre* open text files with the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application instead of the standard text editor:

```
[SETTINGS]
.zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
```



16.3.3 "Sticky note"

The yellow text area is for notes. Changes are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

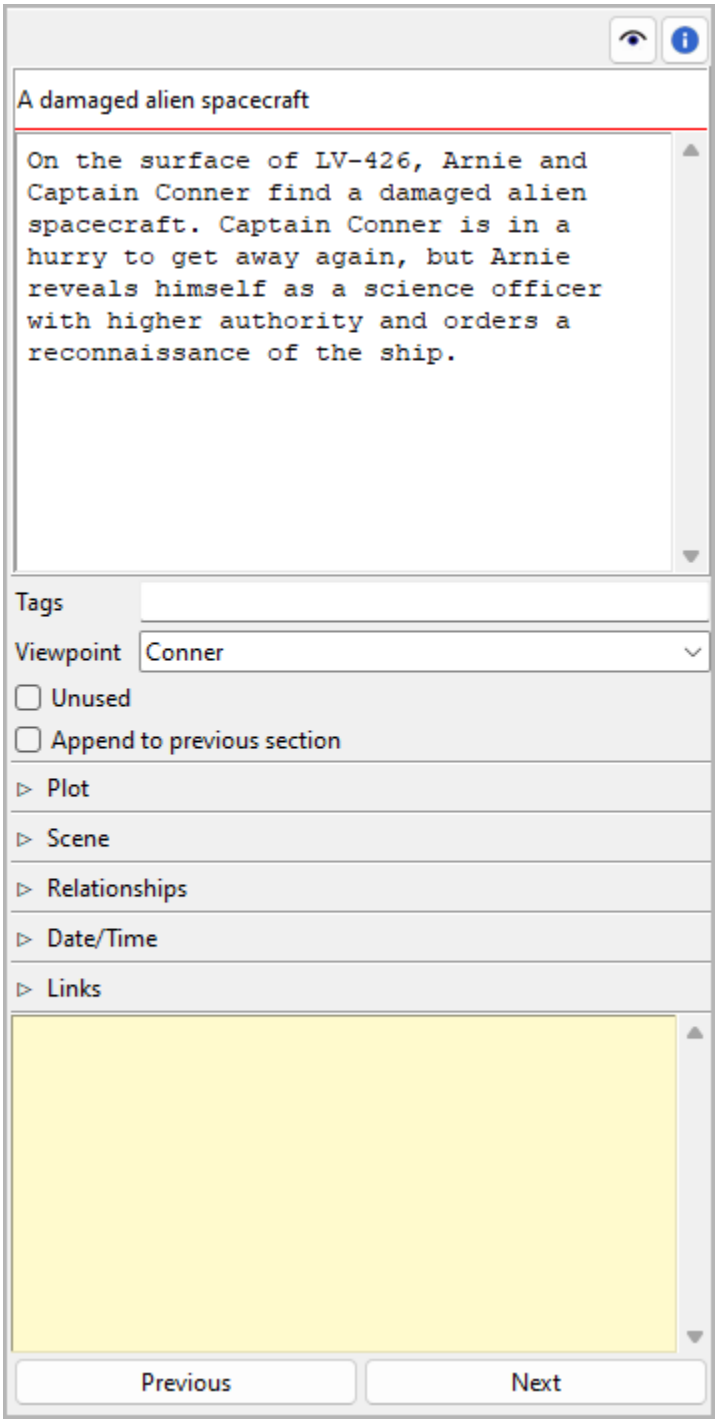
When the "sticky note" of a stage contains text, "N" is displayed in the tree view as a reminder. If the branch of a chapter with stages containing notes is collapsed, the "N" is displayed in the chapter row.

16.3.4 Navigation buttons

- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous stage on the same level in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next stage on the same level in the tree.

16.4 Section properties

The Section properties view opens in the right pane when you select a section in the tree.



16.4.1 Title and description

Title and description are displayed in an editable "index card".

The editing of the title can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the description are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

16.4.2 Tags

Tags are a very freely usable tool for labeling sections in the tree view. Tags do not have to be defined elsewhere, but simply entered in the input field separated by semicolons. Editing can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

> **Caution**
>
> If you want to use a tag more than once, make sure you use the same spelling in the different places.

16.4.3 Viewpoint

The viewpoint character's short name is displayed in the tree view. You can select it from a drop-down list containing all characters in the tree view's sort order.

16.4.4 Unused

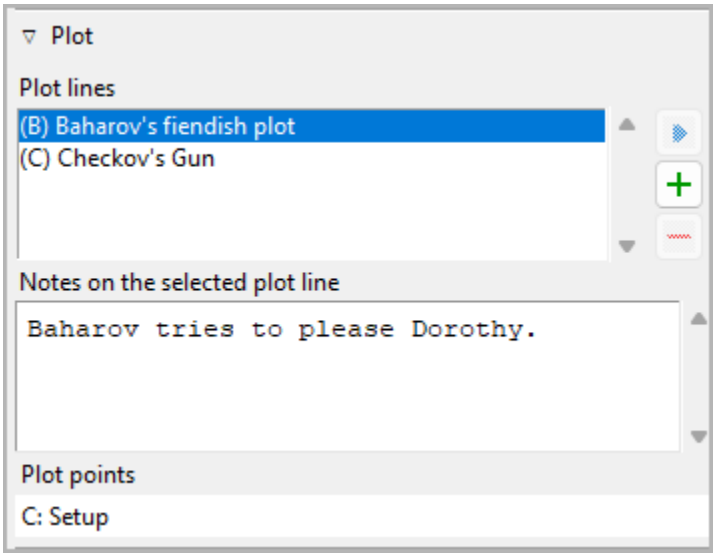
With the **Unused** checkbox, you can change the section type.

16.4.5 Append to previous section

When ticked, there will be no section divider inserted above the selected section in exported documents. The section just starts a new paragraph.

16.4.6 Plot

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



Plot lines

Here you can assign the selected section to the plot lines it belongs to. The assigned plot lines are displayed in a list in the order they are assigned to the section.

> **Tip**
>
> A more convenient way to manage and keep track of plot line assignments is offered by the nv_matrix plugin.

You can also assign a section to a plot line by entering text in the corresponding *Plot line notes* cell of the plot grid.

Add plot line assignment

When clicking on , the "Pick mode" is activated, and the cursor changes to a "plus" shape. By clicking on a plot line, it will be related with the section.

> **Hint**
>
> You can exit the "Pick mode" without selecting an element by clicking on the highlighted status bar, or by pressing the `Esc` key.

Remove plot line assignment

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected plot line is removed from the list.

View the related element

When double-clicking on a plot line, or clicking on , the selected plot line is opened and its properties are displayed.

> **Hint**
>
> You can go back to the initially selected section with .

Plot line notes

You can enter section-related notes for the plot line selected in the list of related plot lines. These notes appear in the plot grid where you also can edit them.

Plot points

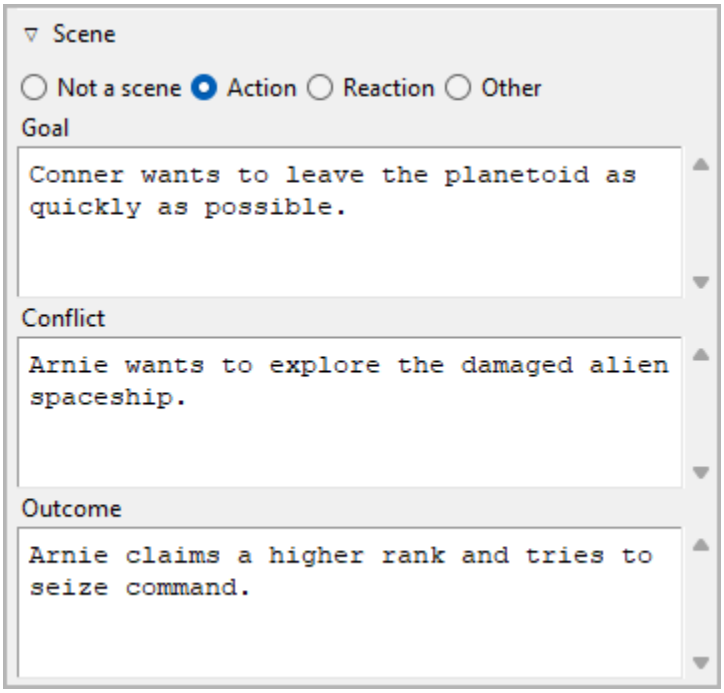
The plot points assigned with the selected section are displayed along with their plot lines.

> **Hint**
>
> To change or clear the plot point assignment, go to the plot point's properties.

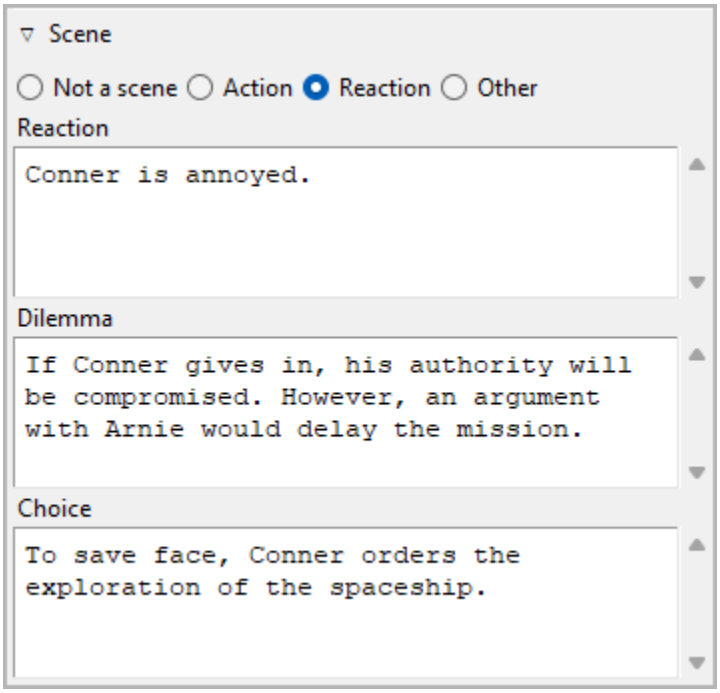
16.4.7 Scene

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.

Here is an example of an "action scene":



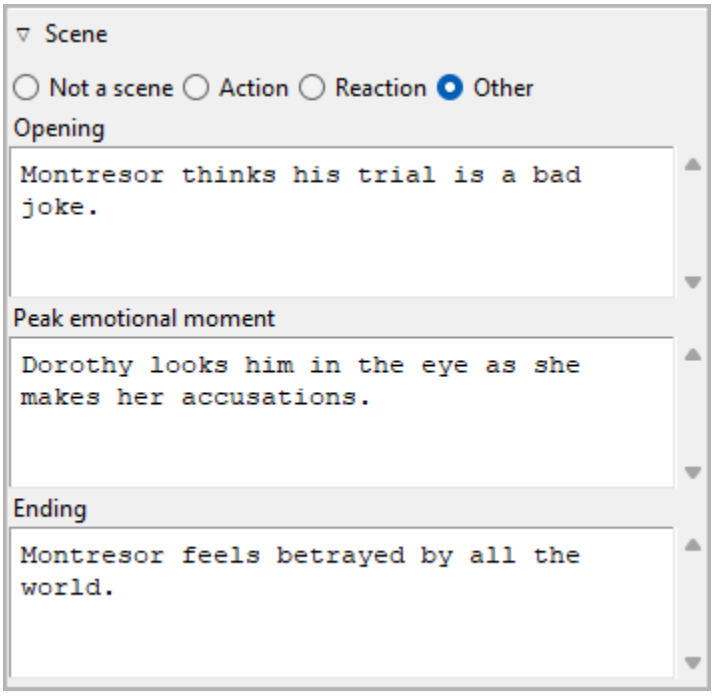
Here is an example of a "reaction scene" or "sequel":



There is a popular theory for "selling writers" that suggests novels are best divided into scenes, alternating between "action scenes" and "reaction scenes", or "scenes" and "sequels". If you want to implement something like this to ensure suspense, you can do so here.

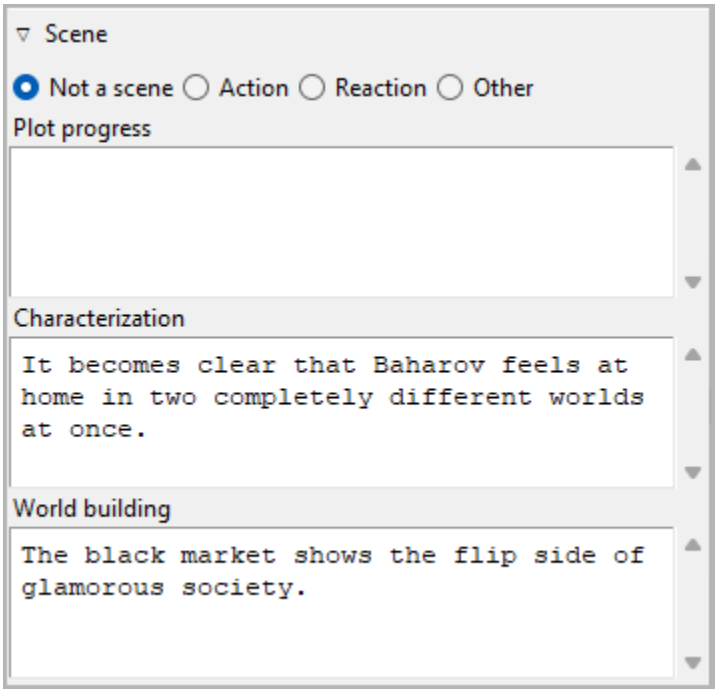
If this is not for you, but you would like to use a different method to set up a dramaturgical scene micro-structure, you can set the section to **Other**, and get three freely named text fields.

Here is an example of a non-standard scene category:



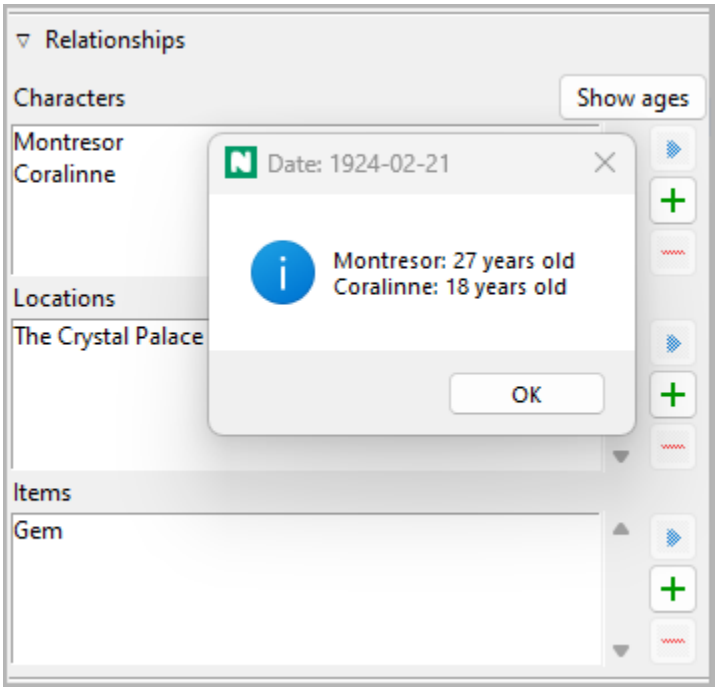
On the other hand, not every section is a scene to which the categories mentioned above apply. Sections can be characterized by mode of discourse (e.g. Narration, Dramatic action, Dialogue, Description, Exposition). So if a section is not staged, you can set the section to **Not a scene**, and get three freely named text fields.

Here is an example of a non-staged section category:



16.4.8 Relationships

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



If you want to associate characters, locations, and items with the section, you can do it here by adding the element to a list of relationships.

Show ages

If a section is dated, you can call up the ages of the related characters who have birth dates.

Add Relationship

When clicking on , the "Pick mode" is activated, and the cursor changes to a "plus" shape. By clicking on a character/location/item, this element will be related with the section.

> **Hint**
>
> You can exit the "Pick mode" without selecting an element by clicking on the highlighted status bar, or by pressing the `Esc` key.

Remove Relationship

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected relationship is removed from the list.

View the related element

When double-clicking on a related element, or clicking on , the selected element is opened and its properties are displayed.

> **Hint**

You can go back to the initially selected section with .

Hint

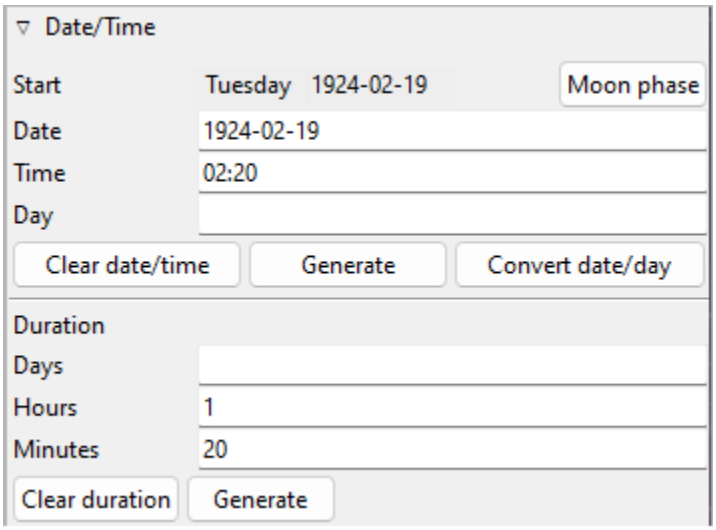
A convenient way to manage and keep track of relationships is offered by the nv_matrix plugin.

16.4.9 Date/Time

Here you can enter information about the selected section's narrative time. Editing can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

Hint

Dedicated timeline software offers a more convenient way of entering date/time and duration information. So if chronology is important to your story, you might want to take a look at the Timeline plugin, or the Aeon Timeline 2 plugin.



Start

If the selected section is a scene, this is when it starts:

Date
: Format: *YYYY-MM-DD*, according to ISO 8601.

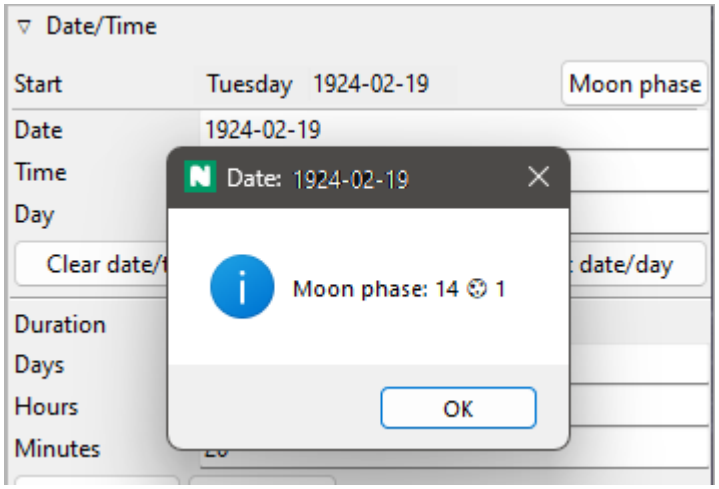
Time
: Format: *hh:mm*, according to ISO 8601.

Day
: Format: Any number. Day "0" is the reference date, if set.

Note

All entries are optional. You can either enter a date, or a day.

Moon phase
If the required date information is set, you can call up the corresponding moon phase.



The moon phase information consists of:

- the phase day (0 to 29, where 0=new moon, 15=full etc.),
- the visible shape,
- the fraction illuminated.

> **Note**
> The moon phase calculation is based on a 'do it in your head' algorithm by John Conway. In its current form, it's only valid for the 20th and 21st centuries.

Clear date/time
This will reset *Date*, *Time*, and *Day* simultaneously.

Generate
This generates date and time from the date/time/duration data of the *previous section*, so the selected section follows directly the previous one.

Convert date/day
If the reference date is set, The unspecific *Day* can be transformed into a specific *Date*, and vice versa.

> **Hint**
> If necessary, you can convert all sections at once in the Book properties view.

Duration

Days
Any number should be accepted.

Hours
If a number greater than 24 is entered, the number of days will be automatically increased.

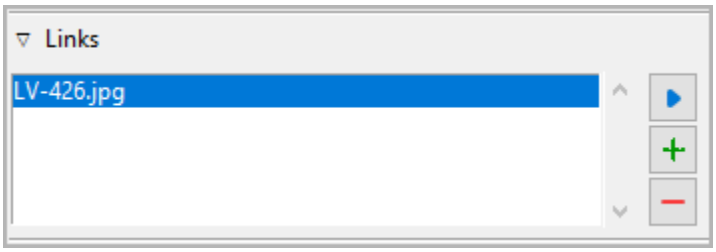
Minutes
If a number greater than 60 is entered, the number of hours will be automatically increased.

Clear duration
This will reset *Days*, *Hours*, and *Minutes* simultaneously.

Generate
This generates the duration from the date/time data of the *next section*, so the next section follows directly the current one.

16.4.10 Links

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



This is a list for image and research document links.

Although *novelibre* holds some character/location/item data, it is not the right application for extensive world building. For this, you may want to use more powerful software, like Zim Desktop Wiki. In this case, *novelibre* allows you to create links to the text files that will take you quickly to the right places in the wiki.

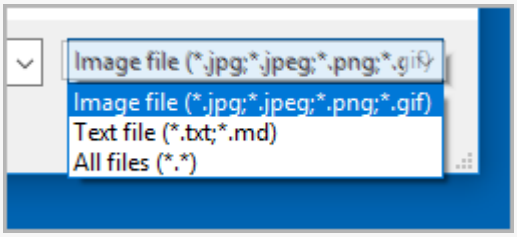
Or you have collected some images that could inspire you when writing. Then simply create links to these images to open them with your system's standard image viewer.

> **Tip**
>
> If you have collected several images for a character in a folder that your standard image viewer can browse through, a single link to any image file is sufficient.

The links are displayed in a list in the order they are entered.

Add Link

When clicking on , a file selection dialog opens. The selected file will be added to the link list.

> **Hint**
>
> By default, the dialog shows image files. For other file types, change the selector in the lower right corner.
>
> 
>

Remove Link

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected link is removed from the list.

Open Link

When double-clicking on a link, or clicking on , the link is opened with the standard application for the link's file type.

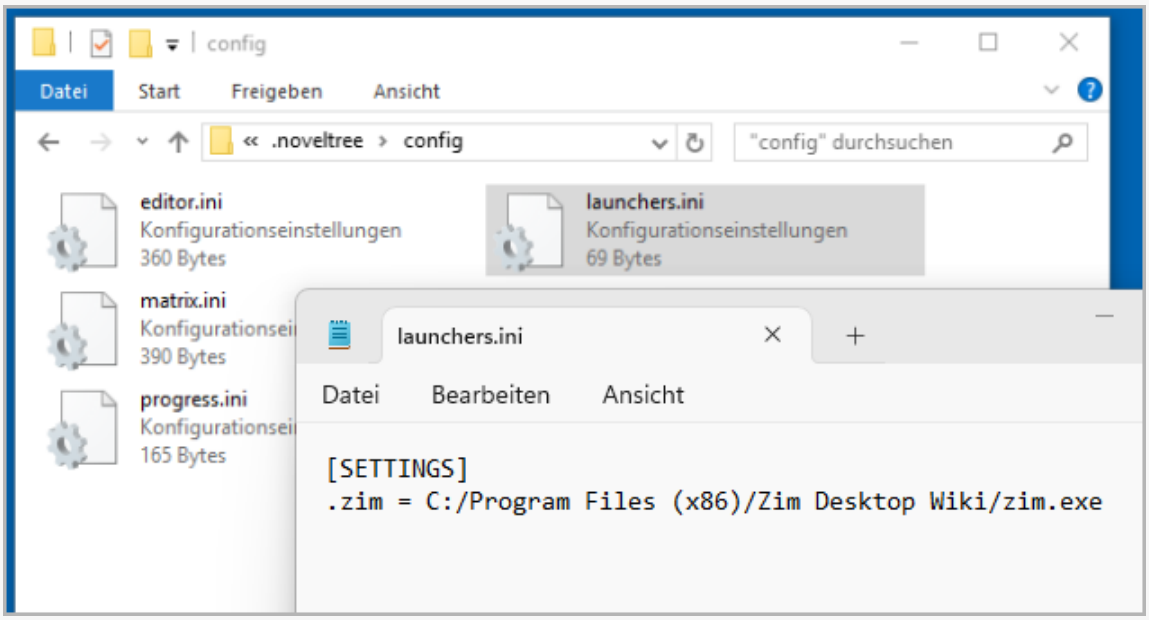
Hint

If you want to open certain linked files with another application than the standard application, you can provide a *novelibre* "launcher" setting. For this, just create a text file named **launchers.ini** in the `.novx/config` directory (where all configuration files are stored). Here you can assign applications to the file extensions.

Zim desktop wiki pages are a special case. For this, the Zim program is assigned to the *.zim* extension.

This example shows a setting that makes *novelibre* open text files with the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application instead of the standard text editor:

```
[SETTINGS]
.zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
```



16.4.11 "Sticky note"

The yellow text area is for notes. Changes are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

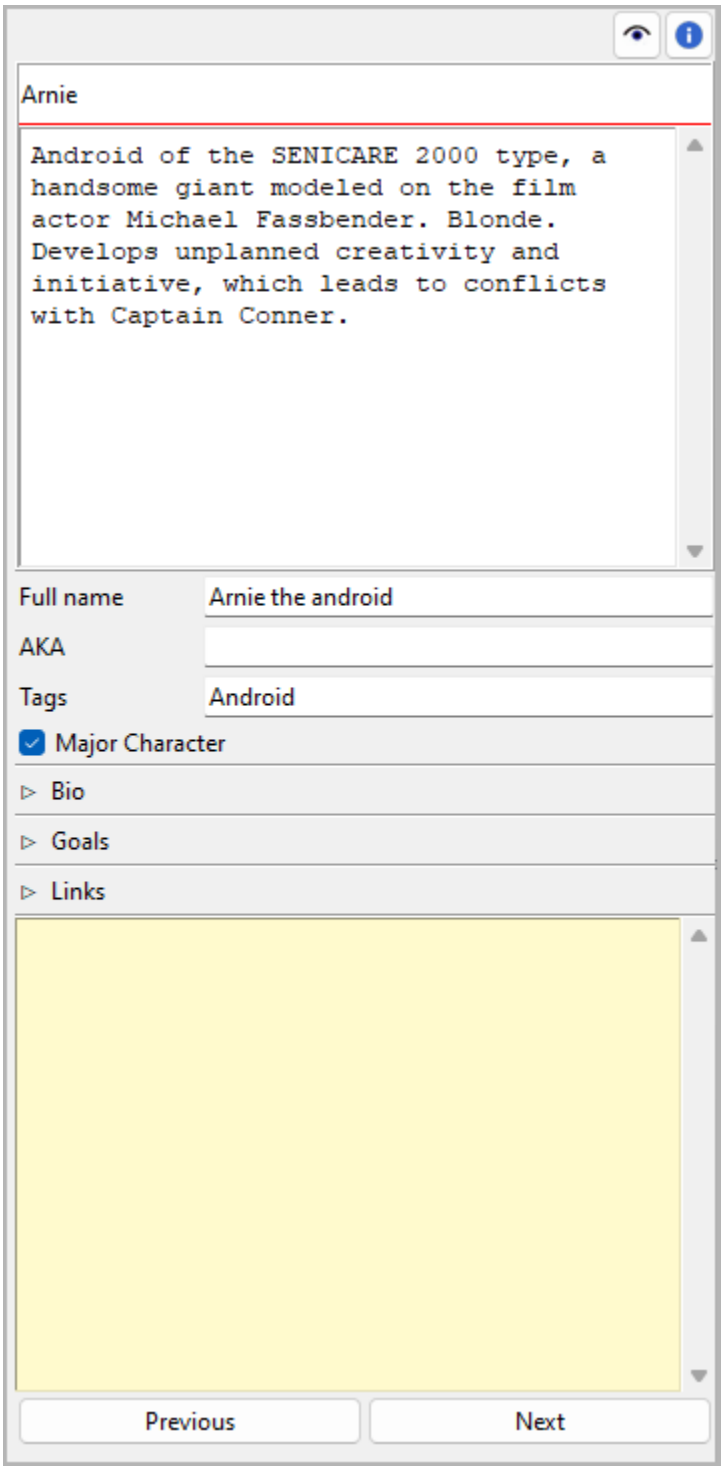
When the "sticky note" of a section contains text, "N" is displayed in the tree view as a reminder. If the branch of a chapter with sections containing notes is collapsed, the "N" is displayed in the chapter row.

16.4.12 Navigation buttons

- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous section in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next section in the tree.

16.5 Character properties

The Character properties view opens in the right pane when you select a character in the tree.



16.5.1 Title and description

Title and description are displayed in an editable "index card".

The editing of the title can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the description are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

16.5.2 Full name

The character's title as shown on the index card is used as a short name at several places. The full name can be entered separately. Editing can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

16.5.3 AKA

This entry field is for alias names. Editing can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

16.5.4 Tags

Tags are a very freely usable tool for labeling characters in the tree view. Tags do not have to be defined elsewhere, but simply entered in the input field separated by semicolons. Editing can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

> **Caution**
>
> If you want to use a tag more than once, make sure you use the same spelling in the different places.

> **Hint**
>
> The nv_zim plugin can adopt keywords when creating a new wiki page for the character. This provides a powerful navigation aid.

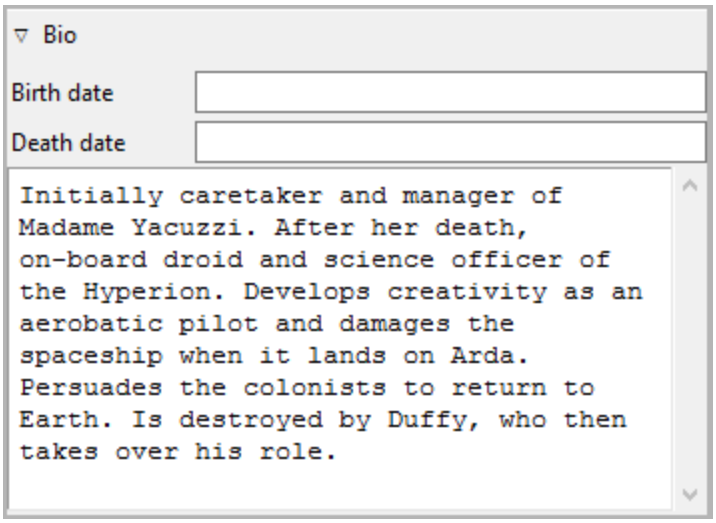
16.5.5 Major Character

With the **Major Character** checkbox you can change the character status.

> **Note**
>
> The character status is only for visual distinction. It has no influence on the program functions. Nevertheless, you can use it to mark viewpoint characters or characters with their own plot lines.

16.5.6 Bio

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.

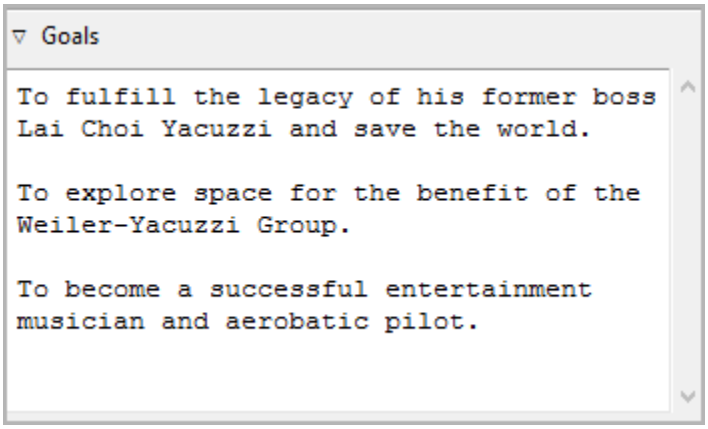


Birth/death date
: Format: *YYYY-MM-DD*, according to ISO 8601.

The editing of the birth and death dates can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the bio are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

16.5.7 Goals

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.

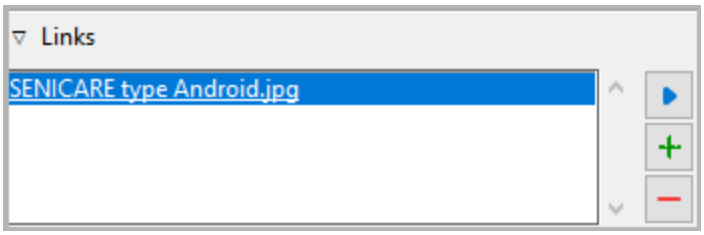


Changes to the goals are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

> **Hint**
>
> This text box can hold any character data that seem important to you. If "Goals" is not the right category for you, you can change the label in the book settings.

16.5.8 Links

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



This is a list for image and research document links.

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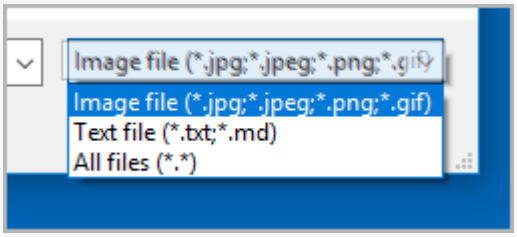
Or you have collected some images that could inspire you when writing. Then simply create links to these images to open them with your system's standard image viewer.

> **Tip**
>
> If you have collected several images for a character in a folder that your standard image viewer can browse through, a single link to any image file is sufficient.

The links are displayed in a list in the order they are entered.

Add Link

When clicking on , a file selection dialog opens. The selected file will be added to the link list.

> **Hint**
>
> By default, the dialog shows image files. For other file types, change the selector in the lower right corner.
>
> 
>

Remove Link

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected link is removed from the list.

Open Link

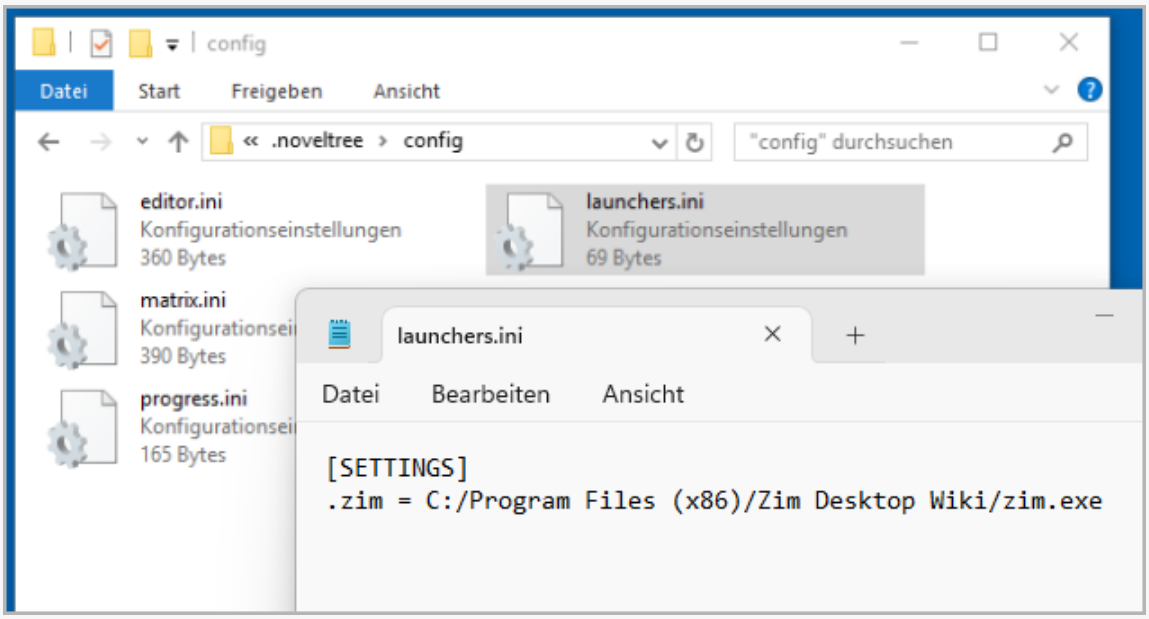
When double-clicking on a link, or clicking on , the link is opened with the standard application for the link's file type.

> **Hint**
>
> If you want to open certain linked files with another application than the standard application, you can provide a *novelibre* "launcher" setting. For this, just create a text file named **launchers.ini** in the `.novx/config` directory (where all configuration files are stored). Here you can assign applications to the file extensions.

Zim desktop wiki pages are a special case. For this, the Zim program is assigned to the *.zim* extension.

This example shows a setting that makes *novelibre* open text files with the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application instead of the standard text editor:

```
[SETTINGS]
.zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
```



16.5.9 "Sticky note"

The yellow text area is for notes. Changes are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

When the "sticky note" of a character contains text, "N" is displayed in the tree view as a reminder.

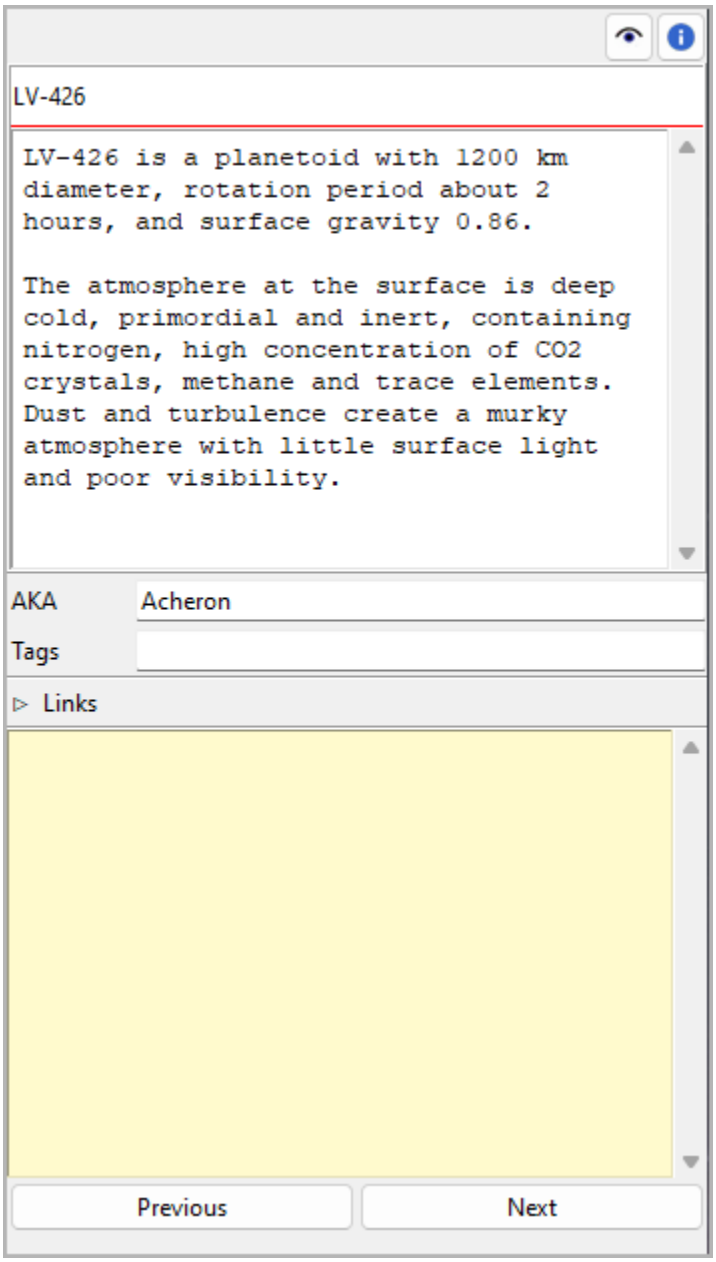
16.5.10 Navigation buttons

- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous character in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next character in the tree.

16.6 Location/item properties

The Location/item properties view opens in the right pane when you select a location or an item in the tree.

16.6.1 Title and description



Title and description are displayed in an editable "index card".

The editing of the title can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the description are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

16.6.2 AKA

This entry field is for alias names. Editing can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

16.6.3 Tags

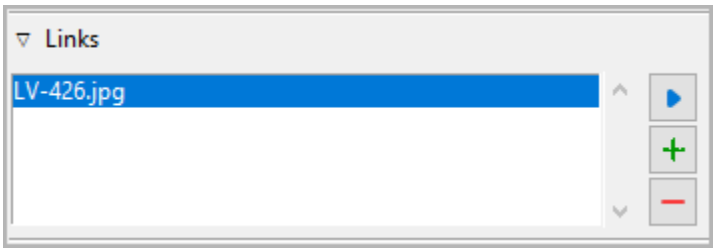
Tags are a very freely usable tool for labeling locations and items in the tree view. Tags do not have to be defined elsewhere, but simply entered in the input field separated by semicolons. Editing can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key.

> **Caution**
>
> If you want to use a tag more than once, make sure you use the same spelling in the different places.

> **Hint**
>
> The nv_zim plugin can adopt keywords when creating a new wiki page for the location or item. This provides a powerful navigation aid.

16.6.4 Links

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



This is a list for image and research document links.

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Or you have collected some images that could inspire you when writing. Then simply create links to these images to open them with your system's standard image viewer.

> **Tip**
>
> If you have collected several images for a character in a folder that your standard image viewer can browse through, a single link to any image file is sufficient.

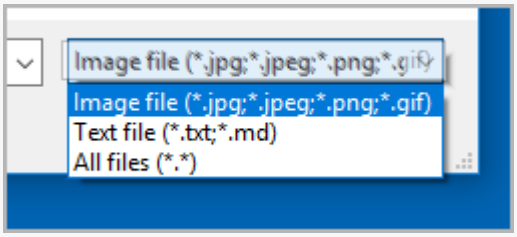
The links are displayed in a list in the order they are entered.

Add Link

When clicking on , a file selection dialog opens. The selected file will be added to the link list.

Hint

By default, the dialog shows image files. For other file types, change the selector in the lower right corner.



Remove Link

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected link is removed from the list.

Open Link

When double-clicking on a link, or clicking on , the link is opened with the standard application for the link's file type.

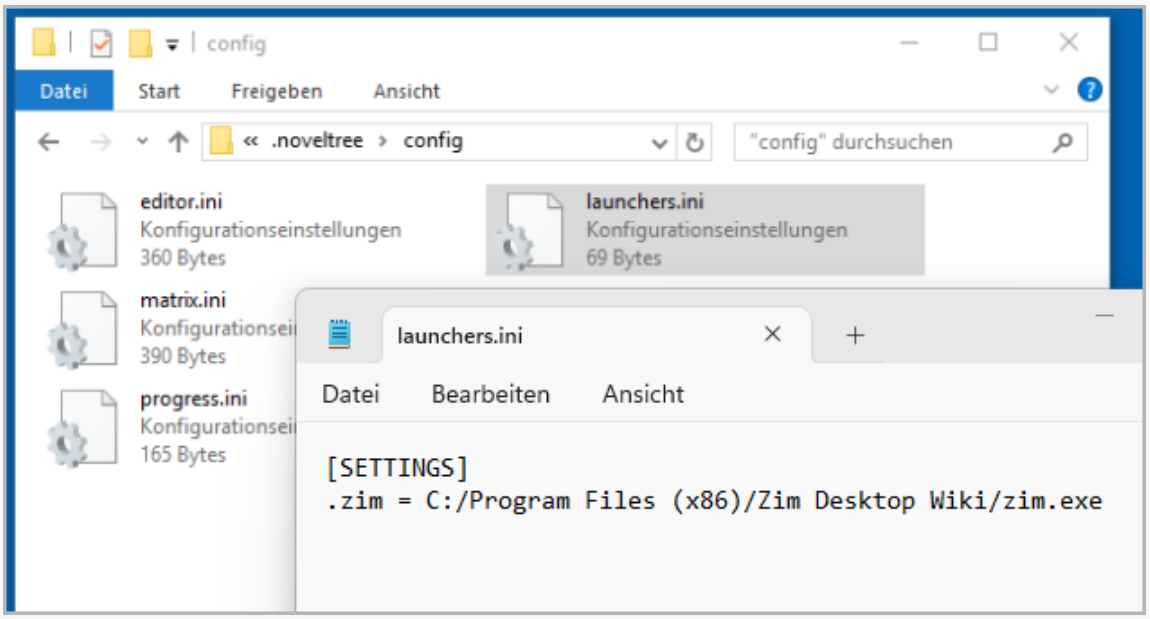
Hint

If you want to open certain linked files with another application than the standard application, you can provide a *novelibre* "launcher" setting. For this, just create a text file named **launchers.ini** in the `.novx/config` directory (where all configuration files are stored). Here you can assign applications to the file extensions.

Zim desktop wiki pages are a special case. For this, the Zim program is assigned to the *.zim* extension.

This example shows a setting that makes *novelibre* open text files with the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application instead of the standard text editor:

```
[SETTINGS]
.zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
```



16.6.5 "Sticky note"

The yellow text area is for notes. Changes are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

When the "sticky note" of a location or item contains text, "N" is displayed in the tree view as a reminder. If the branch of a chapter with sections containing notes is collapsed, the "N" is displayed in the chapter row.

16.6.6 Navigation buttons

Location view

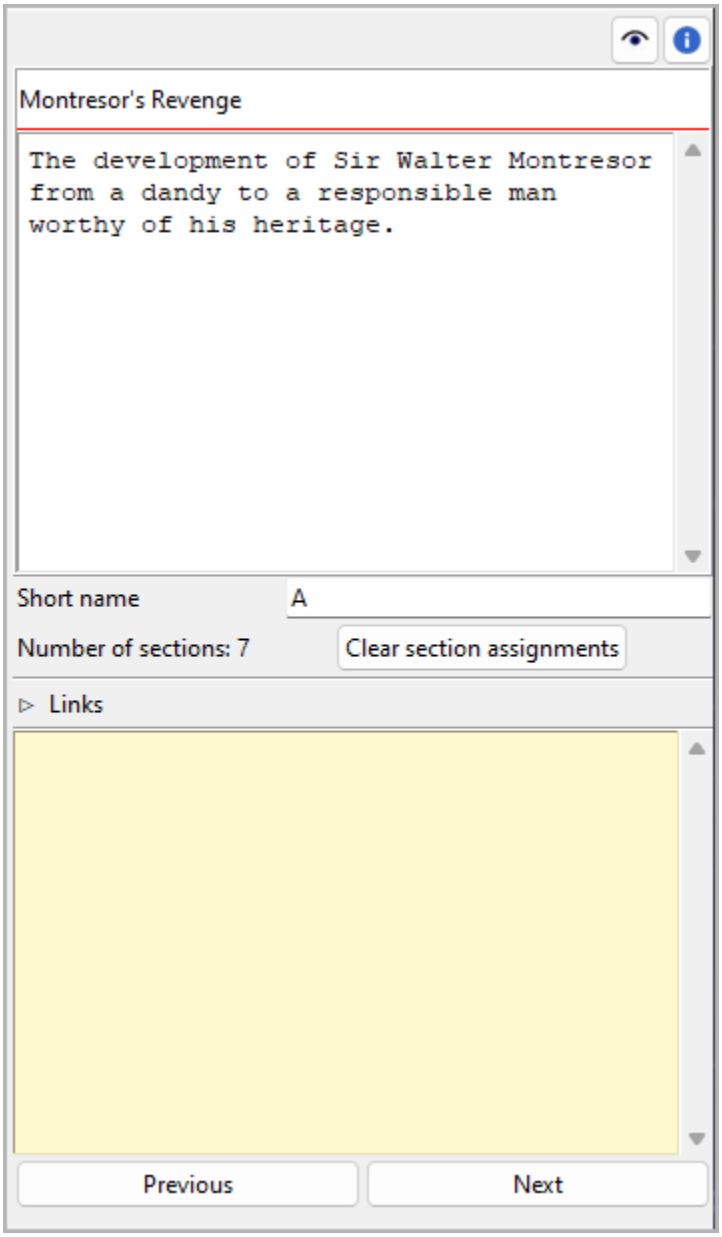
- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous location in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next location in the tree.

Item view

- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous item in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next item in the tree.

16.7 Plot line properties

The Plot line properties view opens in the right pane when you select a plot line in the tree.



16.7.1 Title and description

Title and description are displayed in an editable "index card".

The editing of the title can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the description are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

16.7.2 Short name

Be sure to enter a short name to be displayed as a reference in the tree. A single character like "A", "B", "C" is recommended.

The following example shows plot line short names as displayed in the tree:

	N	Plot lines	Plot points
Book			
Chapter 1			
ACT 1			
Montresor returns from a long journey		A	The normal world
Dorothy shows up		A	The lie Montresor believes
Inciting Incident			
Dorothy meets Baharov		B;C	C: Setup
Montresor at the Gambling Hall		A	Montresor's Ghost appears
Chapter 2		A;B	A: The characteristic moment;B: Things are going for the worse
Chapter 3		A	
Chapter 4		B	
Chapter 5		B	
Chapter 6			
Chapter 7		B;A;C	C: Payoff
Characters			
Locations			
The Crystal Palace			
Items			
Gem			
Plot lines			
(A) Montresor's Revenge			
(B) Baharov's fiendish plot			
(C) Checkov's Gun			

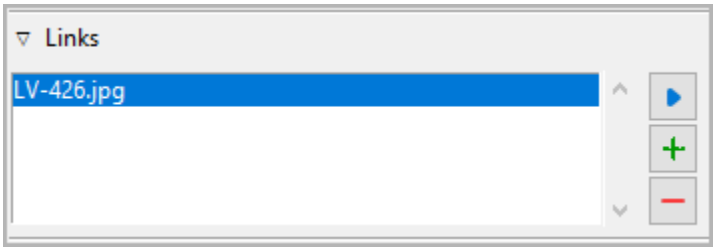
16.7.3 Section assignments

The number of sections that belong to the selected plot line is shown below the "Short name" entry. The assignments can be made in the section properties view. You can unlink all sections from the selected plot line at once by clicking on the **Clear section assignments** button.

> **Hint**
>
> A convenient way to manage and keep track of section assignments is offered by the nv_matrix plugin.

16.7.4 Links

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



This is a list for image and research document links.

Although *novelibre* holds some character/location/item data, it is not the right application for extensive world building. For this, you may want to use more powerful software, like Zim Desktop Wiki. In this case, *novelibre* allows you to

create links to the text files that will take you quickly to the right places in the wiki.

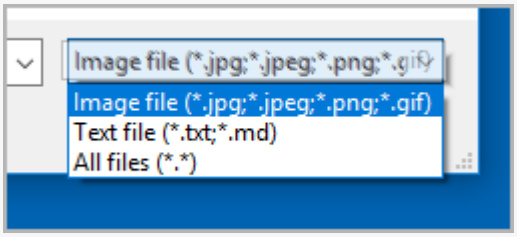
Or you have collected some images that could inspire you when writing. Then simply create links to these images to open them with your system's standard image viewer.

> **Tip**
>
> If you have collected several images for a character in a folder that your standard image viewer can browse through, a single link to any image file is sufficient.

The links are displayed in a list in the order they are entered.

Add Link

When clicking on , a file selection dialog opens. The selected file will be added to the link list.

> **Hint**
>
> By default, the dialog shows image files. For other file types, change the selector in the lower right corner.
>
> 
>

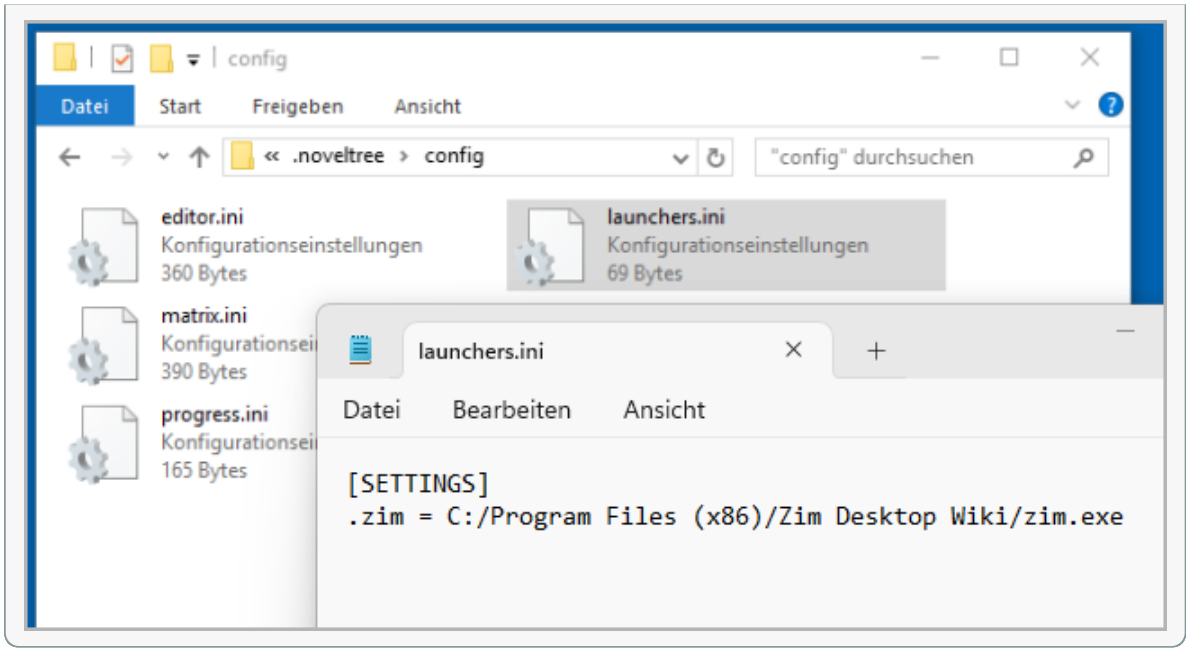
Remove Link

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected link is removed from the list.

Open Link

When double-clicking on a link, or clicking on , the link is opened with the standard application for the link's file type.

> **Hint**
>
> If you want to open certain linked files with another application than the standard application, you can provide a *novelibre* "launcher" setting. For this, just create a text file named **launchers.ini** in the `.novx/config` directory (where all configuration files are stored). Here you can assign applications to the file extensions.
>
> Zim desktop wiki pages are a special case. For this, the Zim program is assigned to the *.zim* extension.
>
> This example shows a setting that makes *novelibre* open text files with the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application instead of the standard text editor:
>
> ```
> [SETTINGS]
> .zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
> ```



16.7.5 "Sticky note"

The yellow text area is for notes. Changes are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

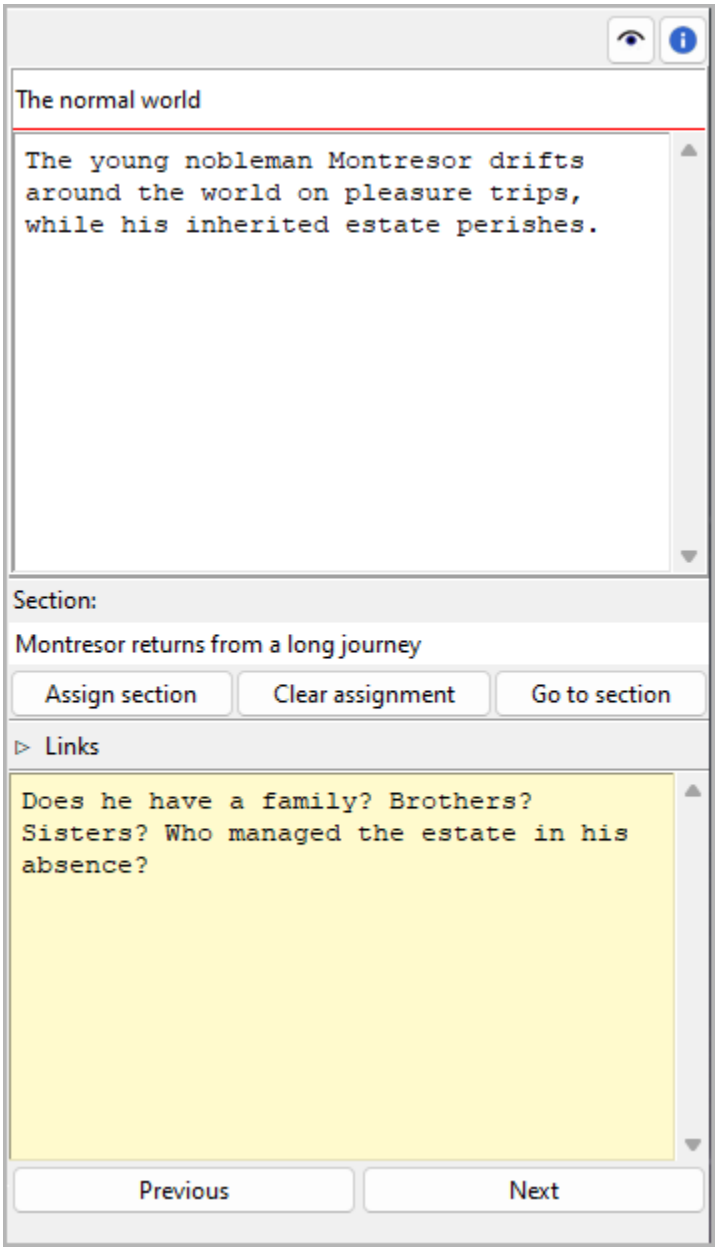
When the "sticky note" of a plot line contains text, "N" is displayed in the tree view as a reminder. If the branch of a plot line with plot points containing notes is collapsed, the "N" is displayed in the plot line row.

16.7.6 Navigation buttons

- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous plot line in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next plot line in the tree.

16.8 Plot point properties

The Plot point properties view opens in the right pane when you select a plot point in the tree.



16.8.1 Title and description

Title and description are displayed in an editable "index card".

The editing of The editing of the title can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the description are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

16.8.2 Assigned section

You can connect the plot point to a section in the book. The label below "Section" displays the section title.

Assign section

When clicking on the **Assign section** button, the "Pick mode" is activated, and the cursor changes to a "plus" shape. By clicking on a section, this section will be assigned to the plot point.

> **Hint**
>
> You can exit the "Pick mode" without selecting a section by clicking on the highlighted status bar, or by pressing the `Esc` key.

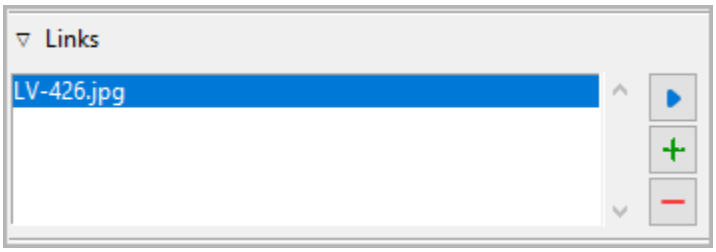
Clear assignment
If a section is assigned to the plot point, you can disconnect it by clicking on the **Clear assignment** button.

Go to section
When clicking on the **Go to section** button, the selected section is opened and its properties are displayed.

> **Hint**
>
> You can go back to the initially selected plot point with .

16.8.3 Links

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



This is a list for image and research document links.

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Or you have collected some images that could inspire you when writing. Then simply create links to these images to open them with your system's standard image viewer.

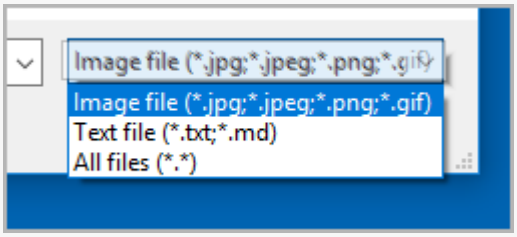
> **Tip**
>
> If you have collected several images for a character in a folder that your standard image viewer can browse through, a single link to any image file is sufficient.

The links are displayed in a list in the order they are entered.

Add Link

When clicking on , a file selection dialog opens. The selected file will be added to the link list.

> **Hint**
>
> By default, the dialog shows image files. For other file types, change the selector in the lower right corner.



Remove Link

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected link is removed from the list.

Open Link

When double-clicking on a link, or clicking on , the link is opened with the standard application for the link's file type.

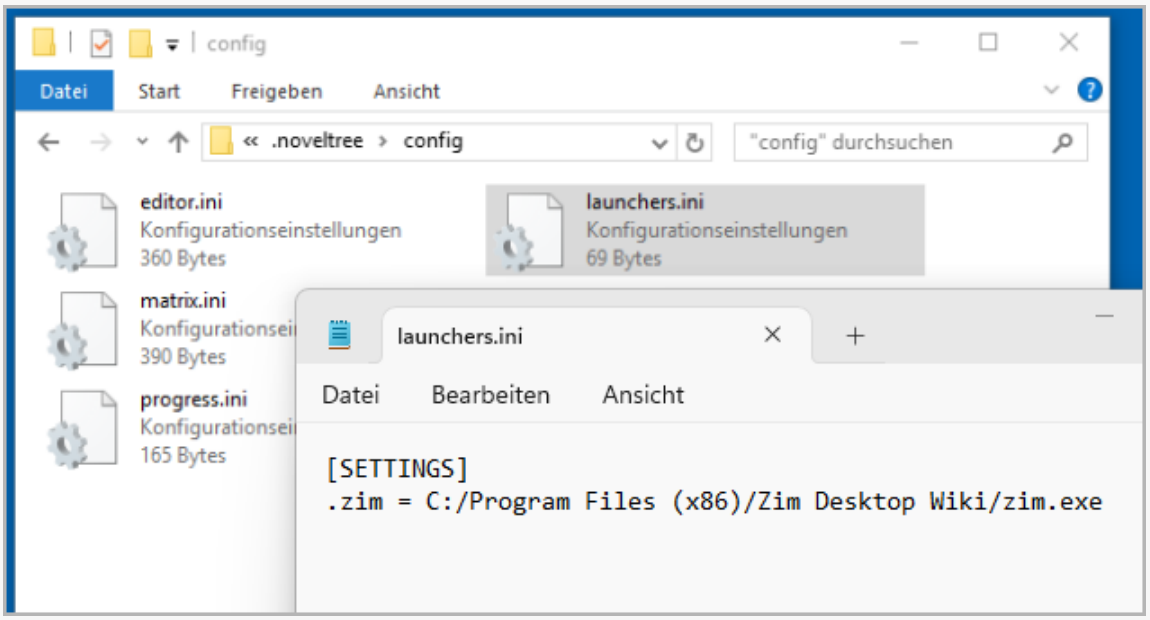
Hint

If you want to open certain linked files with another application than the standard application, you can provide a *novelibre* "launcher" setting. For this, just create a text file named **launchers.ini** in the `.novx/config` directory (where all configuration files are stored). Here you can assign applications to the file extensions.

Zim desktop wiki pages are a special case. For this, the Zim program is assigned to the *.zim* extension.

This example shows a setting that makes *novelibre* open text files with the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application instead of the standard text editor:

```
[SETTINGS]
.zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
```



16.8.4 "Sticky note"

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When the "sticky note" of a plot point contains text, "N" is displayed in the tree view as a reminder. If the branch of a plot line with plot points containing notes is collapsed, the "N" is displayed in the plot line row.

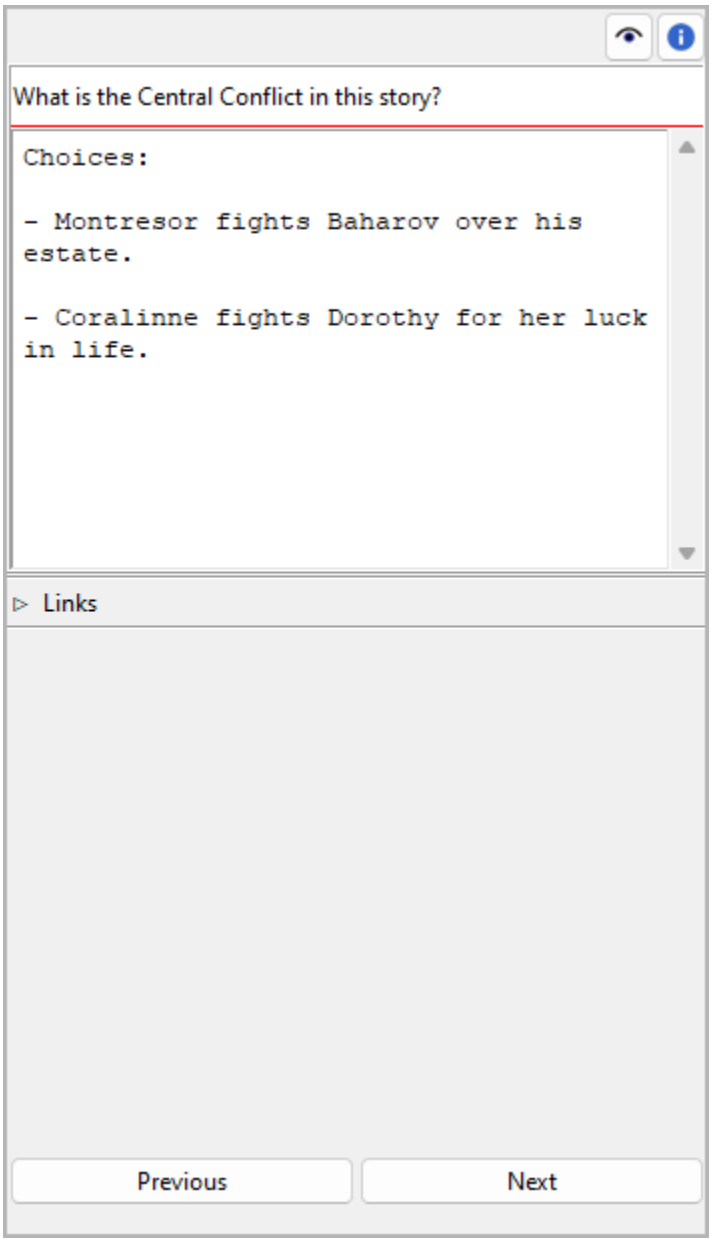
16.8.5 Navigation buttons

- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous plot point in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next plot point in the tree.

16.9 Project note properties

The Project note properties view opens in the right pane when you select a project note in the tree.

16.9.1 Title and content

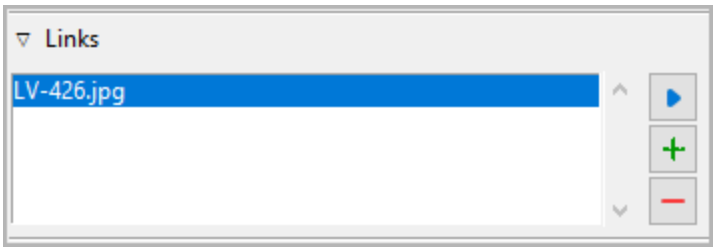


Title and content are displayed in an editable "index card".

The editing of the title can be completed by pressing the `Enter` key. Changes to the content are applied when the mouse is clicked anywhere outside the text input field.

16.9.2 Links

Expand or collapse this frame by clicking on the label.



This is a list for image and research document links.

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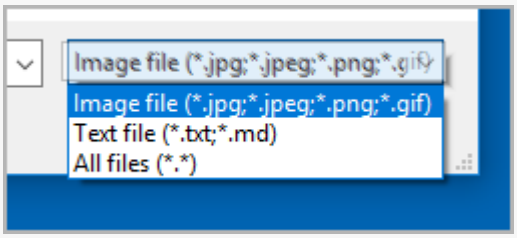
Or you have collected some images that could inspire you when writing. Then simply create links to these images to open them with your system's standard image viewer.

> **Tip**
>
> If you have collected several images for a character in a folder that your standard image viewer can browse through, a single link to any image file is sufficient.

The links are displayed in a list in the order they are entered.

Add Link

When clicking on , a file selection dialog opens. The selected file will be added to the link list.

> **Hint**
>
> By default, the dialog shows image files. For other file types, change the selector in the lower right corner.
>
> 
>

Remove Link

When clicking on or pressing the `Del` key, the selected link is removed from the list.

Open Link

When double-clicking on a link, or clicking on , the link is opened with the standard application for the link's file type.

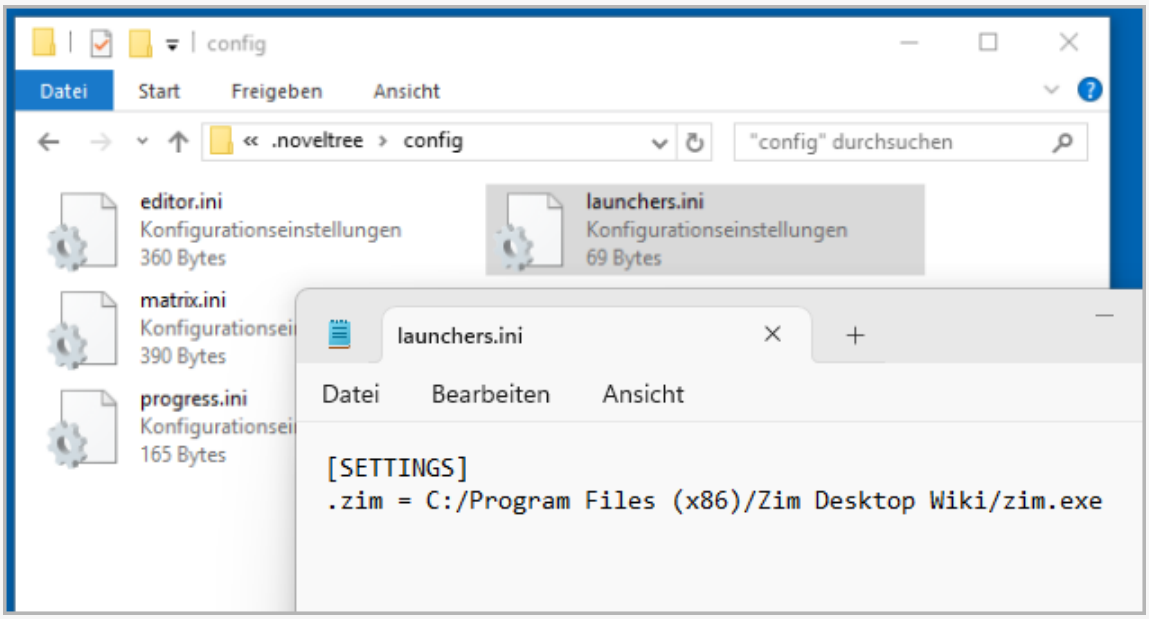
> **Hint**
>
> If you want to open certain linked files with another application than the standard application, you can provide a *novelibre* "launcher" setting. For this, just create a text file named **launchers.ini** in the `.novx/config`

directory (where all configuration files are stored). Here you can assign applications to the file extensions.

Zim desktop wiki pages are a special case. For this, the Zim program is assigned to the *.zim* extension.

This example shows a setting that makes *novelibre* open text files with the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application instead of the standard text editor:

```
[SETTINGS]
.zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
```



16.9.3 Navigation buttons

- **Previous** lets you navigate to the previous project note in the tree.
- **Next** lets you navigate to the next project note in the tree.

CHAPTER

SEVENTEEN

PLUGINS

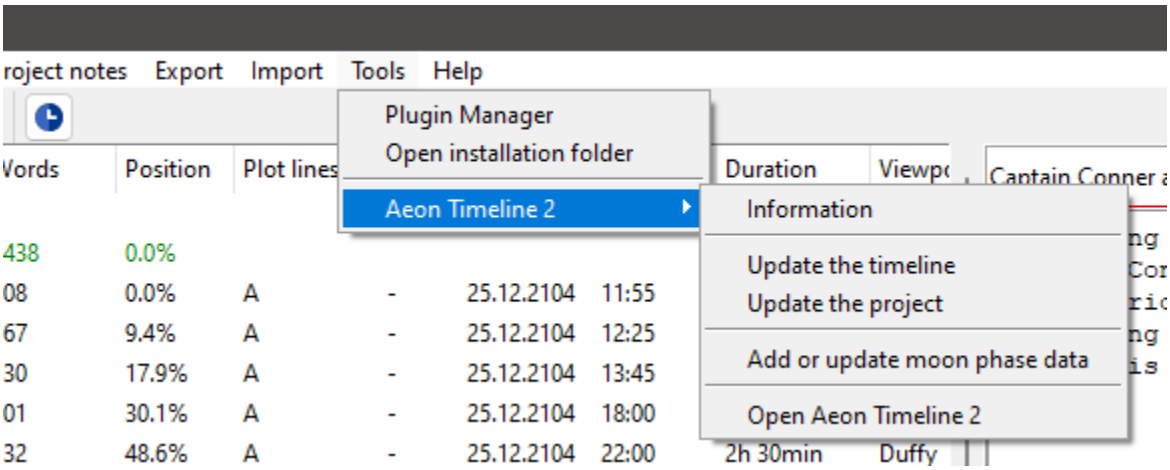
Deutsch

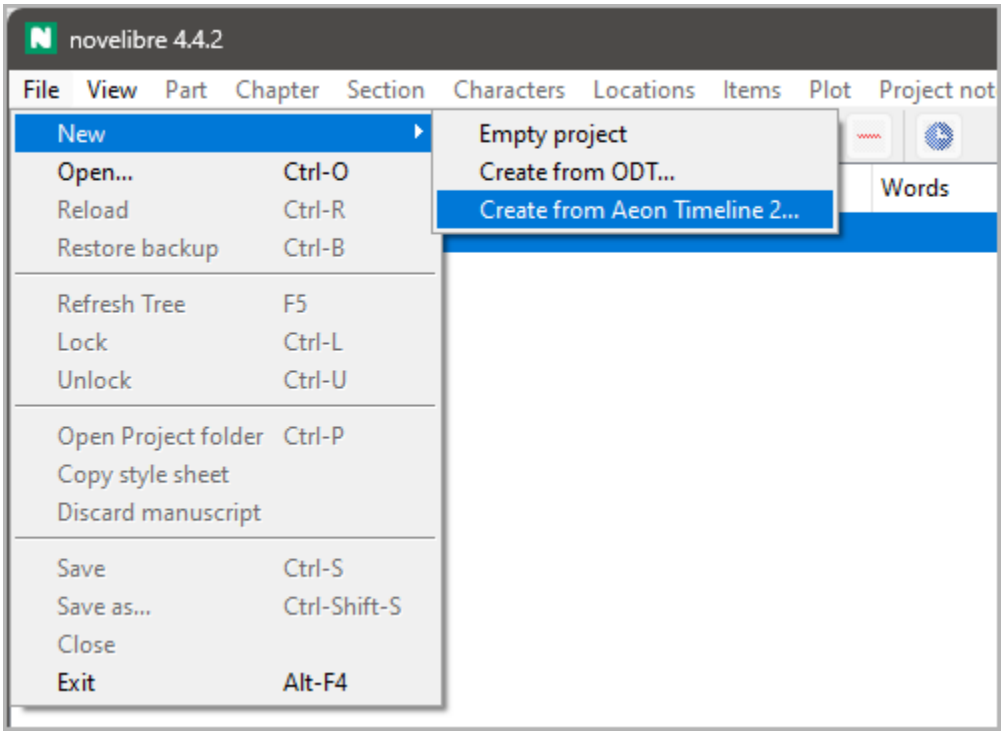
17.1 nv_aeon2

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_aeon2 release. You can open it with **Help > Aeon 2 plugin Online help**.

The plugin adds a **Timeline** entry to the *novelibre* **Tools** menu, a **Create from Aeon Timeline 2…** to the **File > New** submenu, and an **Aeon 2 plugin Online Help** entry to the **Help** menu. The Toolbar gets a button.





17.1.1 Installing the Aeon Timeline 2 custom template

After installation, you can copy a "novelibre.xml" template to the *Aeon Timeline 2* custom template folder. The easiest way is to create new timelines based on this template. It provides the entities and event properties that are converted to *novelibre* by default.

You find the customized template in the *novelibre* installation directory under

`c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\nv_aeon2_sample\`

Just copy it into

`AppData\Local\Scribble Code\Aeon Timeline 2\CustomTemplates`.

> **Hint**
>
> The `<your user name>\AppData` folder is hidden, so you might have to go to the *Explorer* settings first to enable *Show hidden files*. Just disable this again after successfully having installed the custom template.

The next time you start *Aeon Timeline 2*, the new template appears in the *Custom Templates* area.

17.1.2 Command reference

Tools > Aeon Timeline 2 > Information

Show information about an existing *Aeon Timeline 2* project, if any. *Aeon Timeline 2* and *novelibre* file dates are compared.

Tools > Aeon Timeline 2 > Update the timeline

If a timeline exists, update it from *novelibre*.

Tools > Aeon Timeline 2 > Update the project

Update the *novelibre* project from the timeline, if existing.

Tools > Aeon Timeline 2 > Add or update moon phase data

The "Moon phase" event property consists of:

- the phase day (0 to 29, where 0=new moon, 15=full etc.),
- the visible shape,
- the fraction illuminated.

> **Note**
>
> The moon phase calculation is based on a 'do it in your head' algorithm by John Conway. In its current form, it's only valid for the 20th and 21st centuries.

Tools > Aeon Timeline 2 > Open Aeon Timeline 2

Same as clicking on the button on the toolbar.

Open the project's timeline, if existing, with the *Aeon Timeline 2* application. Depending on the configuration (see below), the project is automatically locked.

File > New > Create from Aeon Timeline 2...

Open a file dialog to select a timeline. If no *novelibre* project with the timeline's file name exists, create a new one from the timeline.

17.1.3 Control conversion

Prepare your timeline for export

After installation, you can copy a "novelibre" template to the *Aeon Timeline 2* custom template folder. The easiest way is to create new timelines based on this template. It provides the entities and event properties that are converted to *novelibre* by default.

For existing timelines you have two choices:

- Option 1: Add or rename the required entities and event properties in the Aeon Timeline 2 settings.
- Option 2: Customize the *nv_aeon2* configuration to fit your timeline, see *Custom configuration*.

17.1.4 Synchronization in detail

Known limitations

- "Narrative" events that begin before 0001-01-01 in the timeline, will not be synchronized with *novelibre*, because *novelibre* can not handle these dates.
- The same applies to the section duration in this case, i.e. the event duration in Timeline and the section duration in *novelibre* may differ.

Conversion rules for newly created novelibre projects

The names/column labels refer to timelines based on the "novelibre" template.

- If an *Aeon* event title occurs more than once, the program aborts with an error message.
- Events assigned to the "Narrative" arc are converted to regular sections.
- New sections are put into a new chapter named "New sections".
- All sections are sorted chronologically.
- The section status is "Outline".
- The event title is used as section title (*).
- The start date is used as section date/time, if the start year is 1 or above.
- The section duration is calculated, if the start year is 1 or above.
- Event tags are converted to section tags, if any (*).
- "Descriptions" are imported as section descriptions, if any (*).
- "Notes" are used as section notes, if any (*).
- "Participants" are imported as characters, if any (*).
- "Locations" are imported, if any (*).
- "Items" are imported, if any (*).

Update rules for existing novelibre projects

- Only sections that have the same title as an event are updated.
- If an *Aeon* event title occurs more than once, the converter aborts with an error message.
- If a *novelibre* section title occurs more than once, the converter aborts with an error message.
- Sections are marked "unused" if the associated event is deleted in *Aeon*.
- Section date, section time, and section duration are updated.
- Non-empty section description and section tags are updated.
- Notes of events with a matching title are appended to the section notes.
- The start date is overwritten, if the start year is 1 or above.
- The section duration is overwritten, if the start year is 1 or above.
- New "Normal" type sections are created from "Narrative" events, if missing.
- New sections are put into a new chapter named "New sections".
- New plot lines, characters, locations, and items are added, if assigned to "Narrative" events.
- Arc, character, location, and item relationships are updated, if the entity names match.
- When processing unspecific "day/hour/minute" information, the default date from the *novelibre* project is used. f there is no default date set, "today" is used.

Update rules for Aeon Timeline 2 projects

- If an *Aeon* event title occurs more than once, the converter aborts with an error message.
- If a *novelibre* section title occurs more than once, the converter aborts with an error message.
- Event date/time and event span are updated, if the start year is 1 or above.
- Updated event span is specified in days/hours/minutes as in *novelibre*.
- Non-empty event description and event tags are updated.
- Event properties "Description" and "Notes" are created, if missing.
- Events created or updated from "Normal" sections are assigned to the *Narrative* arc.
- "Narrative" events are removed if the associated section is deleted in *novelibre*.
- Entity types "Arc", "Character", "Location", and "Item" are created, if missing.
- A "Narrative" arc is created, if missing.
- A "Storyline" arc role is created, if missing.
- New arcs, characters, locations, and items are added, if assigned to sections.
- Arc, character, location, and item relationships are updated, if the entity names match.
- When creating events from sections without any date/time information, they get the default date from the *novelibre* project, and are sorted in reading order. If there is no default date set, "today" is used.
- When processing unspecific "day/hour/minute" information, the default date from the *novelibre* project is used for date calculation. If there is no default date set, "today" is used as reference date.

17.1.5 Custom configuration

You can override the default settings by providing a configuration file. Be always aware that faulty entries may cause program errors.

Global configuration

An optional global configuration file named `nv_aeon2.ini` an be placed in the configuration directory of the installation. It is applied to any project. Its entries override nv_aeon2's built-in constants. This is the path: `c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\config\nv_aeon2.ini`

Local project configuration

An optional project configuration file named `nv_aeon2.ini` can be placed in your project directory, i.e. the folder containing your *novelibre* and *Aeon Timeline 2* project files. It is only applied to this project. Its entries override aeon2nv's built-in constants as well as the global configuration, if any.

How to provide/modify a configuration file

You find the a sample configuration file with the *nv_aeon2* default values in the *novelibre* installation directory under

`c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\nv_aeon2_sample\`

You best make a copy and edit it.

- The SETTINGS section mainly refers to custom property, role, and type names.
- Comment lines begin with a # number sign. In the example, they refer to the code line immediately above.

This is the configuration file explained:

```
[SETTINGS]

narrative_arc = Narrative

# Name of the user-defined "Narrative" arc.

property_description = Description

# Name of the user-defined section description property.

property_notes = Notes

# Name of the user-defined section notes property.

property_moonphase = Moon phase

# Name of the user-defined moon phase property.

type_arc = Arc

# Name of the user-defined "Arc" type

type_character = Character

# Name of the user-defined "Character" type

type_location = Location

# Name of the user-defined "Location" type

type_item = Item

# Name of the user-defined "Item" type

role_arc = Arc

# Name of the user-defined role for regular arcs.

role_plotline = Storyline

# Name of the user-defined role for plot line arcs.

role_character = Participant

# Name of the user-defined role for characters in a section.

role_location = Location

# Name of the user-defined role for section locations.

role_item = Item

# Name of the user-defined role for items in a section.
```

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```
color_section = Red

# Color of new section events

color_event = Yellow

# Color of new non-section events


[OPTIONS]

add_moonphase = No

# Yes: Add the moon phase to the event properties.
# No: Update moon phase, if already defined as event property.

lock_on_export = No

# Yes: Lock the novelibre project when opening the timeline.
# No: Do not lock the novelibre project when opening the timeline.
```

Note

Your custom configuration file does not have to contain all the entries listed above. The changed entries are sufficient.

Deutsch

17.2 nv_collection

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_collection release. You can open it with **Help > Collection plugin Online help**.

If you have several *novelibre* projects, you can manage them as books in a collection, also organized by series. A collection gives you quick access to your projects.

17.2.1 Start the collection manager

Open the collection manager from the main menu: **File > Collection**.

17.2.2 Open a collection

By default, the latest collection selected is preset. You can change it with **File > Open**.

17.2.3 Create a new collection

With **File > New**, you can create a new collection. This will close the current collection and open a file dialog asking for the location and file name of the collection to create. Once you specified a valid file path, a blank collection appears.

17.2.4 Create a new series

With **Series > Add**, you can add a new series. Edit the series' title and description in the right window.

17.2.5 Add books to the collection

To add the current novelibre project as a book to the collection, use **Book > Add current project to the collection**. If a series is selected, the book is added as a part of this series.

17.2.6 Update book description

To update the book description from the current project, use **Book > Update book data from the current project**.

> **Caution**
>
> Be sure not to change the book title, because it is used as identifier.

To update the current project description from the book, use **Book > Update project data from the selected project**.

17.2.7 Remove books from the collection

To remove the selected book from the collection, use **Book > Remove selected book from the collection**.

17.2.8 Move series and books

Drag and drop while pressing the `Alt` key.

> **Caution**
>
> Be aware, there is no "Undo" feature.

17.2.9 Remove books

To remove a book from the collection, either select the book and hit the `Del` key, or use **Book > Remove selected book from the collection**.

> **Note**
>
> When removing a book from the collection, the project file associated is kept on disc.

17.2.10 Delete a series

To delete a series, either select the series and hit the `Del` key, or use **Series > Remove selected series but keep the books**.

> **Note**
>
> When deleting a series, the books are kept by default.

To delete the selected series and remove all its books from the collection, use **Series > Remove selected series**.

17.2.11 Quit/Exit

- Under Windows you can exit with **File > Exit** or `Alt-F4`.
- Otherwise you can exit with **File > Quit** or `Ctrl-Q`.

Deutsch

17.3 nv_editor

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_editor release. You can open it with **Help > Editor plugin Online help**.

You can use the section editor to quickly edit and split individual sections. The editor provides access to the internal markup, which is similar to HTML.

17.3.1 Launch the section editor

Open a section editor window by double-clicking on a section, or via the **Section > Edit** menu entry when a section is selected, or by hitting the `Enter` key.

> **Note**
>
> - If the project is locked, editor windows cannot be opened.
> - If you choose a section already open, the window will be brought to the foreground.

17.3.2 Select text

- Select a word via double-clicking.
- Select a paragraph via triple-clicking.
- Extend the selection via `Shift-Arrow`.
- Extend the selection to the next word via `Ctrl-Shift-Arrow`.
- `Ctrl-A` selects the whole text.

17.3.3 Copy/Paste text

- `Ctrl-C` copies the selected text to the clipboard.
- `Ctrl-X` cuts the selected text and moves it to the clipboard.
- `Ctrl-V` pastes the clipboard text content to the cursor position.

17.3.4 Format text

- `Ctrl-I` places "emphasized" markup around the selected text or at the cursor, like so:

  `<em>Example</em>`

  If the selection is already emphasized, the command removes the markup.
- `Ctrl-B` places "strong" markup around the selected text or at the cursor, like so:

  `<strong>Example</strong>`

  If the selection is already strong, the command removes the markup.
- `Ctrl-M` removes "emphasized" and "strong" markup from the selection.

17.3.5 Undo/Redo

- `Ctrl-Z` undoes the last editing. Multiple undo is possible.
- `Ctrl-Y` redoes the last undo. Multiple redo is possible.

17.3.6 Split a section

With **File > Split at cursor position** or `Ctrl-Alt-S`, you can split the section at the cursor position.

- All the text from the cursor position is cut and pasted into a newly created section.
- The new section is placed after the currently edited section.
- The new section is appended to the currently edited section.
- The new section has the same status as the currently edited section.
- The new section is of the same type as the currently edited section.
- The new section has the same viewpoint character as the currently edited section.
- The editor loads the newly created section.

17.3.7 Create a section

With **File > Create section** or `Ctrl-Alt-N`, you can create a section.

- The new section is placed after the currently edited section.
- The new section is of the same type as the currently edited section.
- The editor loads the newly created section.

17.3.8 Word count

- The section word count is displayed at the status bar at the bottom of the window.
- By default, word count is updated manually, either by pressing the `F5` key, or via the **Word count > Update** menu entry.
- The word count can be updated "live", i.e. just while entering text. This is enabled or disabled via the **Word count > Live update** menu checkbox.

> **Note**
>
> Live updating the word count is resource intensive and may slow down the program when editing big sections. This is why it's disabled by default.

17.3.9 Apply changes

With `Ctrl-S`, you can apply changes to the section. Then "Modified" status is displayed in *novelibre*.

- If the project is locked in *novelibre*, you will be asked to unlock it before changes can be applied.

> **Note**
>
> Before applying changes, the program checks the editor content for XML validity. Malformed XML will not be accepted.

17.3.10 Close the editor window

- To close the editor window, click on the **Close** button, or just close the window.
- Under Windows you can optionally exit with **Section > Exit** or `Alt-F4`.
- Otherwise you can optionally exit with **Section > Quit** or `Ctrl-Q`.
- When closing the editor window, you will be asked for applying changes.

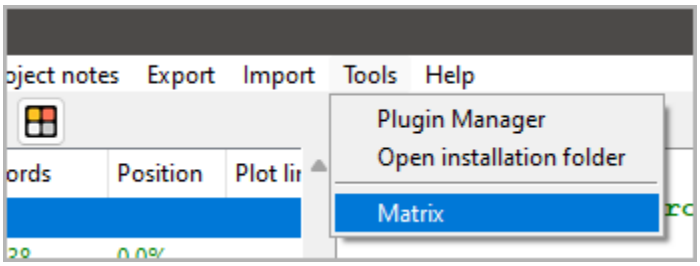
Deutsch

17.4 nv_matrix

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_matrix release. You can open it with **Help > Matrix plugin Online help**.

The plugin adds a **Matrix** entry to the *novelibre* **Tools** menu, and a **Matrix plugin Online help** entry to the **Help** menu. The Toolbar gets a button.



17.4.1 Start the matrix manager

- Open the matrix manager either from the main menu: **Tools > Matrix**,
- or via the button in the toolbar.

17.4.2 Add/remove relationships

- Add/Remove relationships by klicking on the nodes with the `Ctrl` key pressed.

17.4.3 Mouse wheel scrolling

- Use the mouse wheel for vertical scrolling.
- Use the mouse wheel with the `Shift` key pressed for horizontal scrolling.

17.4.4 Exit

- Close the window.

Deutsch

17.5 nv_progress

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_progress release. You can open it with **Help > Progress viewer Online help**.

The plugin adds a **Daily progress log** entry to the *novelibre* **Tools** menu.

17.5.1 Launch the program

- Open the progress log viewer from the main menu: **Tools > Daily progress log**.
- While the *nv_progress* window is open, the actual word count is automatically updated.

17.5.2 Exit

- Close the window.

Deutsch

17.6 nv_statistics

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_statistics release. You can open it with **Help > Project statistics Online help**.

The plugin adds a **Project statistics view** entry to the *novelibre* **Tools** menu, and a **Project statistics Online help** entry to the **Help** menu. The Toolbar gets a button.

17.6.1 Launch the program

- Open the project statistics viewer from the main menu: **Tools > Project statistics view**,
- or via the button in the toolbar.

17.6.2 Charts

The bars in the chart show the number of words in relation to the total number of words in all the used sections.

By double-clicking on a label you can select the related element in the *novelibre* tree view.

17.6.3 Change the scale

- You can enlarge the percentage bars by stretching the window.

17.6.4 Exit

- Close the window.

Deutsch

17.7 nv_templates

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_templates release. You can open it with **Help > Templates plugin Online help**.

With *novelibre*, you can define a narrative structure with stages. See Plotting with novelibre. *nv_templates* faciliates the reuse of narrative structures.

The plugin adds a **Story Templates** entry to the *novelibre* **Tools** menu, a **Create from Template…** entry to the **File > New** submenu, and a **Template plugin Online Help** entry to the **Help** menu.

> **Important**
>
> The plugin comes with sample templates which are automatically copied into the *templates* folder of the *novelibre* installation. Existing files are overwritten. So if you customize your templates, better rename them.

17.7.1 Command reference

File > New

Create from template…

This creates a new project with the narrative structure from a Markdown template file.

- First, a file select dialog asks for the new project's file name (novelibre v1.4+). If you cancel the dialog, you can select the file name later when saving the project.
- Then a second file select dialog asks for the template file to apply.

Tools > Story Templates

Load…

This loads the narrative structure from a Markdown template file.

- A file select dialog asks for the template file to apply.

Save…

This saves the narrative structure to a Markdown template file.

- A file select dialog asks for the new template's file name.

Open folder

This opens the templates folder with the OS file manager, so you can manage and edit the templates.

17.7.2 Conventions

Markdown file structure

The *Story Template* Markdown file defines a narrative structure with the help of headings and ordinary text.

First level heading for top level stages, e.g. acts

The first level heading begins with #, followed by a space and a stage title.

Second level heading for minor stages or turning points

The second level heading begins with ##, followed by a space and a stage title.

Ordinary text

Any text under a heading is used as notes for the element generated from the heading.

Example

```
# ACT 1

Setup

## Inciting Incident

Also called "catalyst" or "call to adventure".
This sets the protagonist in motion.

## Plot Point 1

"Point of no return": The protagonist engages with the action
the inciting incident has created.

# ACT 2

Confrontation

## Midpoint

The main turning point. A significant event, changing the
development of things from good to bad, or vice versa.

## Plot Point 2

The aftermath of the Midpoint crisis.
What changes the protagonist from "passenger" to "driver".

# ACT 3
```

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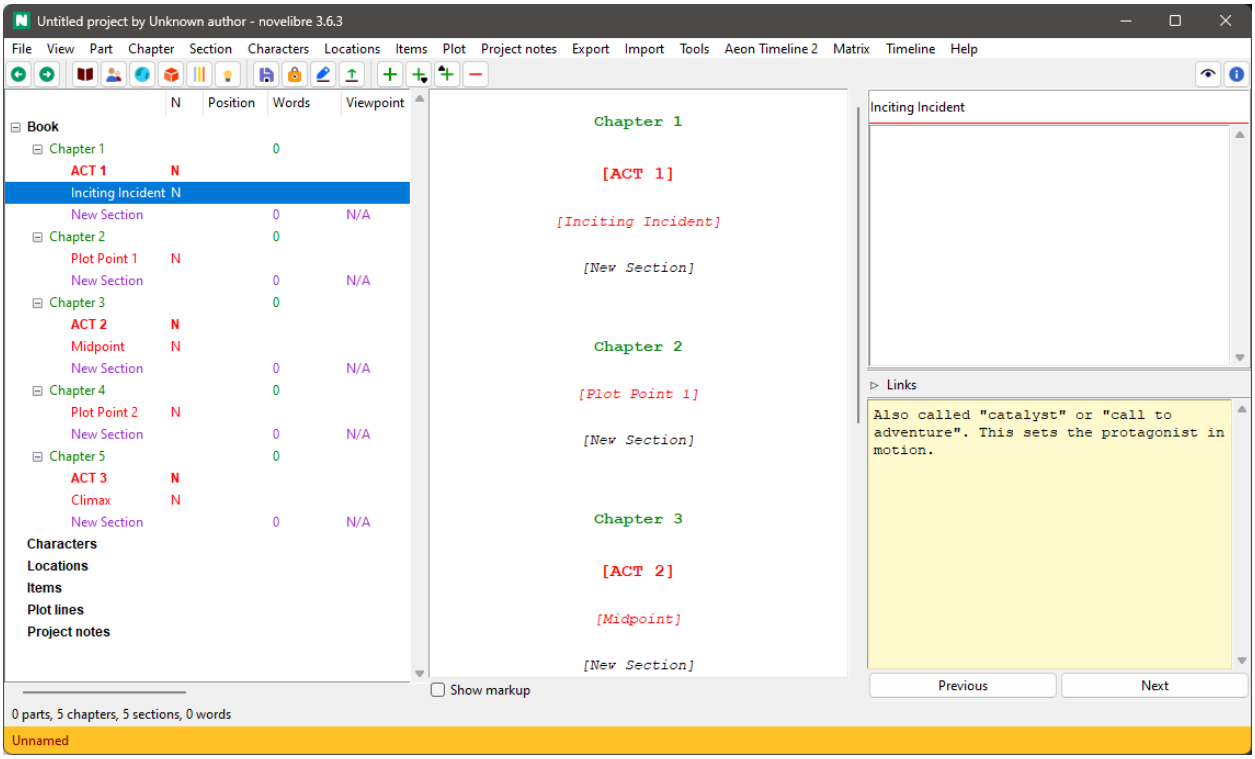
```
Resolution

## Climax

The final moment of the story's conflict.
```

This file generates the following structure in an empty project:



Deutsch

17.8 nv_themes

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_themes release.

The plugin adds a **Change theme** entry to the *novelibre* **View** menu.

> **Note**
>
> Actually, this plugin is more intended for Linux, where the default theme looks pretty stale, and there are plenty of desktops, each with a different look.
>
> On Windows, *novelibre* uses a lot of native widgets by default, you can hardly do better with custom themes.

17.8.1 Start the dialog

Start the theme changer from the main menu: **View > Change theme**.

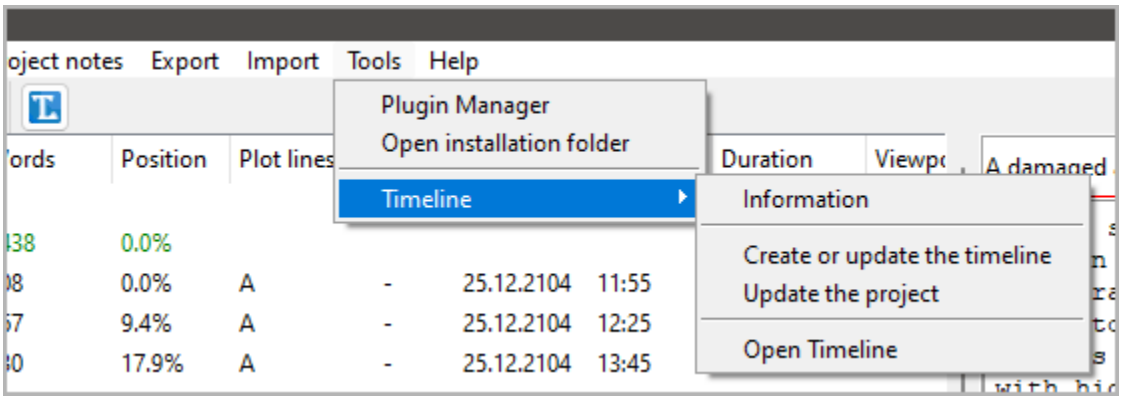
Deutsch

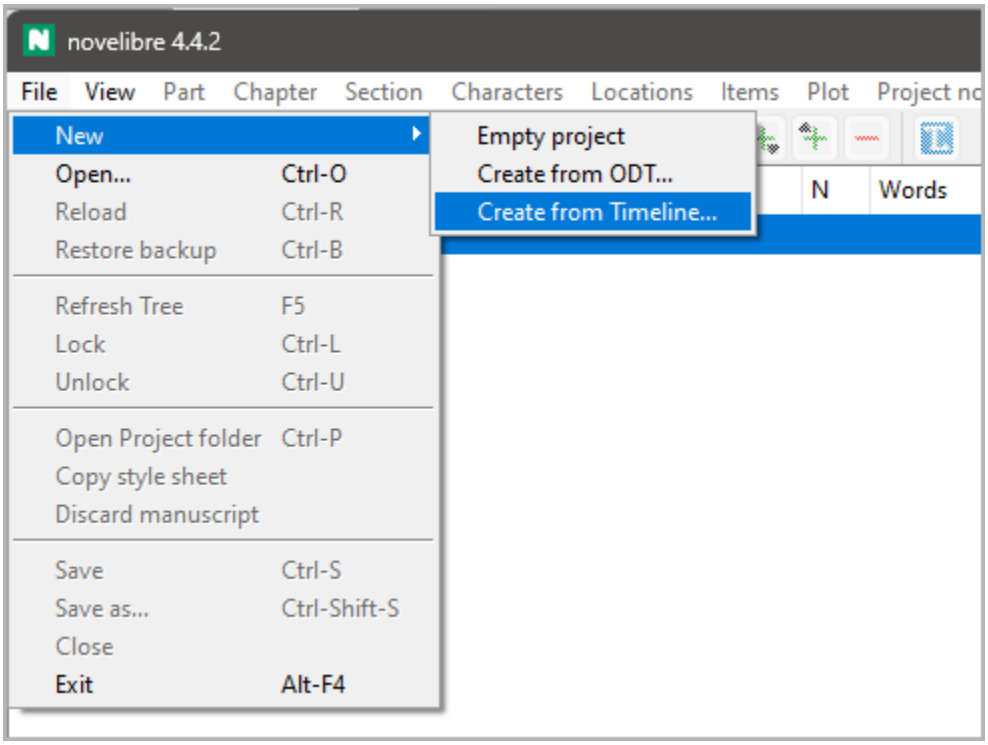
17.9 nv_timeline

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_timeline release. You can open it with **Help > Timeline plugin Online help**.

The plugin adds a **Timeline** entry to the *novelibre* **Tools** menu, a **Create from Timeline…** to the **File > New** submenu, and a **Timeline plugin Online Help** entry to the **Help** menu. The Toolbar gets a button.





17.9.1 Command reference

Tools > Timeline > Information

- Show information about an existing *Timeline* project, if any. *Timeline* and *novelibre* file dates are compared.

Tools > Timeline > Create or update the timeline

If a timeline exists, update it from *novelibre*, otherwise create a new timeline.

Tools > Timeline > Update the project

Update the *novelibre* project from the timeline, if existing.

> **Important**
>
> Please make sure to save the timeline before trying to sync with *novelibre*. Since *nv_timeline* reads the .timeline file, unsaved changes may not be recognized. In case of doubt, close *Timeline* before syncing with *novelibre*.

Tools > Timeline > Open Timeline

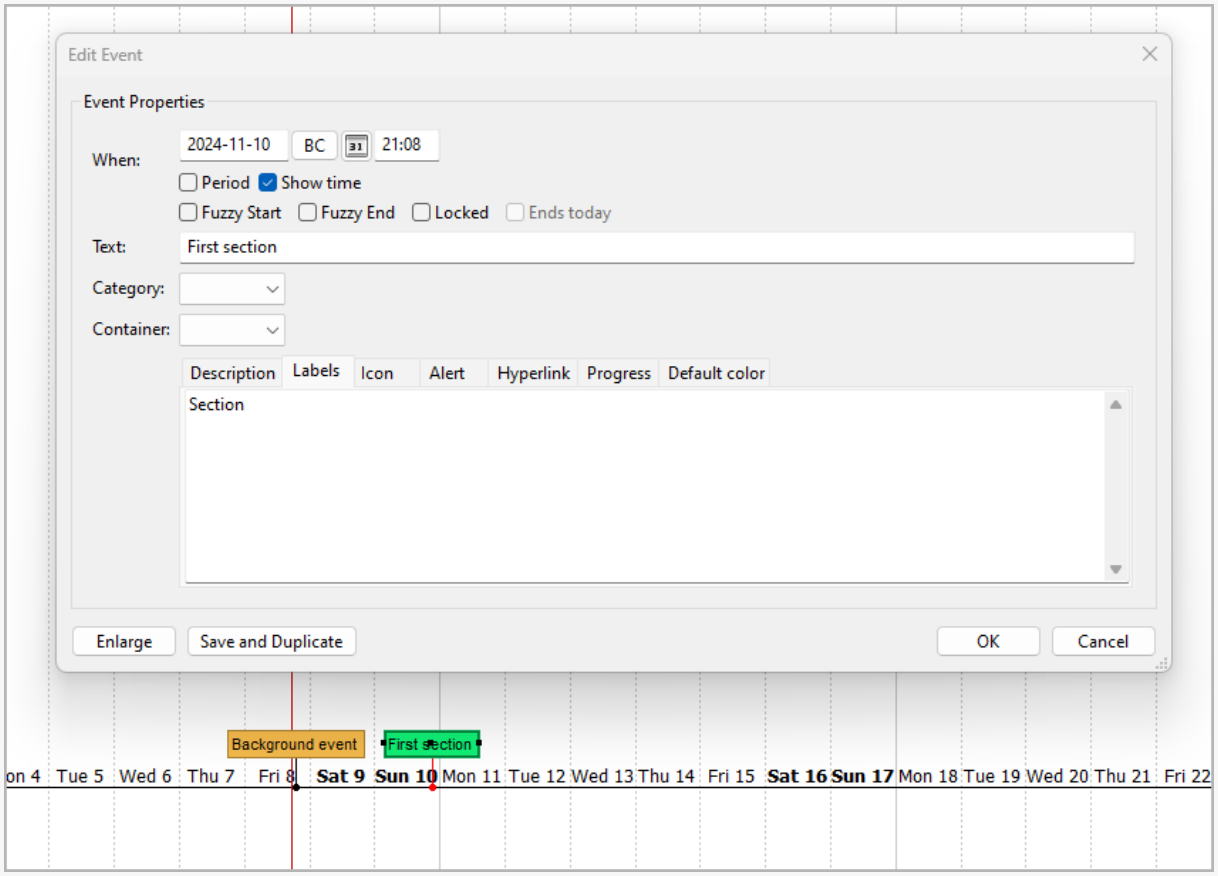
Same as clicking on the button on the toolbar.

Open the project's timeline, if existing, with the *Timeline* application. Depending on the configuration (see below), the project is automatically locked.

File > New > Create from Timeline…

Open a file dialog to select a timeline. If no *novelibre* project with the timeline's file name exists, create a new one from the timeline.

> **Hint**
>
> To become sections in *novelibre*, *Timeline* Events need a "Section" label.



The idea behind this is that only selected events should be included as sections in the *novelibre* project. There may also be background events, for example, that should not be synchronized.

17.9.2 Custom configuration

You can override the default settings by providing a configuration file. Be always aware that faulty entries may cause program errors or unreadable *Timeline* projects. If you change a configuration inbetween, previously synchronized projects might no longer match.

Global configuration

An optional global configuration file named `nv_timeline.ini` can be placed in the configuration directory of the installation. It is applied to any project. Its entries override *nv_timeline's* built-in constants. This is the path under Windows: `c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\config\nv_timeline.ini`

Local project configuration

An optional project configuration file named `nv_timeline.ini` can be placed in your project directory, i.e. the folder containing your *novelibre* and *Timeline* project files. It is only applied to this project. Its entries override *nv_timeline's* built-in constants as well as the global configuration, if any.

How to provide/modify a configuration file

You find the a sample configuration file with the *nv_timeline* default values in the *novelibre* installation directory under

`c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\nv_timeline_sample\`

You best make a copy and edit it.

- The SETTINGS section comprises the program "constants". If you change them, the program might behave differently than described in the documentation. So only touch them if you are clear about the consequences.
- Comment lines begin with a # number sign. In the example, they refer to the code line immediately above.

This is the configuration file explained:

```
[SETTINGS]

section_label = Section

# Events with this label become sections in a newly created
# novelibre project.

section_color = 170,240,160

# Color for events imported as sections from novelibre.

new_event_spacing = 1

# Days between events with automatically generated dates.


[OPTIONS]

lock_on_export = No

# Yes: Lock the novelibre project when opening the timeline.
# No: Do not lock the novelibre project when opening the timeline.
```

How to reset the configuration to defaults

Just delete your global and local configuration files.

17.9.3 Conventions

General

- The *novelibre* project file and the *Timeline* file are located in the same directory.
- They have the same file name and differ in the file extension.
- Either a timeline or a *novelibre* project is generated from the other file for the first time. After that, the two files can be synchronized against each other.

Caution

Synchronizing means overwriting target data with source data. Since *nv_timeline* works in both directions, there is always a danger of confusing source and target, thus losing changes. So if the program asks you for confirmation to overwrite a file, better check if it's actually the target file.

On the novelibre side

- Only normal sections are synchronized with *Timeline*, or exported to *Timeline*. Unused sections will not show up in the timeline.
- Sections with an unspecific time stamp (day, hours, minutes) are synchronized with the timeline, if a reference date is set.
- Changes to the section date/time affect the event start date/time during synchronization.
- Changes to the section duration affect the event end date/time during synchronization.
- Changes to the section title affect the event text during synchronization.
- Changes to the section description affect the event description during synchronization.
- Changes to the section type may add or remove the corresponding event during synchronization.
- Adding or removing sections will add or remove the corresponding event during synchronization.

On the Timeline side

- A section ID is a string looking like "sc1". It is auto-generated and must not be changed manually.
- Only events with a label containing the string "Section" (user input) or a section ID (auto-generated) are exported as sections to a new *novelibre* project.
- When creating a new *novelibre* project from a timeline the first time, "Section" labels are replaced with section ID labels.
- If a new *novelibre* project is generated again with the same timeline, the section ID labels may change.
- Only events with a label containing a section ID are synchronized with an existing *novelibre* project.
- Changes to the event end date/time affect the section duration during synchronization.
- Changes to the event start date/time affect the section date/time during synchronization.
- Changes to the event text affect the section title during synchronization.
- Changes to the event description affect the section description during synchronization.
- The section structure of an existing *novelibre* project can not be changed in *Timeline*. Adding/removing events, or adding/removing section IDs from event labels will *not* add or remove the corresponding section during synchronization.
- When creating events from sections without date/time information, the dates are automatically generated with a one-day difference, starting from the *novelibre* project's reference date.

Known limitations

- Section events that begin before 0001-01-01 in the timeline, will not be synchronized with *novelibre*, because *novelibre* can not handle these dates.
- The same applies to the section duration in this case, i.e. the event duration in *Timeline* and the section duration in *novelibre* may differ.

- If a section event ends after 9999-12-31 in the timeline, the section duration is not synchronized with *novelibre*.

Deutsch

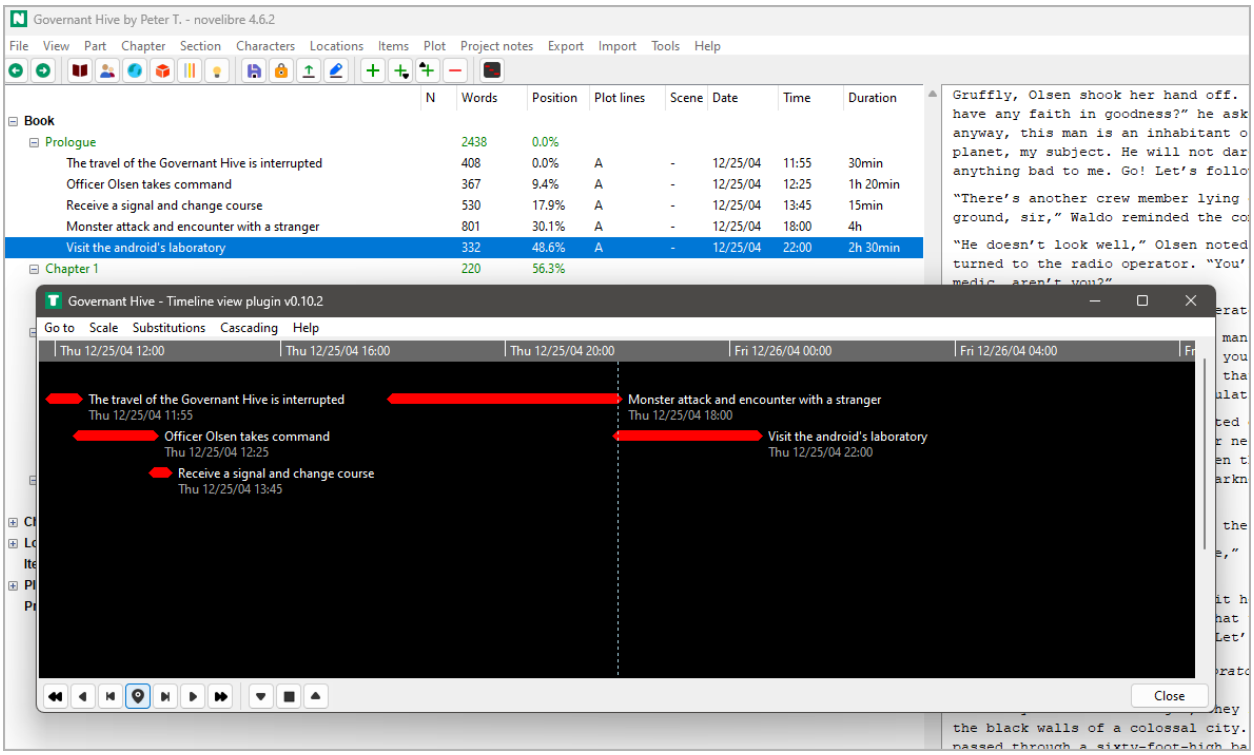
17.10 nv_tlview

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_tlview release. You can open it with **Help > Timeline view Online help** or with `F1`.

nv_tlview is a plugin providing a timeline view with sections that are given a narrative date/day and time.

The plugin adds a **Timeline view** entry to the *novelibre* **Tools** menu, and a **Timeline view Online help** entry to the **Help** menu. The Toolbar gets a button.



17.10.1 Operation

Start the Timeline view

- Open the Timeline view either from the main menu: **Tools > Timeline view**,
- or via the button in the toolbar.

Mouse scrolling

- Scroll the timeline horizontally with `Shift-Mousewheel`.
- Scroll the timeline vertically with the mousewheel.
- Scroll the timeline in any direction by right-clicking on the canvas and dragging the mouse.

- Increase or reduce the time scale with `Ctrl-Mousewheel`.
- Change the distance limits for stacking with `Shift-Ctrl-Mousewheel`.

Selecting a section in the *novelibre* project tree

- Select a section by double klicking on a timeline marker. This will bring the *novelibre* application window in the foreground.

Shifting a section in time

- Hold down the `Shift` button and click on the timeline marker, then drag it with the mouse. This will move the section forward or backward in time while keeping the duration.

Shifting the section end

- Hold down the `Ctrl` and `Shift` buttons and click on the timeline marker, then drag it with the mouse. This will increase or decrease the section's duration while keeping the start date/time.

Hint

- Shifting operations with the mouse can be aborted with the `Esc` key before releasing the mouse button.
- Shifting operations with the mouse can be undone with .

17.10.2 Command reference

"Go to" menu

First event
Shift the timeline so that the earliest event is positioned near the left edge of the window.

Last event
Shift the timeline so that the latest event is positioned near the right edge of the window.

Selected section
Shift the timeline so that the section selected in the *novelibre* project tree is positioned in the center of the window.

"Scale" menu

Hours
This sets the scale to one hour per line.

Days
This sets the scale to one day per line.

Years
This sets the scale to one year per line.

Fit to window
This sets the scale and moves the timeline, so that all sections with valid or substituted date/time information fit into the window.

"Substitutions" menu

Use 00:00 for missing times

- If ticked, "00:00" is used as display time for sections without time information. This does not affect the section properties.
- If unticked, sections without time information are not displayed.

"Cascading" menu

The section marks are stacked on the timeline canvas, so that they would not overlap or cover the title of previous sections. If the stacking algorithm does not seem good enough to you, you can adjust its limits.

Tight
Arrange consecutive events behind each other, even if they are close together.

Relaxed
Arrange consecutive events in a stack, even if they are some distance apart.

Standard
Reset the cascading to default.

> **Hint**
>
> You can fine-tune the stacking limits with `Shift-Ctrl-Mousewheel`.

"Help" menu

Online help
Open this help page in a web browser.

Buttons in the footer toolbar

Go one page back
Shift the timeline to go about one screen width back in time. Same as the "back" mouse button (Windows).

Scroll back
Shift the timeline to go 1/5 screen width back in time. You can move it more precisely with the mouse wheel.

Go to the first event
Shift the timeline so that the earliest event is positioned near the left edge of the window.

Go to the selected section
Shift the timeline so that the section selected in the *novelibre* project tree is positioned in the center of the window.

Go to the last event
Shift the timeline so that the latest event is positioned near the right edge of the window.

Scroll forward
Shift the timeline to go 1/5 screen width forward in time. You can move it more precisely with the mouse wheel.

Go one page forward
Shift the timeline to go about one screen width forward in time. Same as the "forward" mouse button (Windows).

Reduce the time scale
Reduce the time scale in major steps. Fine scaling is meant to be done with the mouse wheel.

Fit to window
This sets the scale and moves the timeline, so that all sections with valid or substituted date/time information fit into the window.

Increase the time scale
Increase the time scale in major steps. Fine scaling is meant to be done with the mouse wheel.

Undo the last change
This restores date/time/duration before the last mouse operation on a section.

> **Caution**
>
> Interim changes to date/time/duration on the same section via the section properties in *novelibre* may get lost.

Close
Close the timeline viewer window. Same as `Ctrl-Q` (Linux) or `Alt-F4` (Windows).

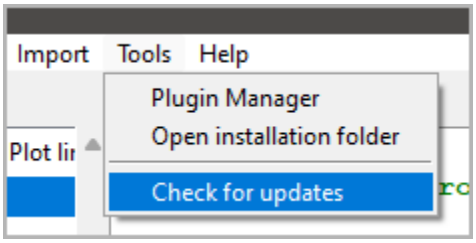
Deutsch

17.11 nv_updater

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_updater release. You can open it with **Help > Update checker Online help**.

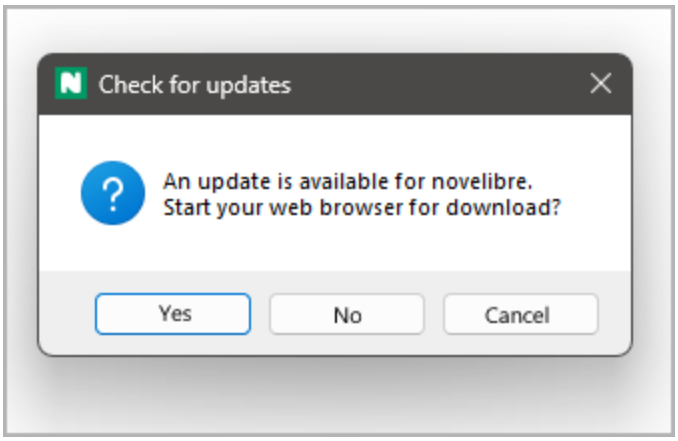
The plugin adds a **Check for updates** entry to the *novelibre* **Tools** menu, and an **Update checker Online help** entry to the **Help** menu.



17.11.1 Start the update checker

Open the update checker from the main menu: **Tools > Check for updates**.

If an update is found, a message pops up.

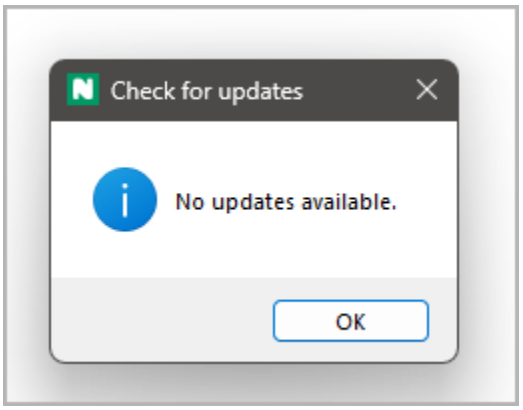


You can choose:

- **Yes** starts your web browser with the update URL.
- **No** skips this update.
- **Cancel** cancels the update check.

> **Important**
>
> The *nv_updater* plugin only initiates the download process via the system web browser. If a download directory is preset, all zip files with the downloaded releases will end up there. You then perform the actual installation manually as usual.

If no update is found, a message pops up at the end.



> **Important**
>
> To take effect, update installations require a *novelibre* restart.

Deutsch

17.12 nv_zim

User guide

This page refers to the latest nv_zim release. You can open it with **Help > Zim connection Online help**.

nv_zim is a plugin that connects *novelibre* projects with a *Zim Desktop Wiki*. This is mainly intended for world building documentation.

The plugin adds an **Zim Desktop Wiki** entry to the *novelibre* **Tools** menu, and a **Zim connection Online help** entry to the **Help** menu. The property views of characters, locations, items, and book get a **Wiki page** button. The Toolbar gets a button.

17.12.1 Setting up Zim Desktop Wiki

17.12.2 General

To launch the Zim Desktop Wiki application, *nv_zim* must know the location of its installation. If you have installed Zim in the default directory, there is nothing to do here.

> **Note**
>
> At program startup, *nv_zim* checks the *launchers.ini* file in the *novelibre* configuration directory. Here is an example with a Windows entry:
>
> ```
> [SETTINGS]
> .zim = C:/Program Files (x86)/Zim Desktop Wiki/zim.exe
> ```
>
> If this file doesn't exist, or the path doesn't fit, the program searches the default installation paths for the 32-bit and the 64-bit versions under Windows, as well as `/usr/bin/zim` under Linux. If this fails, it opens a file selection dialog, asking for the location. The proper location is then automatically entered in the *launchers.ini* file.

17.12.3 Zim notebooks as project wikis

The *nv_zim* plugin extends the *novelibre* user interface, so you can conveniently launch the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application with a project-related notebook or a context-related wiki page. Basically, this works with any Zim notebook, even with pages that belong to different notebooks. However, it is recommended to create a notebook called *project wiki* linked with the current *novelibre* project, or with multiple projects that belong to a series. Then the program can automatically generate missing pages in this notebook.

File locations

Project wikis may be located anywhere. However, auto-created ones are put into a subdirectory of the *novelibre* project, named `<project name>_zim`.

- If you later move the project wiki to another location, the next time you open it from within *novelibre* you can select it with a file selection dialog and link to it again.
- If you move the project wiki to another location together with the *novelibre* project, the program can automatically correct the wiki links.
- Even if you leave the project wiki where it is, but move the *novelibre* project somewhere else, the program can automatically correct the wiki links.

Notebook structure

Auto-generated project wikis have a "flat" structure, which means: all wiki pages are located in the Zim notebook's *Home* folder. Groupings and tree structures can be created using links on appropriately structured overview pages. Compared to a folder structure, this has the advantage that each page can be categorized under several different aspects. If you prefer a hierarchical structure instead, you can subsequently move auto-generated wiki pages with *Zim*, but you may have to renew the link in *novelibre* via the selection dialog.

Tags

novelibre offers the option of assigning tags to characters, locations, and items. When *nv_zim* auto-generates a wiki page, it inserts existing tags in the appropriate notation for *Zim*, allowing the application to group and link pages according to the categories represented by the tags.

Wiki links in novelibre

novelibre saves the file paths of the project wiki and the wiki pages in the *.novx* file, if the project is not locked at the time of linking. Otherwise, the program only remembers these file paths for the current session, so as not to change the locked project. However, if you subsequently unlock the project and reopen the wiki or a page, it will automatically save the file paths and display a corresponding message on the status bar.

> **Tip**
>
> If you want to link more than one wiki page with a character, location, item, or the book, you can use regular links. When the *nv_zim* is installed, *novelibre* will recognize wiki pages among the links and open them with the *Zim* application.

17.12.4 Zim Desktop Wiki menu

Open project wiki

With **Tools > Zim Desktop Wiki > Open project wiki**, or clicking on the button on the toolbar, you can open the Zim notebook linked with the project.

If there is no link yet, or if the saved link address is not valid, you will be asked whether you want to open an existing wiki or create a new one:

Browse
: this opens a file picker dialog to search for a Zim wiki file with the extension *.zim*. Zim is launched with the selected project wiki open.

> **Note**
>
> The selected file will be linked as the project wiki, if the project is not locked. If the project is locked, you can open the project wiki from within *novelibre* during the current session, but you may have to re-select it in the next session.

Create
: this auto-creates a new blank Zim notebook in a subdirectory of the project directory, and opens it with Zim.

> **Note**

> The new *.zim* file will be linked as the project wiki, if the project is not locked. If the project is locked, you can open the project wiki from within *novelibre* during the current session, but you may have to re-select it in the next session.

Cancel
Aborts the operation without launching Zim.

> **Hint**
>
> If you want to open the project wiki or a wiki page from within *novelibre*, but don't see any reaction, please take a look at the taskbar and see whether the *Zim Desktop Wiki* application is already open, but is covered by other open windows, e.g. by *novelibre*. In this case, the "Zim" window is not automatically lifted to the foreground.

Create project wiki

With **Tools > Zim Desktop Wiki > Create project wiki** you can create a new Zim notebook in a subdirectory of the project directory and open it with Zim. The generated project wiki contains pages for the book and for all characters, locations, and items. If there is already a Zim notebook in the target directory, this directory is automatically renamed and kept as a backup.

> **Note**
>
> The new *.zim* file will be linked as the project wiki, if the project is not locked. If the project is locked, you can open the project wiki from within *novelibre* during the current session, but you may have to re-select it in the next session.

Remove wiki links

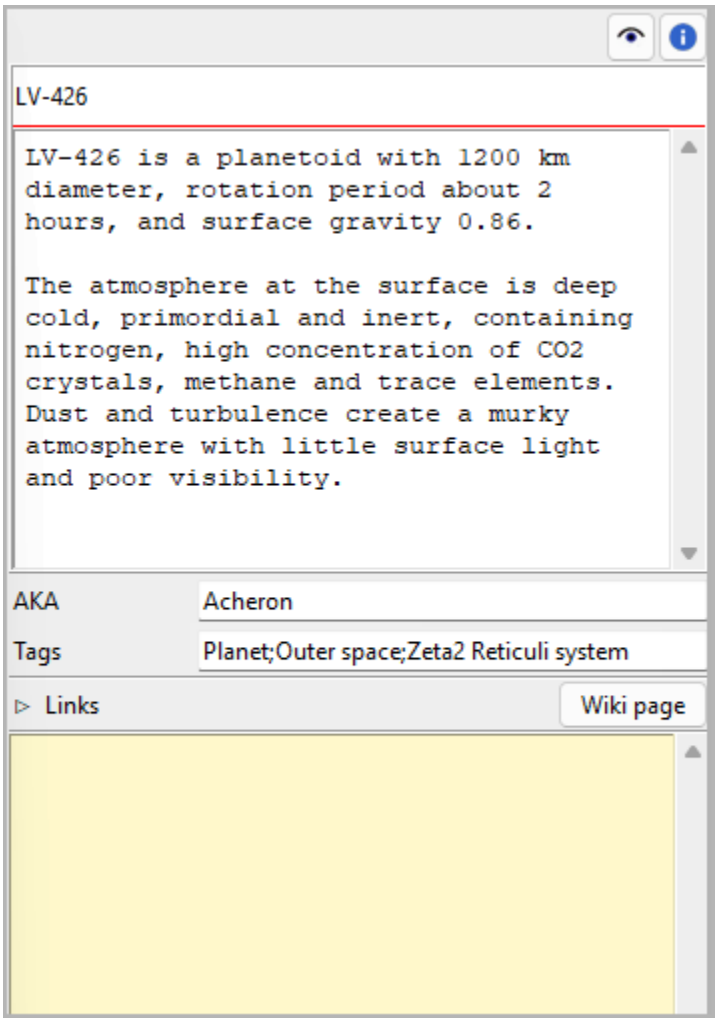
With **Tools > Zim Desktop Wiki > Remove wiki links** you can remove saved wiki links from the project file. This takes effect when saving the next time.

A submenu offers two options:

Selected pages
This will remove the Zim wiki links of the selected elements. This command only refers to linked pages, but not to the project wiki.

All
This will remove all Zim wiki links. This command refers both to linked pages and to the project wiki.

17.12.5 Book/Characters/Locations/Items properties



"Wiki page" button

By clicking on this button you open a linked wiki page with Zim.

If no wiki page is linked yet, the program first tries to find a page in the project wiki whose name matches the title of the book, the location or the item, or the full name of the character, if known, otherwise the short name.

If no project wiki has been defined yet, the program first asks for the project wiki and gives you the option of selecting or creating it (see above). You will then be asked whether you want to open an existing wiki page or create a new one:

Browse
: this opens a file picker dialog to search for a Zim page file with the extension *.txt*. Zim is launched with the selected wiki page open.

> **Note**
>
> The selected file will be linked with the element currently selected in *novelibre*, if the project is not locked. If the project is locked, you can open the wiki page from within *novelibre* during the current session, but you may have to re-select it in the next session.

Create
this auto-creates a new wiki page as a part of the project wiki, and opens it with Zim.

> **Note**
>
> The new *.txt* file will be linked with the element currently selected in *novelibre*, if the project is not locked. If the project is locked, you can open the wiki page from within *novelibre* during the current session, but you may have to re-select it in the next session.

Cancel
Aborts the operation without launching Zim.

CHAPTER

EIGHTEEN

UTILITIES

Deutsch

18.1 scap_novx

User guide

This page refers to the latest scap_novx release.

The scap_novx Python script creates a *novelibre* project from a Scapple outline.

18.1.1 Instructions for use

Intended usage

The included installation script prompts you to create a shortcut on the desktop. You can launch the program by dragging a *scap* file and dropping it on the shortcut icon.

Command line usage

Alternatively, you can

- launch the program on the command line passing the scapple file as an argument, or
- launch the program via a batch file.

usage: `scap_novx.py [--silent] Sourcefile`

positional arguments:

`Sourcefile`

The path of the Scapple outline file.

optional arguments:

`--silent` suppress error messages and the request to confirm overwriting

18.1.2 Mode of operation

scap_novx generates a new *novelibre* project file with the same file name as the Scapple source file, but with the extension `.novx`. It is placed in the same directory as the source file.

> **Note**
>
> If the *novelibre* project already exists, it would not be overwritten. Character/Location/Item XML files are generated instead. They can be imported into any *novelibre* project.

18.1.3 Conversion rules

- Notes with a shadow are converted to sections.
- Sections are ordered by their position in the Scapple diagram (from top left to bottom right).
- Notes with a "cloud" border without shadow are converted to section and character notes.
- Notes with a square border are converted to tags.
- Notes with red text are converted to major characters.
- Notes with purple text are converted to minor characters.
- Notes with blue text are converted to locations.
- Notes with green text are converted to items.
- Assign characters/locations/items to a section by connecting the corresponding notes.
- Assign tags to sections/characters/locations/items by connecting the corresponding notes.
- Assign a viewpoint character to a section by creating an arrow pointing from the character to the section. If a section is pointed to by several characters, or by no character, the viewpoint is random.

18.1.4 How to mark notes for export

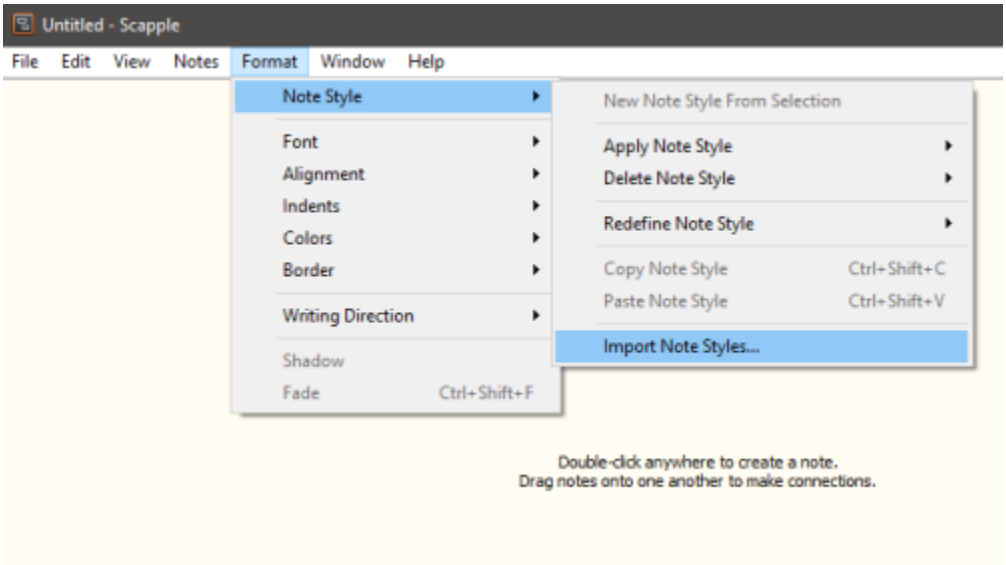
Import styles (optional)

The scap_novx distribution comes with a sample Scapple project *styles.scap* including all required styles.

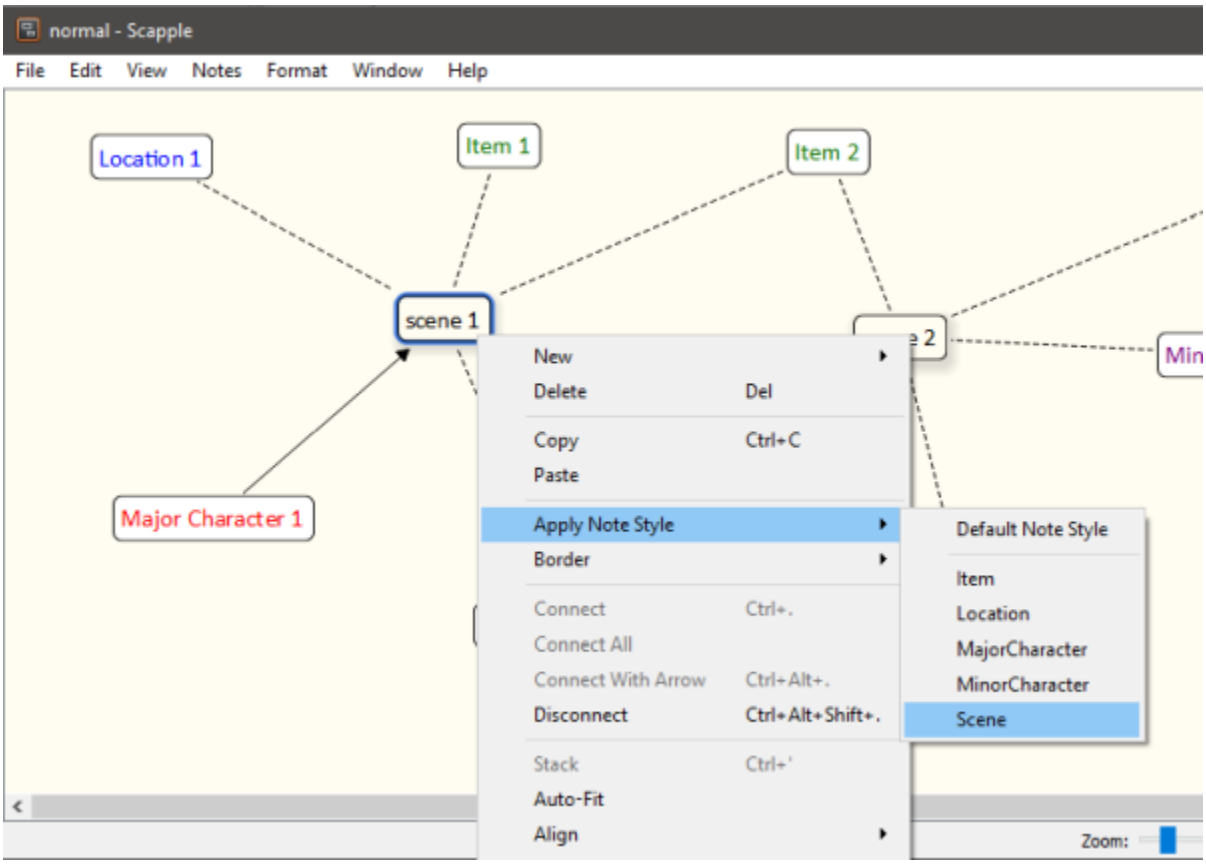
You find this a sample project in the *novelibre* installation directory under

```
c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\scap_novx\sample\
```

You can either use this diagram as a template, or import the styles into your own Scapple diagram.

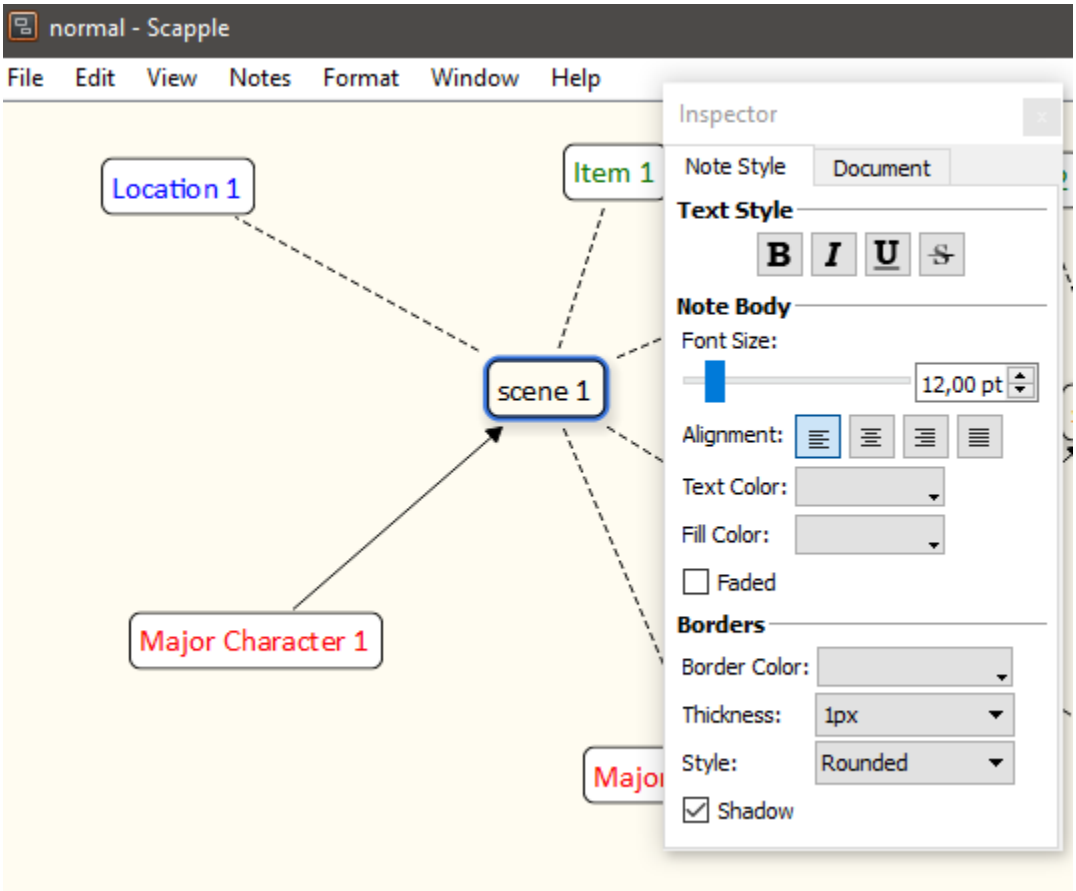


In the file picker dialog, select <`unzipped scap_novx release folder`>`\sample\styles.scap`. Then you can apply the styles via context menu.



Mark sections

Either apply the "Section" style, if any, via context menu, or tick "Shadow" in the Inspector to mark the note as section.



Mark notes

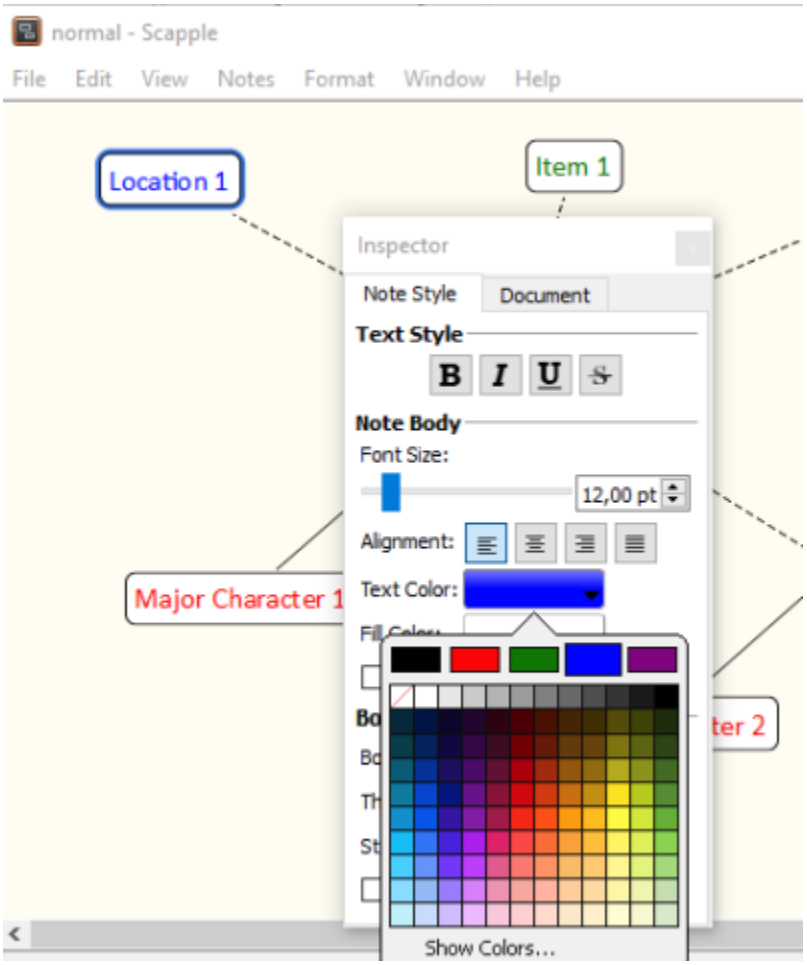
Either apply the "Note" style, if any, via context menu, or make the note's border style "Cloud" in the Inspector.

Mark tags

Either apply the "Tag" style, if any, via context menu, or make the note's border style "Square" in the Inspector.

Mark locations

Either apply the "Location" style, if any, via context menu, or tick the big blue field above the text color swatch in the Inspector.



Mark major characters

Either apply the "MajorCharacter" style, if any, via context menu, or tick the big red field above the text color swatch in the Inspector.

Mark minor characters

Either apply the "MinorCharacter" style, if any, via context menu, or tick the big purple field above the text color swatch in the Inspector.

Mark items

Either apply the "Item" style, if any, via context menu, or tick the big green field above the text color swatch in the Inspector.

18.1.5 Custom configuration

You can override the default settings by providing a configuration file. Be always aware that faulty entries may cause program errors.

Global configuration

An optional global configuration file can be placed in the configuration directory in your user profile. It is applied to any project. Its entries override scap_novx's built-in constants. This is the path: `c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\scap_novx\scap_novx.ini`

Local project configuration

An optional project configuration file `scap_novx.ini2novx.ini` can be placed in your project directory, i.e. the folder containing your *novelibre* and Timeline project files. It is only applied to this project. Its entries override scap_novx's built-in constants as well as the global configuration, if any.

How to provide/modify a configuration file

You find the a sample configuration file with the *scap_novx* default values in the *novelibre* installation directory under

`c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\scap_novx\sample\`

You best make a copy and edit it.

- The SETTINGS section mainly refers to colors, i.e. The text colors that mark the characters/locations/items in Scapple. If you change them, the program might behave differently than described in the description of the conversion rules below.
- The OPTIONS section comprises options for regular program execution.
- Comment lines begin with a # number sign. In the example, refer to the code line immediately above.

This is the configuration file explained:

```
[SETTINGS]

location_color = 0.0 0.0 1.0

# RGB text color that marks the locations in Scapple.

item_color = 0.0 0.5 0.0

# RGB text color that marks the items in Scapple.

major_chara_color = 1.0 0.0 0.0

# RGB text color that marks the major racters in Scapple.

minor_chara_color = 0.5 0.0 0.5

# RGB text color that marks the minor characters in Scapple.

[OPTIONS]

export_sections = Yes

# Yes: create sections from Scapple notes.

export_characters = Yes

# Yes: create characters from Scapple notes.
```

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```
export_locations = Yes

# Yes: create locations from Scapple notes.

export_items = Yes

# Yes: create items from Scapple notes.
```

18.1.6 Installation path

The setup script installs *scap_novx.py* in a defined place. This is the installation path on Windows:

`c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\scap_novx`

Deutsch

18.2 novx_xtg

User guide

This page refers to the latest novx_xtg release.

The novx_xtg Python script runs through all chapters and sections of a novelibre project and fills XTG templates.

18.2.1 Instructions for use

Intended usage

The included installation script prompts you to create a shortcut on the desktop.
You can launch the program by dragging a novelibre project file and dropping it on the shortcut icon.

Command line usage

Alternatively, you can

- launch the program on the command line passing the novelibre project file as an argument, or
- launch the program via a batch file.

usage: `novx_xtg.pyw [--silent] Sourcefile`

positional arguments:

`Sourcefile`

The path of the novelibre project file.

optional arguments:

`--silent` suppress error messages and the request to confirm the use of default values

—

18.2.2 General

About XTG

The XTG file format uses the *XPress Tags* language, the knowledge of which is assumed. You canownload the manual *A Guide to XPress Tags* for your program version from the *Quark* web site.

novelibre text markup

Bold and italics are supported. Other highlighting such as underline and strikethrough are lost.

Quotation marks and punctuation

It is assumed that quotation marks and punctuation marks are already set correctly; this is best done in advance with a word processor, e.g. via novelibre's "proof read" function.

18.2.3 Configuration

- Place a subfolder named **novx_xtg** in the novelibre project folder. It contains the configuration file and all template files as listed below to be applied to this project. The best way is to copy the provided sample folder and customize the contained files with a text editor according to your needs.
- If there is no configuration data in the project file, data stored in *c:Users<user name>.novxnovx_xtgconfig* is used prior to the script's default configuration data.
- If a template file or a configuration entry is missing, *novx_xtg* uses the lower priority source as a fallback.

> **Hint**
>
> You find the a sample configuration folder with templates and the *novx_xtg* default values in the *novelibre* installation directory under
>
> `c:\Users\<user name>\.novx\novx_xtg\sample\`
>
> You best make a copy and edit it.

Configuration file

This is the configuration file explained:

```
[STYLES]
first_paragraph = @Text body:

# XPress tag for paragraphs preceded by a heading or a blank line.

indented_paragraph = @Text body indent:

# XPress tag for indented paragraphs.

other_paragraph = @First line indent:

# XPress tag for regular paragraphs.

italic = <@Emphasis>

# XPress tag opening italic sections.
```

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```
italic0 = <@$p>

# XPress tag closing italic sections.

bold = <@Strong emphasis>

# XPress tag opening bold sections.

bold0 = <@$p>

# XPress tag closing bold sections.

acronym =

# XPress tag opening acronyms.

acronym0 =

# XPress tag closing acronyms.

figure =

# XPress tag opening figure groups.

figure0 =

# XPress tag closing figure groups.

[OPTIONS]

adjust_digits = Yes

# If Yes, adjust digit-separating blanks.

space_points = Yes

# If Yes, space digit-separating points.

per_chapter = No

# If Yes, create one XTG file for each chapter.
# If No, create one XTG file for the entire document.
```

Style tags

- **textbody** - The QX paragraph style applied to all paragraphs in a section, except the first. The first paragraph's style can be set in the section level templates.
- **italic** - The opening tag to replace novelibre's *italic* formatting.
- **italic0** - The closing tag to replace novelibre's *italic* formatting.
- **bold** - The opening tag to replace novelibre's *bold* formatting.

- **bold0** - The closing tag to replace novelibre's *bold* formatting.
- **acronym** - The opening tag to format sequences of uppercase characters (e.g. set a slightly smaller font size).
- **acronym0** - The closing tag to format sequences of uppercase characters.
- **figure** - The opening tag to format figures (e.g. switch the font to get "osf" text figures).
- **figure0** - The closing tag to format figures.

Options

- **adjust_digits** - Replace regular spaces between digits with thin spaces.
- **space_points** - Insert a thin space after each point that separates digits.
- **per_chapter** - Generate one XTG file per chapter. The file names consist of the chapter's number and title. the files are written to the XTG_Chapters subdirectory.

You can define styles in `fileHeader.XTG`, but it is preferable to use the names of styles that already exist in the QX book project instead.

18.2.4 List of templates

Project level templates

- **fileHeader.XTG** - This template must contain at least the version code and encoding indication.

Chapter level templates

- **partTemplate.XTG** - Chapter header; applied to chapters marked "section beginning".
- **chapterTemplate.XTG** - Chapter header; applied to all "used" and "normal" chapters unless a "part template" exists.

Section level templates

- **firstSectionTemplate.XTG** - Applied to sections at the beginning of the chapter.
- **sectionTemplate.XTG** - Applied to "used" sections within "normal" chapters.
- **sectionDivider.XTG** - Section divider placed between sections.
- **appendedSectionTemplate.XTG** - Applied to sections to be appended to the previous section.

18.2.5 Placeholders

Syntax

There are two options:

1. $Placeholder
2. ${Placeholder}

"Project template" placeholders

- **$Title** - Project title
- **$Desc** - Project description
- **$AuthorName** - Author's name
- **$Language** - Language code acc. to ISO 639-1

- **$Country** - Country code acc. to ISO 3166-2
- **$CustomPlotProgress** - Custom "Plot progress" field title
- **$CustomCharacterization** - Custom "Characterization" field title
- **$CustomWorldBuilding** - Custom "World building" field title
- **$CustomGoal** - Custom "Goal" field title
- **$CustomConflict** - Custom "Conflict" field title
- **$CustomOutcome** - Custom "Outcome" field title
- **$CustomChrBio** - Custom character "Bio" field title
- **$CustomChrGoals** - Custom character "Goals" field title

"Chapter template" placeholders

- **$ID** - Chapter ID,
- **$ChapterNumber** - Chapter number (in sort order),
- **$Title** - Chapter title
- **$Desc** - Chapter description
- **$Notes** - Chapter notes
- **$ProjectName** - URL-coded file name without suffix and extension
- **$ProjectPath** - URL-coded fpath to the project directory
- **$Language** - Language code acc. to ISO 639-1
- **$Country** - Country code acc. to ISO 3166-2
- **$ManuscriptSuffix** - File name suffix of the manuscript

"Section template" placeholders

- **$ID** - Section ID,
- **$SectionNumber** - Section number (in sort order),
- **$Title** - Section title
- **$Desc** - Section description
- **$WordCount** - Section word count
- **$WordsTotal** - Accumulated word count including the current section
- **$Status** - Section status (Outline, Draft etc.)
- **$SectionContent** - Section content
- **$Date** - Specific section date (YYYY-MM-DD)
- **$Time** - Time section begins: (hh:mm)
- **$OdsTime** - Time section begins: (PThhHmmMssS)
- **$Day** - Day section begins
- **$ScDate** - Date or day (localized)
- **$DateYear** - Year

- **$DateMonth** - Month (number)
- **$DateDay** - Day (number)
- **$DateWeekday** - Day of the week (name)
- **$MonthName** - Month (name)
- **$LastsDays** - Amount of time section lasts: days
- **$LastsHours** - Amount of time section lasts: hours
- **$LastsMinutes** - Amount of time section lasts: minutes
- **Duration** - Combination of days and hours and minutes
- **$Scene** - The sections's kind of scene, if any
- **$Goal** - The section protagonist's goal
- **$Conflict** - The section conflict
- **$Outcome** - The section outcome
- **$Tags** - Comma-separated list of section tags
- **$Characters** - Comma-separated list of characters assigned to the section
- **$Viewpoint** - Viewpoint character
- **$Locations** - Comma-separated list of locations assigned to the section
- **$Items** - Comma-separated list of items assigned to the section
- **$Notes** - Section notes
- **$ProjectName** - URL-coded file name without suffix and extension
- **$ProjectPath** - URL-coded fpath to the project directory
- **$Language** - Language code acc. to ISO 639-1
- **$Country** - Country code acc. to ISO 3166-2
- **$ManuscriptSuffix** - File name suffix of the manuscript
- **$SectionsSuffix** - File name suffix of the section descriptions
- **$CustomPlotProgress** - Custom "Plot progress" field title
- **$CustomCharacterization** - Custom "Characterization" field title
- **$CustomWorldBuilding** - Custom "World building" field title
- **$CustomGoal** - Custom "Goal" field title
- **$CustomConflict** - Custom "Conflict" field title
- **$CustomOutcome** - Custom "Outcome" field title

18.2.6 Installation path

The setup script installs *novx_xtg.pyw* in a defined place. This is the installation path on Windows:

```
c:\Users\<user name>.novx\novx_xtg
```

CHAPTER

NINETEEN

PROGRAM ERRORS

novelibre has proven to be very stable in daily use. There are no mysterious crashes and no third-party program packages are used, as they occasionally cause problems with other application programs.

Nevertheless, there is no guarantee that it is free of bugs. *novelibre* has an open program architecture to enable extensive functional extensions through plugins. Unfortunately, this also means that a bug in one plugin can affect the entire program.

19.1 What to do in case of error?

1. Save your data

   If a program error occurs that does not lead to a hard termination, a warning window should open recommending that the program session be terminated. In this case, you can try to save changes.

2. Update the application and all plugins

   Please make sure you have the latest version of *novelibre* and all its plugins. If you have an outdated version of the program, the error you are experiencing might already have been fixed.

3. Report the bug

   If the error persists, you might experience a bug that is yet unknown.

   In the installation directory of *novelibre* there should be a text file named *error.log*, which lists the lines of code that led to the error. The content of this file can help the developer to fix the problem.

   So if you want to contribute to the improvement of *novelibre*, you can go to the home page of *novelibre* or a plugin which may look suspicious, and submit a bug report in the *Issues* section. However, you need a user account to do this, which is free of charge.

   > **Hint**
   >
   > Take a look at the issues to see whether your error has already been reported. If this is the case, you can add a comment to this issue.
   >
   > If you know your way around a little, you can also take a look at the closed issues and reopen one if necessary.
   >
   > If you are reporting a new bug, please fill out the *Bug report* form. Please indicate which plugins you have installed.

4. Uninstall plugins

   If *novelibre* can be started, open the plugin manager, delete all plugins one after the other, and restart *novelibre*. If the error can no longer be reproduced, you can continue working without plugins for the time being.

5. Return to an old version

   If this doesn't help, but you have been working with *novelibre* for a long time without any problems, the problem may have been introduced with a faulty update. If you still have the previous program version in your *Download* folder, reinstall it (and the old plugins if any).

CHAPTER

TWENTY

ABANDONING NOVELIBRE

You have put a lot of time and effort into a novel project with *novelibre*, but have come to the conclusion that *novelibre* is not right for you after all? Don't worry, the effort was not in vain. You can export just about anything in the form of *Writer* text documents and *Calc* spreadsheets.

20.1 How to continue using your projects without novelibre

So if you prefer to continue working in the classic way with OpenOffice or LibreOffice, simply create a final manuscript document and a section list or a plot grid. In addition, descriptions of your characters, locations etc., as text documents, tables, or desktop wiki as required. You can then continue all of this manually.

- Useful when switching to yWriter is the nv_yw7 plugin.
- When switching to novelWriter, you can first convert your project to a yWriter project (see above), and then turn it into a *novelWriter* project using the yw2nw converter tool.

In case *novelibre* is no longer available for any reason, you can view *.novx* files in a web browser using the css style sheet, and copy everything you want via the clipboard.

For experts, there is also the option of creating completely different file formats from the *.novx* files using *XSLT* transformation. Examples for this can be found in the novelibre repository.

20.2 How to uninstall novelibre

1. Open the installation folder (the subdirectory `.novx` in your user directory).

   > **Tip**
   >
   > This is particularly easy to do from *novelibre* with **Tools > Open installation folder**.

2. If you have set *novelibre* under Windows as the default application for *.novx* files, undo this by executing `remove_novelibre.reg` (double-click and confirm).
3. Go up one level to your user directory and delete the installation folder. This will remove *novelibre* along with the plugins and utilities from your computer.
4. Remove the *novelibre* shortcut from the desktop.

> **Note**
>
> As developer, I am naturally interested in your experiences with *novelibre*. Feel free to leave a note in the discussions forum

CHAPTER

TWENTYONE

ABOUT THIS USER GUIDE

21.1 License information

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- novelibre home page: https://github.com/peter88213/novelibre/